

After-Action Review

Commissioned by the UNDP Crisis Bureau and the UNDP Regional Bureau
for Arab States



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Resilient nations.*

DRAFT for Review

UNDP's crisis response in Hodeidah / Yemen January – June 2019

Lessons learned and recommendations



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Acronyms

AA	Ansar Allah
AAR	After Action Review
BCP	Business Continuity Plan
BERA	UNDP Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy
BMS	UNDP Bureau for Management Services
BPPS	UNDP Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
CB	UNDP Crisis Bureau
CfW	Cash-for-Work
CMST	Crisis Management Support Team
CSMT	Country Support Management Team of UNDPs Crisis Bureau
CO	Country Office
COMS	Communications
CPF	Country Programme Framework
DDR	Disarmament, Demobilization and Reintegration
DIM	Direct Implementation
DPC	Direct Project Costing
DPPA/DPO	Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs / Department of Peace Operations
DRR/O	Deputy Resident Representative / Operations
DRR/P	Deputy Resident Representative / Programmes
EOD	Entry on Duty
ETC	Emergency Telecommunications Cluster
FAO	Food and Agricultural Organization
FSAC	Food Security and Agricultural Cluster
FTA	Foxed Term Appointment
FTE	Full-Time-Equivalent
GMS	General Management Services
GOE	General Operating Expenditures
GNP	Global Policy Network
GS	General Staff
GSSC	Global Shared Services Center
HoSO	Head of Sub Office
HQ	Headquarters
HR	Human Resources
IBRD	International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
IC	individual Contractor
ICT	Information Communication Technology
IPC	Integrated Phase Classification (for Food Security)
IRGY	Internationally Recognized Government of Yemen

L1, L2, L3	Crisis levels 1, 2, 3
LP (UNLP)	United Nations Laissez-Passer
LTA	Long-term Agreement
M1, M2, M3	UNDP Atlas Approval levels Manager 1, 2, 3
MCT	UNDP Management Consulting Team
NAMCHA	National Authority for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
NEA	Netherlands Enterprise Agency
NGO	Non-governmental Organization
NO	National Officer
OAI	UNDP Office for Audit and Investigation
OCHA	UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
OFRM	UNDP Office for Finance and Resource Management
OHR	UNDP Office for Human Resources
OM	Operations Manager
OSESGY	Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary General to Yemen
PMD	UNDP Performance Management and Development tool
PO	Purchase Order
PVE	Prevention of Violent Extremism
R&R	Rest & Recuperation
RBAS	UNDP Regional Bureau for Arab States
RC	UN Resident Coordinator
RCC	Redeployment Coordination Committee
RCO	UN Resident Coordinator's Office
RCT	Regional Country Team
REQ	Requisition
RM	Resources Mobilization
RoL	Rule of Law
RR	UNDP Resident Representative
SC	Service Contract
SCMCHA	Supreme Council for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
SO	Sub Office
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
SSR	Security Sector Reform
STC	Southern Transitional Council
STRATCOM	Strategic Communications
TA	Temporary Appointment
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
UNMHA	United Nations Mission to support the Hudaydah Agreement
WB	World Bank
WFP	World Food Programme
YEMAC	Yemen Mine Action Center

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Executive summary

The peace agreement concluded between the Houthi movement Ansar Allah (AA) and the Internationally Recognized Government of Yemen (IRGY) on the 18th December 2018 in Stockholm must be seen as a critical experience informing and promoting the overall peace process in Yemen. Similarly, the UNDP surge response in Hodeidah must be understood as a critical experience informing UNDP's future response to a possibly comprehensive political transition process in Yemen.

The After-Action Review (AAR) process has established that UNDP's surge response in Hodeidah was successful, guided by a strong strategic vision and supported by a matured UNDP crisis response mechanism. In light of possible future trends and needs, the present report nevertheless identifies critical improvement opportunities and proposes a comprehensive set of recommendations to UNDP at country and corporate levels.

The AAR key conclusions can be summarized in three points. First, the existing crisis response mechanism, processes and tools have matured and are working well for what they were designed for. However, some important adjustments and additions such as the revision of existing, or establishment of a new contract modality for crisis deployments in high-risk environments will be important to further improve UNDP's crisis response system.

Secondly, the success of the Hodeidah response is partially due to the vision, attitude and efforts of individual UNDP colleagues at corporate and country level – using existing mechanisms and “going the extra mile”, and strong collaboration between them. This has important implications for UNDP's organisational strategy: beyond systems and processes UNDP should invest more into an organisational culture that encourages, recognises and rewards individual efforts and informed risk-taking as well as collaboration across business units.

Thirdly, when it comes to setting up operations in complex and high-risk environments, UNDP's systems still lack professionalism compared to sister agencies and contextual requirements. UNDP should expect to continuously – and likely increasingly – operate in protracted, post-conflict and transition settings around the world. Beyond the given alignment with its mandate, UNDP can indeed offer important value added in strengthening the nexus between humanitarian, peacebuilding and recovery strategies and interventions. Therefore, UNDP should invest in establishing required additional support capacities and mechanisms to better operate in such environments.

Corporate findings

In terms of **strategy and leadership**, the Regional Bureau for Arab States and the Yemen country office, in close collaboration with the Crisis Bureau, demonstrated excellent vision and ensured UNDP's strategic positioning. Based on UNDP's successful positioning work, a new corporate strategic partnership with DPPA/DPO at corporate and country level is emerging, possibly informing future integrated mission settings.

The existing **corporate crisis response mechanism** has functioned well and proven its relevance to assist the Yemen country office in receiving rapid support. Technical cooperation between crisis bureau and regional bureau was excellent due to efforts of senior managers and regional desks, in addition to existing formal coordination processes. The responsibility for some important tasks related to the implementation of an L3 crisis response among UNDP business units, however, is not sufficiently clear and crisis response capacities of some corporate bureaus (BERA, BMS) are not geared towards providing required support.

In terms of **deployments**, surge advisors were identified and deployed with adequate speed despite the complex and high-risk environment. The deployed team was of unusually high quality, partly due to careful additional due diligence during selection and strong communication with the country office. Deployments highly valued that mission briefing and debriefing were systematically provided, as well as the regular checking-in by the CB desk. The deployment process has shown, however, that currently existing contractual modalities are not appropriate for deployments in high-risk environments.

When it comes to operating **in complex and high-risk environments**, **UNDP's systems supporting the establishment of local presences lack professionalism** compared to sister agencies. First, the Hodeidah response illustrates that the 6-month surge support period is insufficient and misleading in complex settings. Secondly, the setup of a physical office and living space in a high-risk environment requires a specialised team capacity that should be made available at the beginning of the surge phase for an adequate period of time. Thirdly, financial support arrangements for the establishment of the sub office were unclear. In fact, UNDP currently lacks an adequate financial instrument to support country offices in recurrent and protracted crisis contexts. Fourthly, UNDP's internal incentive structure is still not geared towards encouraging response efficiency and informed risk-taking required to operate successfully in these environments. Finally, corporate bureaus are currently not structured to provide implementation support to country offices in L3 crisis contexts.

Country Office Level

The **delinking** of the RC function from UNDP led to temporary confusion regarding roles in supporting the Stockholm agreement. Nevertheless, thanks to a mature approach to collaboration shared between UNDP and the RCO this confusion was eventually overcome.

In terms of **CO strategy, response structure and capacities**, the surge operation was guided by strong senior management vision, leading to a strong positioning of the country office. The direct and hands-on involvement of country office senior management, especially the UNDP RR, in the coordination of the surge effort and frequent communication with the Strategic Surge Advisor was time-intensive but helpful. Meanwhile, surge deployments located (stranded) in Amman due to Visa problems fell outside an adequate management structure and were therefore under-managed and under-used.

The establishment of the **sub office and the remote management structure** was based on a relevant and solid business case. The modular design of the sub office structure was adequate and judicious. While the establishment of the initial team was done with impressive speed, there is a need for harmonisation of contract modalities used for the Hodeidah team. Also, the financial framework and architecture of the sub office require urgent clarification.

The **programmatic positioning** of UNDP regarding 4 areas of the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreement was strategic. UNDP's technical collaboration, especially in the area of Rule of Law, with OSESGY and UNMHA was appreciated. In addition, the development and implementation of a

labour-intensive solid waste management programme in addition the “Stockholm programme areas” supported UNDP’s visibility, recognition and reputation.

Operational capacities, not strengthened through the surge package, were stretched processing additional surge-related transactions. In fact, all operations units are heavily involved in the processes of UN agency & common services transactions and have barely any spare capacities to support a surge response. Also, the country office staff would benefit from additional training regarding procedures available in a surge context and existing country office business processes require adaptation to the increasingly decentralised structure. It is also important to note that national staff in Hodeidah recruited on service contracts and through third party providers is exposed to arbitrary detention by local authorities, which requires a solution.

International partners have a positive perception of UNDP in Yemen, and of UNDP’s efforts in Hodeidah. Accordingly, CO **resources mobilization** efforts for Hodeidah were reasonably successful despite a slowly advancing Hodeidah response. In terms of **external communication**, Hodeidah – and Yemen in general – are highly politicised contexts that require politically savvy guidance. A dedicated communications strategy and clear communication protocol for the Hodeidah operation is therefore highly recommendable.

Recommendations

53 recommendations activities were identified in response to the findings of the AAR. Since it is unrealistic to expect diligent and successful implementation of all recommendations, the AAR report proposes a prioritization of recommendations based on a review of their potential impact, urgency, feasibility and cost.

Corporate level recommendations

Proposed for immediate implementation:

- Introduce default rapid CO capacity assessment methodology as standing practice (supported by BMS).
- Introduce the “3+6 surge” mechanism (surge, transition, institutionalization).
- Include an international security specialist by default in all L3 post-conflict surge responses and ensure the entire period of covered.
- Establish a dedicated contract modality for L3 (insurance coverage, LP, staff status, reasonable pro-forma costs, fast-track recruitment).
- Negotiate an adequate insurance package to be offered of ICs to be deployed in high-risk environments.
- Establishment of a flexible surge operations support center at HQ level to absorb temporary workload peaks in all areas.
- Designate a dedicated HQ-based spokesperson for L3 settings, especially in politicized contexts such as Yemen.

Proposed for subsequent implementation:

- Establish a corporate support mechanism to country offices in performing a coordination function in post-conflict contexts focusing on the areas of peacebuilding, rule of law, livelihood recovery, and government coordination capacities (Coordinator rosters, TOR, deployment mechanism, etc).

- Introduce a crisis management qualification for UNDP operations staff.
- Revamp and include crisis operations training into the DRR introduction (both at regional and corporate level).
- For sub office establishment / surge responses in complex settings, establish and train rapid response teams (including OM and Construction Engineer).
- Introduce a revolving fund with XB/GMS reimbursement scheme serving L2 and L3 crises, especially start-up funding for sub offices.
- In protracted settings, introduce systematic scenario preparedness planning supported by joint RB/CB/GPN capacities.

Country level recommendations

Proposed for immediate implementation:

- Assign matrix management responsibility to Amman liaison office for surge staff based in Amman, and revise job descriptions as required to maximize use of these capacities.
- Clarify sub office financial architecture, including the establishment of a dedicated budget.
- Clarify sub office contract modalities and realign contracts and staffing accordingly.
- Provide training for business-critical functions at Hodeidah level.
- Targeted training / preparation of CO operations colleagues covering business-critical functions.
- Explore additional approaches to increase bandwidth in Sana'a and Aden.

Proposed for subsequent implementation:

- Establish a technical coordination group for UN agencies and NGOs in Hodeidah covering the areas of livelihood recovery, peacebuilding, government coordination capacity building and rule of law, and launch key assessments in close collaboration with SCMCHA.
- Ensure all SO staff is paid from a project budget dedicated to Hodeidah operations or from the SO budget.
- Staff re-deployment / regular circulation from main to sub office to facilitate main office – sub office exchanges and on-the-job training of new sub office staff.
- Outsource administrative/operational tasks for areas where staff presence in the CO is not required.
- Organize monthly briefings with local and national authorities on incoming staff and missions to facilitate visa approval processes.
- Issuance of UNLPs for Service Contract Holders.
- Develop, implement and monitor a SO communication strategy (linking into CO strategy).
- Launch a dedicated “apolitical” communication campaign in Hodeidah targeting communities and grand population, showcasing UNDP’s work.

1 Introduction



The present report summarizes the main findings and lessons learned of the After-Action Review of UNDP's surge response supporting the Yemen country office from January to June 2019 following the conclusion of the peace agreement concluded between the Houthi movement Ansar Allah (AA) and the Internationally Recognized Government of Yemen (IRGY), on the 18th December 2018 in Stockholm. It proposes a set of prioritized recommendations for UNDP at country office and corporate levels.

The recommendations proposed in the present report have been developed to inform future planning at country office and corporate levels. In fact, plausible future scenarios developed collaboratively by UNDP Yemen country office (CO), the Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS) and the Crisis Bureau (CB) representatives during the After-Action Review process for 2020/21 show that the need for continuous corporate engagement and support to the Yemen country office should be anticipated.¹

1.1 Context and Objective

In response to the conclusion of the Stockholm Peace agreement in December 2018 including the redeployment plan for the city and port of Hodeidah, the UNDP Crisis Bureau deployed a crisis package in support of the UNDP Yemen CO from January 7th to the end of June 2019, based on a decision taken by the Crisis Board under a Level 3 crisis response. The objective of the support package was for UNDP to promptly develop a business case for, and subsequently set up a sub office and its operations in Hodeidah, in support of the implementation of the Stockholm Agreement.

The crisis package included investments to strengthen delivery capacities, reinforce representation, and ensure business continuity in a location that is critical for the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreement and the interests of the parties and people of Yemen. Following the conclusion of the corporate support as part of the above-mentioned crisis package, the UNDP Crisis Bureau in close coordination with the Regional Bureau for Arab States commissioned an After-Action Review (AAR).

As per the terms of reference, the objective of the AAR was to examine the performance of UNDP's crisis response in support of the establishment of a presence in Hodeidah, through the Business Case, and to identify lessons learned that will strengthen the efficiency of UNDP's corporate response to crisis.

The review, which was conducted in October 2019, covers the surge period of 6 months approved and launched by the UNDP Crisis Board on the of 21st December 2018, until the end of June 2019. It has also considered events and actions from July to October 2019 to the extent that these further inform findings and recommendations.

The present report provides a review of the timeliness and effectiveness of the overall response in support of the Stockholm Peace Agreement in Hodeidah (relevance, speed, modalities, quality of the response by HQ units and the Country Office). It reviews the response of UNDP in Hodeidah, and its strategic collaboration with UNMHA and OSESGY in supporting the implementation of the Stockholm agreement. Coordination and decision-making processes between CO, Crisis Bureau and Regional Bureau have also been considered.

Aiming to be action-oriented, this AAR furthermore intends to inform UNDP on how to enhance the speed, quality and efficiency of its future responses. It identifies innovative elements of the Surge response and response gaps in a highly volatile and insecure environment. It proposes concrete steps towards an overall strengthening of UNDP's surge mechanism in L3 crisis contexts.

¹ See separate report: UNDP Yemen, supported by UNDP CB (2019): Scenarios and Preparedness Planning 2020 / 21.

The review coincided with the CO strategic management retreat in Sana'a and the review team had the opportunity to partake in the retreat. It was therefore agreed among stakeholders that the AAR process would also contribute to designing plausible scenarios for 2020/21 and to identifying – against the scenarios – preparedness actions for the country office. The results of this scenario and preparedness planning exercise are presented in a separate document.²

1.2 Methodology

The **review was structured in 3 phases**. The inception phase (phase 1) entailed a desk review of key primary sources of information as well as background documents, the development of the detailed review methodology, initial interviews with stakeholders, as well as the design and administration of two online surveys. Field work and stakeholder discussions (phase 2) were carried out in New York, Amman, Sana'a and Hodeidah, accompanied by additional online interviews. The 2nd phase also included:

- **Focus Group Discussion (FGD) on contractual modalities:** with representatives from BMS (Human Resources, Procurement, Coordination, Security), RBAS, and CB. The FGD focussed on the identification of specific requirements of contractual modalities in highly volatile environments as compared to modalities currently available in UNDP.
- **RACI exercise with CMST members:** The RACI exercise (RACI: Responsibility, Accountability, Consultation, Information) was used to establish the de-facto distribution of roles and responsibilities during the implementation of a surge response, as well as the level of common understanding (agreement, clarity) between CMST members.
- **Scenario-based planning exercises** with CO senior and middle managers, and separately with the Hodeidah Sub Office team: The two exercises were used to contributing to the establishment of a common vision among senior managers of the Yemen Country Office on UNDP positioning and preparedness activities in view of plausible scenarios for 2020/21.³

Lessons and recommendations that emerged during phase 2 were vetted by members of the UNDP CO in Yemen and representatives of CB, RBAS, the Bureau of Management Services (BMS), the Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA) and the Bureau for Policy and Programme Support (BPPS) at corporate level (phase 3). The present report presents the result of this vetting process.

The **review framework** used comprises 14 areas illustrated in below figure 2. For each area, key aspects and guiding questions were defined during the inception phase.⁴ The distinction Corporate / CO has been made based on primary responsibility for functions in respective areas. It is understood that in most cases the both levels, corporate and country office, are collaborating in the 14 areas and that a multitude of linkages between areas exist. The present report refers as much as possible to these linkages.

The review has sought to facilitate a **positive and open organizational learning process** confirming approaches that worked well and should be continued; identifying new, innovative approaches that should be mainstreamed and integrated in future crisis responses; and approaches that did not work well and could possibly be discontinued or revised. As a general principle, the review was therefore

² Ibid.

³ Ibid.

⁴ Refer to Annex 6.4 for a detailed overview of the review framework.

collaborative and consultative in nature, drawing on the knowledge and experience of a broad range of internal and external stakeholders. As per industry best practice, UNDP country office and bureau leadership has played an active role in engaging with colleagues from all levels during common sessions and discussions, promoting an honest and judgement-free environment.

The methodology and key review steps were closely coordinated with **focal points** from the Bureaus of Management Services (BMS) and External Relationships and Advocacy (BERA) in addition to the Crisis Bureau (CB), the Country Office (CO) in Yemen and the Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS). An informal group of bureau focal points was established for this purpose, and briefings on progress provided at critical milestones.

Figure 1: AAR Phases and Methodology

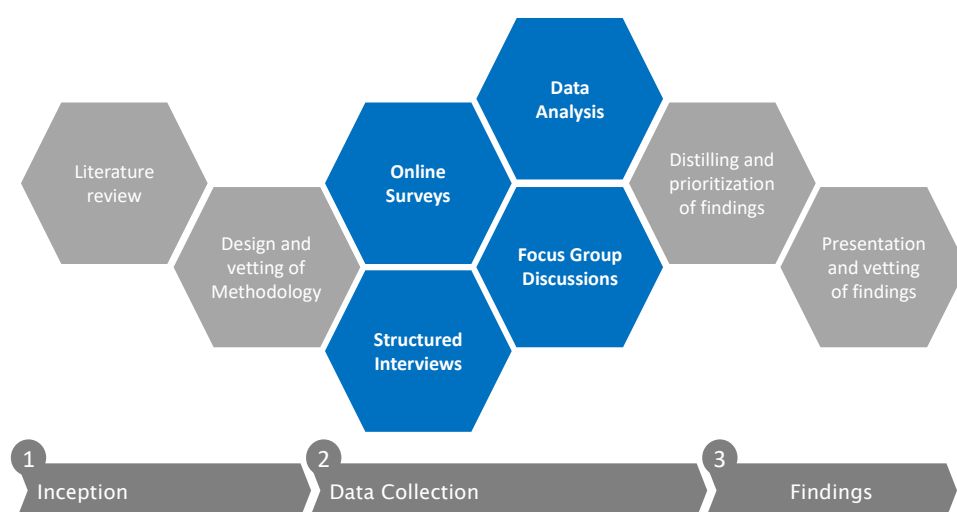


Figure 2: Review Areas

Corporate Response Level	Country Response Level		Special Considerations
Corporate Response Strategy & Leadership	Local Crisis Coordination	Operational Response	Innovations
Corporate Response Mechanisms	Country Office Response Structure and Capacities	Communication	Coordination and decision-making
Deployments	Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	Partnerships and Resource Mobilization	Deployment Preparation / Support
HQ Implementation Support in level 3	Programmatic Response	14 review areas	

2 Overview of the UNDP response



2.1 Country context

With a Human Development Index of 0.452 equivalent to country rank 178 in 2018, the Republic of Yemen is suffering from weak human development. Historically low human development is compounded with high population growth, repeated local conflicts, chronic food insecurity and uncertain political transition.⁵

The impact of the conflict in Yemen has been devastating. Tens of thousands of civilians have been killed or injured and public infrastructure throughout the country has been severely damaged or destroyed. Half of the Yemeni population currently lives in areas directly affected by conflict.⁶ The UN considers Yemen the worst humanitarian crisis in the world. An estimated 80 per cent of the population – 24 million people – require some form of humanitarian or protection assistance, including 14.3 million who are in acute need. Slightly over 20 million Yemenis are food insecure – an unprecedented situation and a 13 per cent increase from 2017. Of these, 9.6 million are one step away from famine. An estimated 3.3 million people remain displaced, up from 2.2 million last year. This includes 685,000 people who fled fighting in Hodeidah and on the west coast from June 2018 onwards.

The conflict has disrupted markets and institutions and destroyed social and economic infrastructure, while inequalities have sharply increased. Gross domestic product per capita has plummeted from US \$3,577 to US \$1,950, a level not seen in Yemen since before 1960. Yemen is now ranked as the world's second most unequal in the world in terms of income, surging past 100 other countries in inequality levels in the last five years.⁷

Against this background and following months of negotiations, the Secretary-General's Special Envoy to the Republic of Yemen convened intra-Yemeni consultations in Sweden in December 2018, which successfully concluded with the parties to the conflict adopting the Stockholm agreement. The agreement includes provisions for Hodeidah port and city, and the ports of Salif and Ras Isa, an executive mechanism on activating the prisoner exchange agreement and a statement of understanding on Taiz.

Following the conclusion of the Stockholm Agreement, the UN Security Council established a new special political mission, "UNMHA", to lead and support the functioning of the Redeployment Coordination Committee (RCC) and to monitor the parties' compliance with the ceasefire in Hodeidah governorate and the mutual redeployment of forces.

2.2 UNDP country office structure and response capacities

Pre-existing technical capacities in relevant areas

Following the conclusion of the Stockholm agreement, UNDP assumed programmatic responsibility in four areas: Support to the management of the port, Mine action, Establishment and training of Local Security Forces, and Revenue management. UNDP could draw on capacities and experience of two existing projects: The National Mine Action project and the Rule of Law project. With regards to port management and revenue management, UNDP had to break new ground.

⁵ Sources: UNDP Human Development Index, http://hdr.undp.org/sites/all/themes/hdr_theme/country-notes/YEM.pdf.

⁶ Source: UNDP Concept Note, Peace Support Facility 2018.

⁷ Source: UNDP 2019, "Assessing the Impact of War in Yemen on Achieving the Sustainable Development Goals".

No local coordination and management capacities

In late 2018, the UNDP Yemen country office had presences in Sana'a (main office), Amman (Liaison office) and Aden (emerging Sub Office). In addition, the country office maintained a project presence in Mukalla within the UNDP-managed UN hub. While the Stockholm-related support needed to be coordinated and delivered locally in close collaboration with UNMHA, the RCC and local authorities, UNDP did not have any presence in Hodeidah.

Limited delivery capacities

By end of 2018, the country office had delivered a total of US\$ 199 million, of which US\$ 158 million or 80% was delivered by the World Bank / IBRD funded project "Yemen Crisis Response" Project channeling the funds to two local partners. The remaining US\$ 40 million (or 20%) was delivered through directly implemented (DIM) projects.

As per data from the corporate planning system, the country office had in 2018 a total of 80 staff not including common services or UNDSS staff. This comprises 26 operation colleagues (24 GS staff, 2 NO staff) and 23 programme colleagues (7 GS staff, 5 NO staff and 11 international staff). Judging from these figures, the country office delivery capacities in terms of workforce and knowledge / experience to manage a rapid build-up of a local presence and DIM programme in Hodeidah was limited. Moreover, the capacities of the country office were, and continue to be, impacted by the volatile and restrictive environment. Due to the conflict, many qualified nationals left the country and the deployment of international staff is expensive and encounters many hurdles.

Figure 3: UNDP Yemen Delivery 2018 by Project (as per Atlas 2019)

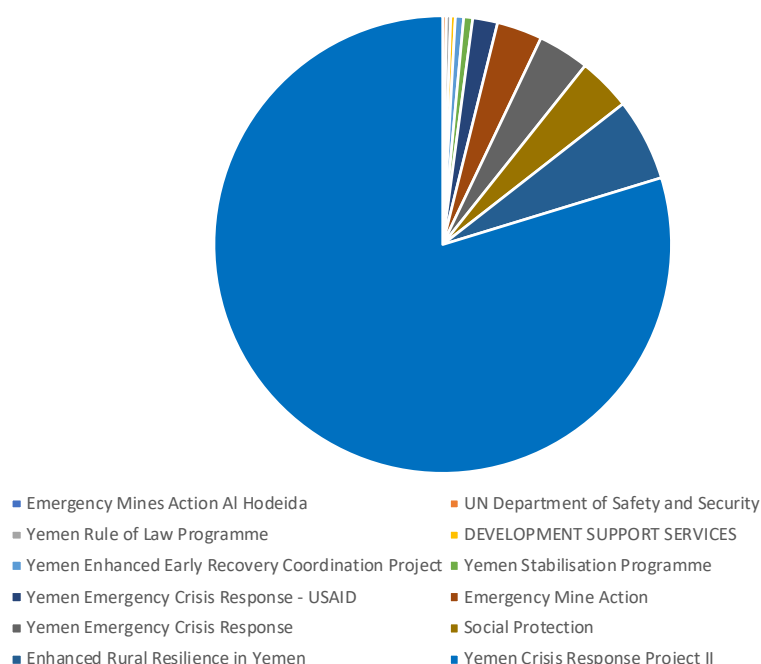
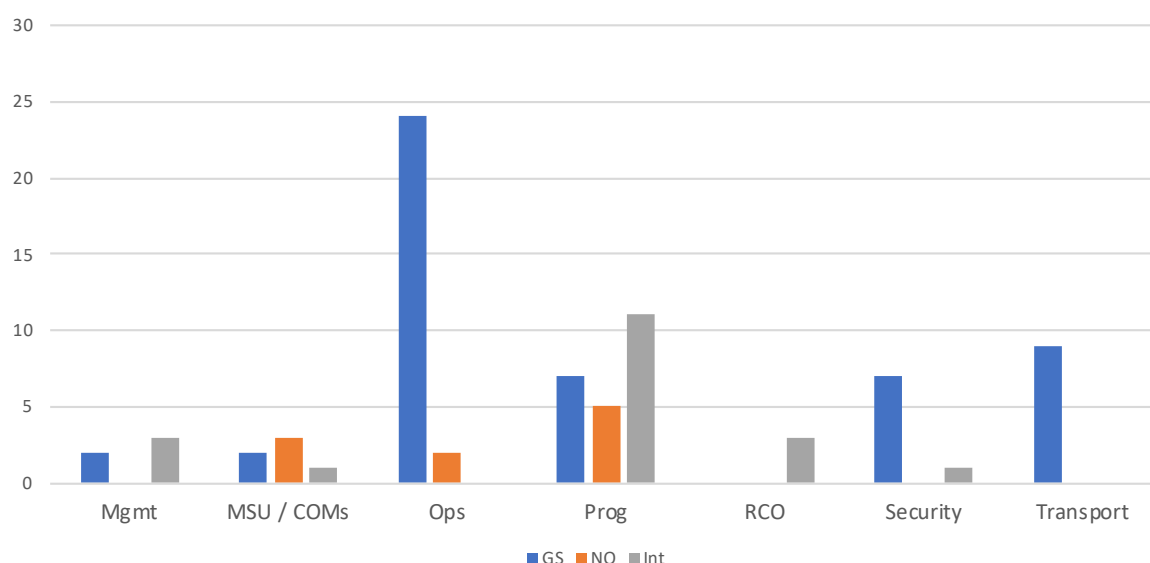


Figure 4: Country Office Staff in 2018 (as per CPS 2018)

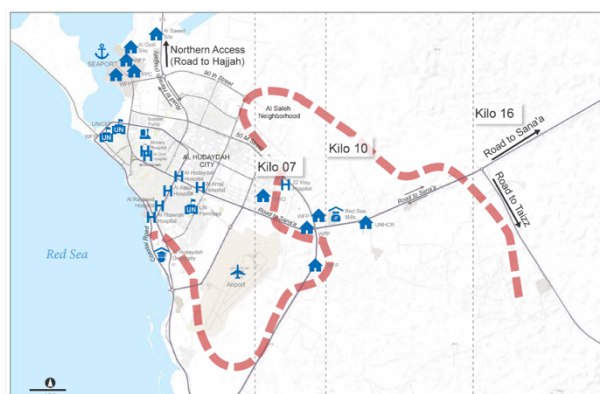


2.3 Contextual factors impacting the response

A politicized environment

The operating environment in Yemen in December 2018 was highly politicised and restrictive. From a political perspective, UNDP had to carefully balance opposed interests of different national and international counterparts. This restricted its ability to coordinate and communicate proactively around programmes and plans.

Figure 5: Frontline crossing Hodeidah in 2018 / 19



Volatile and high-risk security environment

Staff movement close to an active frontline crossing the city of Hodeidah was obviously limited. Not only did the security context complicate the establishment of UNDP's local presence, but it also required restrictive security measures limiting programme implementation and monitoring.

Operational obstacles and restrictions

A complicated and cumbersome visa approval process posed serious restrictions to UNDP's ability to deploy adequate technical capacities on the ground. Three out of eight surge advisors could not be deployed in Yemen and therefore operated from Amman. Significant movement and access restrictions imposed by local authorities constituted additional obstacles to effective programme delivery and monitoring. Shipment of goods and services to Hodeidah was equally limited.

Some of these obstacles were overcome through remote management arrangements and the use of information technology. A low bandwidth and patchy internet connection, however, negatively impacted effective communication between colleagues in Amman, Sana'a and Hodeidah. Attempts to improve connectivity through better ICT equipment are for the time being unsuccessful due to import restrictions imposed on such equipment by the authorities.

After-Action Review

UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

Limitations to effective programme implementation

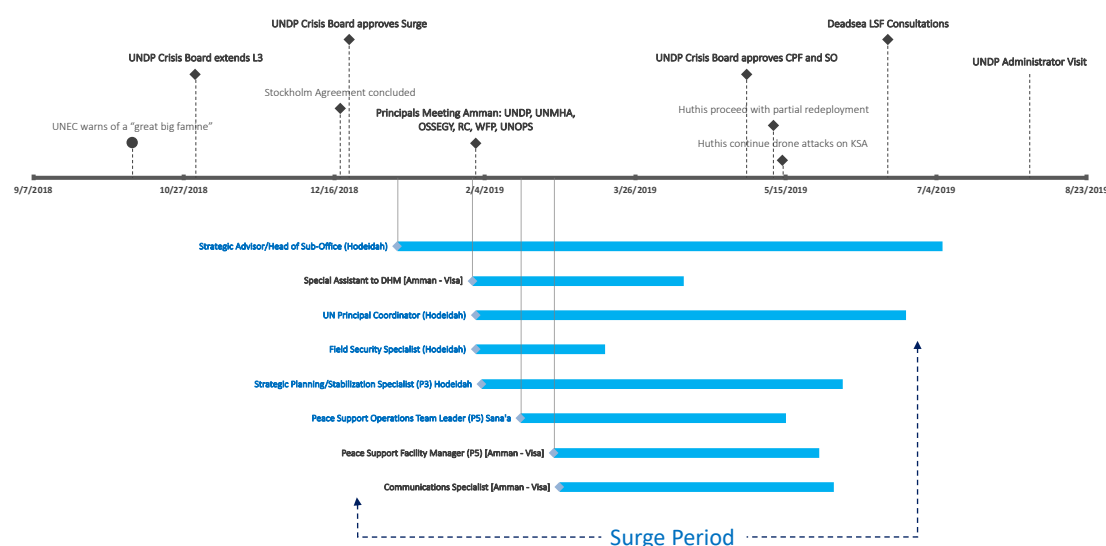
Significant economic interests with regard to revenues generated in the port of Hodeidah limited UNDP's ability to quickly design and implement activities targeting the port. Progress in establishing and building capacities of local security forces required a redeployment of forces from both sides, a precondition which only partially and gradually materialised in the course of 2019. Mine action in Hodeidah was being carried out by a national institution, YEMAC, and UNDP's support was limited to financial support and technical advisory to these institutions with limited ability to guide activities. More importantly, after initial minefield marking in May 2019 the Ministry of Defence only approved YEMAC teams to redeploying to Hodeidah in November following more than 6 months of absence. This meant that no marking or removal of mines has taken place between June and November 2019.

2.4 Timeline of events and surge actions

In October 2018, the United Nations Emergency Relief Coordinator warns the international community of a great famine and the possible loss of up to half a million lives in view of the advancement of troops associated with the Internationally Recognised Government of Yemen on the city of Hodeidah and its port, the key entry point to the country for humanitarian goods and food. Shortly thereafter UNDP convenes a crisis board which extends the L3 status of the Yemen crisis.

Following significant diplomatic efforts led by the Special Envoy of the UN Secretary General for Yemen and involving all key players of the international system, the two war parties, the internationally recognised government of the Republic of Yemen and the Houthi Movement Ansar Allah, conclude a peace agreement on the 18th December 2018 that includes provisions for the city of Hodeidah and the ports of Hodeidah, Salif and Ras Issa; an executive mechanism on activating the prisoner exchange agreement; and an understanding on the city of Ta'iz.⁸

Figure 6: Timeline of Milestone Events and Surge Deployments (see annex 6.5 for enlarged version)



It is important to note that UNDP supported the Office of the Special Envoy of the UN Secretary General for Yemen (OSSEGY) in the preparations for Stockholm. Moreover, it had already identified a suitable

⁸ For the full text of the agreement, please refer to: <https://osesgy.unmissions.org/full-text-stockholm-agreement>.

senior surge advisor that could possibly support the coordination of UN support activities in Hodeidah, in close coordination with the UN mission which was to be established.

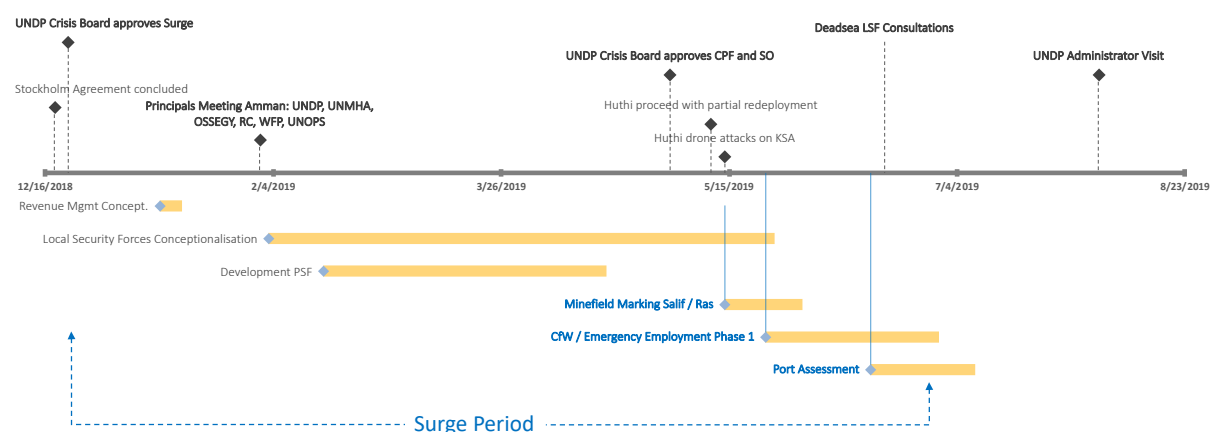
Shortly after the conclusion of the Stockholm agreements, on the 21 December 2018, UNDP organised another Crisis Board meeting, during which a response support package was approved. This meeting officially launched the 6-month surge period as per UNDP's crisis response SOPs.

On the 6th January 2019, the first surge advisor, notably the Strategic Advisor/Head of Sub-Office (Hodeidah), is deployed and arrives in Yemen. 6 additional Surge Advisors follow during the months of January and February and the Surge Communications Advisor is deployed on the 1st of March. 5 of the advisors receive entry visas and are deployed in Yemen. 3 advisors, however, do not receive visas and can only operate from Amman. These are the Communication Advisor, the Special Assistant to the Deputy Head of UN mission and the Peace Support Facility Manager.

A principals meeting is organised on the 1st of February 2019, initiated by UNDP/RBAS and involving UNMHA, OSESGY, RCO, WFP and UNOPS. This meeting is a critical milestone in the sense that it clarifies the roles and responsibilities of agencies with regards to implementation support to the Stockholm agreement, especially the port. Moreover, it clarifies the role of the UNDP-deployed Senior Surge Advisor and confirms him as the Deputy Head of UNMHA.

In the following months, tedious negotiations ensue facilitated by the newly established Redeployment Coordination Committee (RCC) to advance on the different areas of the agreement. In the meantime, the UNDP Surge team under the leadership of the Strategic Advisor / Head of Sub Office develops the business case for the establishment of a UNDP Sub Office in Hodeidah. A draft business case is submitted to the chair of the UNDP Crisis Board on the 17th of February 2019 and approved by the Crisis Board on the 2nd May 2019.

Figure 7: Timeline of Surge-supported Programme Implementation (see annex 6.5 for enlarged version)



On the 11th of May, the Houthis proceed with a partial redeployment of their troops within Hodeidah. This redeployment, however, is done unilaterally by the Houthis and only completes phase one of the redeployment plan agreed upon by the RCC.⁹ Also, the redeployment coincides with a re-launch of Houthi-led drone attacks on targets in Saudi Arabia.

⁹ Phase one requires the opposing forces to move out from the key ports of Hodeidah, Saleef and Ras Isa, and from critical infrastructure such as the Red Sea Mills, which hold enough grain to feed 3.7 million people for a month.

After-Action Review

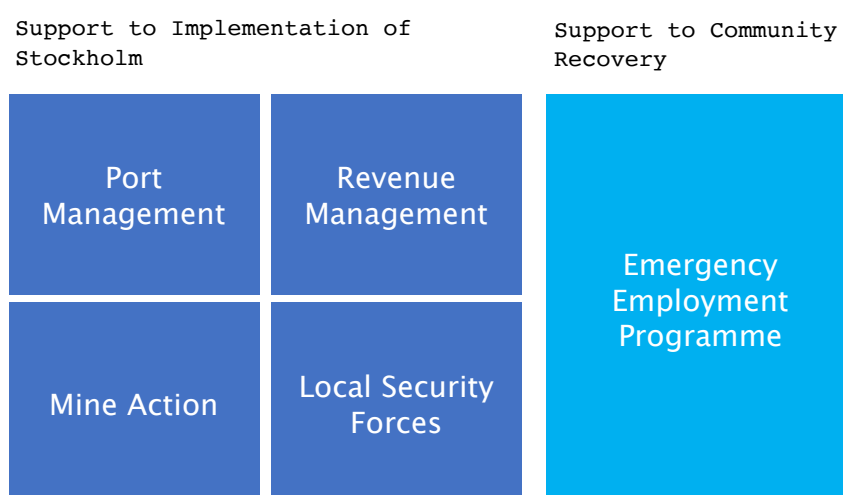
UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

From a programmatic perspective, UNDP launches conceptual work on the 4 areas of the agreement in February 2019. While it becomes very soon clear that no progress can be made any time soon regarding revenue management, the conceptualisation of the Peace Support Facility and the support to local security forces, as well as the support provided to the Yemen Executive Mine Action Centre (YEMAC) proceed in close collaboration with national counterparts and international partners. The emerging Hodeidah Sub Office team also prepares for the implementation of a labour-intensive solid waste management initiative in Hodeidah – an emergency employment and cash-for-work-based street cleaning initiative.

Implementation of programmatic activities starts beginning of May with the minefield marking in Salif and Ras Issa. Shortly after, the emergency employment initiative is launched. On the 15th of June, UNDP finally manages to carry out an assessment of the port of Hodeidah conducted through experts from the port of Rotterdam recruited via an expert roster of the Dutch Foreign Ministry.

As part of its “Dead Sea Rule of Law Consultations” series, UNDP also organises dedicated consultation on the question of local security forces in Hodeidah on the 18th of June 2019, including representatives from OSESGY, UNMHA, international donors, Ansar Allah and IRGY. The latter is the final milestone identified during the official surge period, which ends on the 30 June 2019.

Figure 8 - UNDP's Programme Components in Hodeidah



A black and white aerial photograph of a densely built-up historic city. In the foreground, a large, light-colored domed structure, likely a mosque, is prominent. The city is characterized by multi-story buildings with intricate architectural details, including arched windows and decorative facades. A tall, slender tower or minaret is visible in the background. The overall scene depicts a well-preserved urban environment with a rich cultural heritage.

3 Findings and Recommendations

The presentation of AAR findings and recommendations follows the analytical framework used during the review. Please refer to annex 6.4 for research questions by area.

3.1 Corporate level

Corporate Response Strategy & Leadership

1. The regional bureau for Arab States and the Yemen country office, in close collaboration with the Crisis Bureau, provided a strong vision and ensured UNDP's strategic positioning. While much of the positioning work has been done at country level, the proactive approach of the Regional Bureau supported by the Crisis Bureau to create strategic linkages with the nascent functional conglomerate DPPA/ DPA at UN Secretariat level was exemplary and appreciated by secretariat colleagues (see figure 9). UNDP also managed to assume a critical role as integrator facilitating communication between actors at senior management level in clarifying the roles and responsibilities with regards to the implementation of the peace agreement between DPPA/DPO, UNMHA, OSESGY, RCO and sister agencies. The strategic positioning achieved by UNDP is well illustrated in the letter dated 14 October 2019 from the Secretary-General addressed to the President of the Security Council, emphasising the partnership between UNDP, UNMHA and OSESGY (see annex 6.7 for an extract from the letter).

2. A new corporate strategic partnership with DPPA/DPO is emerging, possibly informing future integrated mission settings. The Hodeidah context as well as the Stockholm peace agreement were specific in nature for three reasons: the peace agreement is geographically confined; technically, it focusses on a limited number of areas; institutionally, the co-existence of OSESGY and UNMHA is unusual. Moreover, the delinking of RC and RR function coincided with the conclusion of the peace agreement. This fact contributed to a lack of clarity on roles, which allowed UNDP to step "in and up", providing a deputy head of mission to the newly created UN mission as well as some dedicated operational start-up support. The distribution of roles and responsibilities between the different actors and specifically UNDP's role therefore also needs to be considered as a specific case. Nevertheless, a number of stakeholders interviewed during the review have emphasised and appreciated UNDP's ability to move comparatively fast and cost-effectively, providing critical deployments including a programme-oriented deputy head of mission, start-up support and immediate technical advice (see figure 10). Given UNDP's comparative advantage and mandate, review stakeholders, including international bilateral actors, therefore imagine a more formalised role for UNDP along similar lines in future integrated mission settings.

3. Coordination and communication between RB, CB and CO was exemplary, and response-related decision-making was effective. UNDP's strategic positioning was in part achieved by effective formal and informal communication and decision-making between RB, CB and CO. Formal decision-making was mostly channelled through the Crisis Board, in line with UNDP crisis response SOPs. Informal decision-making was additionally required as circumstances evolved, and immediate decisions needed to be taken. As an example, an agreement between RBAS Director and CB Deputy Director to deploy a UNDP Surge Advisor as UNMHA deputy head of mission was quickly achieved when the question arose during the principals' meeting in Amman in February 2019. This deployment subsequently proved to be of strategic importance.

4. The absence of the Early Recovery Cluster has created a coordination gap at country and local levels. While a final decision on the global future of the Early Recovery Cluster remains to be expected, the abolishment of the ER cluster in Yemen has certainly created a coordination gap at Hodeidah level.¹⁰ While some of the functions were absorbed by the Food Security and Livelihood cluster, critical

¹⁰ The gap is possibly country-wide, but this consideration is beyond scope of the present report.

assessments are being done separately by NGOs and UN agencies, and thematic areas critical for peace building and the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreements (local security forces, revenue management, NAMCHA coordination capacities) are currently not covered. A local solution can of course be devised and is recommended to tackle this coordination gap. Corporate assistance and support, however, will be required to allow UNDP country offices to effectively assume a critical coordination role in post conflict and transition settings. Similar to ER cluster support, corporate resources would entail a roster of coordination advisors, stand-by partners, and information management capacities and systems, focussing on the areas of peacebuilding, rule of law, livelihood recovery, and government coordination capacities. Local communication and coordination channels with the humanitarian system should be established as required.

Recommendations on Corporate Response Strategy & Leadership:

- R1.** *Invest further into, and enhance collaboration between UNDP, DPPA/DPO and possibly IFIs aiming at formally defining UNDP's institutional role in conflict and post-conflict settings (startup support, technical advice and implementation support, key deployments). [Ref. Finding 2]*
- R2.** *Establish a corporate support mechanism to country offices in performing a coordination function in conflict and post-conflict contexts focusing on the areas of peacebuilding, rule of law, livelihood recovery, and government coordination capacities. [Ref. Finding 4]*

Figure 9: UNDP Staff Survey Question 10

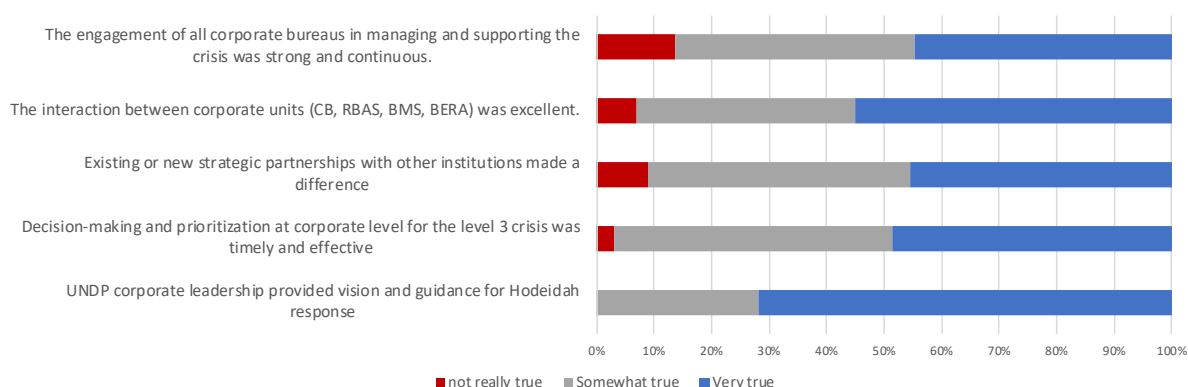
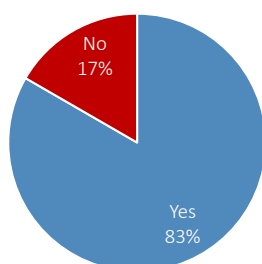


Figure 10 – External Partner Survey Question 8: “Do you feel that the cooperation between UN political mission and UNDP in Hodeidah is a model worth replicating?”



Corporate Response Mechanism

5. The existing corporate crisis response mechanism has functioned well and proven its relevance to assist the Yemen country office in receiving rapid support. The existing UNDP surge mechanism comprising a governance structure, systems, processes and tools has over the years matured, as can be seen from the smooth sequence of corporate and country office surge actions following the conclusion of Stockholm peace agreements. Beyond the Hodeidah case, the usage level of the Express Roster (>1,000 deployments in 2019), of TRAC 1 resources (>85%), of the crisis governance mechanism (5 crisis boards in 2018/9) further illustrate this finding.

6. Technical cooperation between crisis bureau and regional bureau was excellent. The technical desks at crisis bureau and regional bureau level coordinated closely and communicated regularly throughout the response – an approach that deserves to be labelled as a best practice to be adopted and mainstreamed across regions. This level of collaboration, which ensured coherence between regional and country office vision on the one hand, and crisis response and deployments on the other, should be recognised and further encouraged as part of annual work plans, performance discussions and PMDs.

7. The responsibility for tasks related to the implementation of an L3 crisis response among UNDP business units, however, is not clear and crisis-related support capacities of some corporate bureaus are accordingly insufficient. The RACI exercise conducted with the members of the CMST during phase 2 of the AAR showed that there was either disagreement or unclarity on the distribution of responsibilities for 35% of tasks extracted from the SOPs (see annex 6.8 for details).¹¹ Furthermore, while CB, RB and CO seem to have clearly defined responsibilities, the three other corporate bureaus (BMS, BERA, BPPS) do not. The SOPs assign support roles to these bureaus somewhat vaguely, which in reality – as was the case in the Hodeidah response – translates into little concrete action. The only exception to this is the SOP-defined lead role of BERA for crisis communication in L3 settings¹², which in the Yemen case has not been implemented.¹³ Discussions with colleagues at corporate and country level confirm that more support from corporate bureaus regarding programme development and implementation, operations management, resources mobilisation and communication is desired. At the same time, there is a well-founded perception that these bureaus are currently not geared and capacitated to provide such support. From an organisational strategy and resources perspective, it is difficult to make a convincing case for more (adequate) staff capacities and resources based on vaguely defined support roles. More clarity is therefore needed on roles of some UNDP business units (BMS, BERA, BPPS / Global Policy Network) within a surge crisis response, so that capacity and resource needs can be exactly identified.

8. Corporate follow-up after Crisis-Board meetings should have been more systematic. Being pleased with the interaction and communication between country office, regional bureau and crisis bureau, country office colleagues nevertheless expressed the perception that there was little follow-up and accountability regarding CB decisions and CO actions in-between crisis board meetings. While informal communication at technical and senior level between country office and regional bureau was frequent and effective, specific follow-up regarding the use of allocated resources and progress made regarding Stockholm-related programme implementation could have clarified areas of confusion (see below on financial support) and more effectively tackled some operational obstacles that were encountered. Colleagues suggested that the Crisis Bureau, in collaboration with the regional bureau, should have

¹¹ The RACI exercise conducted on the 17th October 2019 with CMST members covered approximately half of the SOP-defined tasks, focusing on those considered to be the most relevant.

¹² See UNDP SOP for Immediate Crisis Response, Section 5.1, Page 12.

¹³ See the section on corporate implementation support for a discussion on corporate lead or support to communication.

organised regular interaction at senior level (CB: Team Lead Country Support; CO: Crisis Coordinator) in addition to the regular technical exchange between CB country desks and surge deployments.

9. Country office capacities to absorb the additional, operational workload related to the establishment of the sub office in Hodeidah were not assessed, and therefore not strengthened through corporate support. Generally, many colleagues feel that operational aspects of a surge response are often neglected and that therefore surge deployments rarely include operational capacities. At the same time, colleagues at corporate and country level also recognise that at the time of design of the surge package there was a shared sense that dedicated operational capacities would not be required. During AAR discussions in Sana'a, with hindsight, senior managers and operations colleagues jointly felt that it would have been good to include operational support, notably a capacity to support recruitment processes and a capacity to support the physical setup of the sub office in Hodeidah.

The scope of additional workload related to the setup of the sub office did not go beyond what could have been expected in December 2018. In fact, it rather stayed below the expected level because of the slow implementation of the peace agreement. It would have therefore certainly been feasible to assess the expected additional workload as well as the capacities of the country office operations team to absorb the additional, temporary workload peak. Based on a rapid assessment, additional operations support could have been integrated into the surge response. Such an assessment of workload, capacities and additional needs can be performed remotely based on available systems data. UNDP should thus consider including a rapid remote operational capacity assessment as standard feature into the crisis board agenda.

10. Mainstreamed fast-track procedures continue to prove useful, but country office colleagues still use them with hesitation. Ten (or 71%) out of the 14 mainstreamed fast-track procedures were used, at least to some extent, in implementing the Hodeidah response. Both country office and headquarters colleagues confirmed their relevance and usefulness. There is, however, a knowledge and training gap regarding the use of these procedures which are still falsely regarded as “exceptional procedures” requiring additional documentation and approvals.

In the words of one colleague, there was a

“the tendency for colleagues to review notes [to file] that had already been signed by management and send them back with a request to re-write or re-do. This slowed things down and created a washing machine effect of notes and corrections when we should have been getting on with the response.”¹⁴

Moreover, regarding the use of mainstreamed fast track procedures for the recruitment of Hodeidah-based position, colleagues commented that:

“Fast track procedures for direct recruitments were not used as much as they could have due to an aversion to this approach (...). There have only been two direct recruitments and we are going to finish 2019 without having used the direct recruitment quota for the CO.”¹⁵

This example illustrates a tension that continues to exist between the option to use tested and corporately approved fast-track procedures for speed and efficiency purposes on the one hand, and the fear to be called out later by country office audits for having unduly used fast-track. This tension is usually only resolved when a CO senior manager, typically the Resident Representative, agrees to sign

¹⁴ Discussion with a UNDP colleague in Yemen during the AAR.

¹⁵ Ibid.

off on an additional (and un-necessary) note to file document confirming his decision to use the relevant procedure.

In the view of the authors of the present report this tension is grounded in two facts. First, DRR/ Ps & Os, OM's and programme and operations colleagues continue to have insufficient knowledge of mainstreamed fast-track procedures and revised PPM measures, and have insufficient appetite to invest in this area of learning. The Crisis Bureau should therefore create new momentum for the training of DRRs in crisis procedures as well as the creation of a breed of trained and experienced crisis operations colleagues at all levels. This should go hand-in-hand with a special recognition of trained operations colleagues, such as a special qualification that can be added to the personal HR file.¹⁶

Secondly, the existing corporate incentive structure continuously rewards the wrong behaviour. As an operations colleague has formulated in discussion with the authors,

"Careers of operations managers in UNDP have failed because of a perceived inappropriate use of procedures, but no career has failed because of a lack of efficiency of an operations manager during a crisis response".¹⁷

Accordingly, operations managers of UNDP by default opt for more time-consuming options, which are perceived as "safe". In the Hodeidah case, only 2 out of 16 positions were recruited using the direct recruitment modality. A rough calculation of time and resources lost because of the non-use of corporately approved fast-track procedures based on moderate assumptions establishes the additional use of capacities at 17 FTE days per position, amounting to a cost of at least US\$ 89,266 for 14 positions, and a time loss of 28 working days per position; i.e. each of the colleagues could have been in place at least one month earlier.

While the high level of accountability and transparency of operations colleagues within UNDP is a valuable achievement that needs to be maintained, the authors believe that it is time for UNDP to complement the existing incentive structure. For instance, country office audits should verify that mainstreamed crisis procedures have been used adequately during L1/2/3 crises. In case procedures were not used, the audit should formulate a negative audit finding. To facilitate the changes to prevailing audit practices, CB should engage with OAI and support the creation of an audit approach / methodology that considers the adequate use of mainstreamed fast-track procedures.

Crisis operations in high-risk environments

When it comes to establishing operations in complex and high-risk environments, UNDP's approach still lacks professionalism compared to sister agencies.¹⁸

11. The 6-month surge support period is insufficient and misleading in complex settings. A 6-month surge period is too short to achieve the establishment of a sub-office, establish an adequate team and launch a response programme in a complex environment. The Hodeidah case, where the physical sub office is still not in place 10 months after the launch of the surge illustrates that the setup of a sub office in volatile high-risk environments requires time, in addition to dedicated capacities. The establishment of a capable longer-term sub office team is usually delayed by the initially high staff turn-over and the fact that surge deployments – in theory also in charge of training newly recruited staff – are in many cases only deployed during 3 months, while recruitment processes for adequate contractual modalities

¹⁶ One colleague suggested a UNDP crisis response needle that can be worn at festive occasions.

¹⁷ Discussion with a UNDP colleague during the AAR in Yemen.

¹⁸ While it has been argued that UNDP should not / does not require specialization in setting up structures in high risk environments, the reality shows that UNDP has established local presences in most of the high-risk and high-opportunity contexts worldwide. Examples include Northern Nigeria (Maiduguri), Hodeidah & Aden (Yemen), Darfur (Sudan), Kivus (DR Congo), Somalia, Iraq, Afghanistan, Banda Aceh (Indonesia), Philippines.

(SCs, FTAs) often – and unnecessarily – take the same amount of time. Moreover, as shown by figure 7, initial programmatic activities were only implemented after 5 months of design and preparatory work even though the sub office team could draw on the capacities and knowledge of an existing national rule of law and mine action programme.

A realistic and adequate solution to this concern would be to structure a surge response in an L3 setting involving the setup of a new local structure into 3 phases: Immediate Surge (3 months), Transition (6 months), Institutionalization. The corporate bridge should cover 9 months, during which the first 3 months are covered by a dedicated team, specially trained for the context and task; and the second sequence of 6 month by surge deployments using the regular mechanism. During this transition phase, the team task will be to prepare the full establishment and institutionalization of the new structure.

12. The setup of a physical office and possibly living space in a high-risk environment requires specialised technical knowledge that should be available at the beginning of the surge phase for an adequate period of time. Areas of required technical expertise in this context include inter alia: Blast and Security assessments; Office space viability assessment; Monitoring of renovation (civil) works; Information system design and implementation; Design and establishment of adequate communication system connectivity; Design of adequate living space. In the absence of an experienced Operations Manager, Engineer and ICT technician, the Senior Surge Advisor / Head of Sub Office deployed to Hodeidah was responsible to cover these areas, in addition to strategic, programmatic and other operational tasks.

As highlighted by country office colleagues, some of the related tasks can be outsourced and others can be supported by partners such as the Emergency Telecommunications Cluster (ETC) run by WFP in partnership with Ericson Response. There remains nevertheless the need to competently identify requirements and guide related works.

There is a shared feeling between stakeholders that the setup of a new structure in a complex operating environment with high reputational risks and opportunities requires a professional “A-team”, jointly trained for its role in such a context, that kick-starts operations, sets key processes in motion, carries out all required assessments and prepares the ground for the surge deployments. The team would by default include a team leader / coordinator, an operations manager, a civil engineer trained in the conduct of critical physical assessments, an ICT expert, a programme specialist (recovery / transition), a finance associate and a human resources associate. It is important to note that the team’s role is therefore different from – but could be combined with – the role of a surge planning mission. Members of the team with an operations qualification and background should be trained and prepared by BMS, and possibly be based in Copenhagen. The CB should ensure the joint training of the team “as one team” including inter alia: roles and responsibilities within the team, teamwork and collaboration, operating in post-conflict and high-risk environments, physical and psychological well-being in restricted environments, liaising and negotiating with counterparts and non-state armed groups, collaborating with humanitarian actors.

13. The absence of an international security advisor in Hodeidah during 4 out of 6 months of the surge response in a high-risk environment is concerning. As documented in the minutes of the crisis board of 21st December 2018,

“the Director of the Security Office pointed out that considering the upcoming setup of a team in Hudaydah, it would be strongly advised to recruit a security officer.”

Accordingly, a security specialist was included in the surge package and deployed during the months of February and March 2019. During the AAR the reason why the Hodeidah team operated during the

following months - and still operates - without an international security specialist could not be clearly established. In the view of the authors, this gap should be immediately addressed. Moreover, an international security specialist should be integrated by default into the surge team and readily availed by the security office.

14. The financial support arrangements for the establishment of the sub office were unclear and funding (“investment”) provided to the Yemen country office up to today was insufficient. During AAR consultations in Sana’a, the country office explained the understanding that CB had allocated US\$ 500,000 to fund the deployment of surge advisors, the RB had allocated US\$ 500,000 as programmatic seed funding and the security office had agreed to fund up to US\$ one million for security measures. The Country Office also understood that this was the total corporate support to be received in the Hodeidah context.

Despite the fact that the Yemen Country Office was delivering a programme portfolio of US\$ 200 million in 2018, it could not by itself absorb the required initial investment cost of US\$ 4.5 million in the absence of significant XB or 11888 resources,¹⁹ until new project and budget including costs sub office costs and staffing were developed and funded by donors. Using various funding sources, the Yemen CO now plans to charge a significant DPC amount²⁰ to existing projects at the end of 2019 to avoid a financial sustainability crisis.

It was subsequently clarified that the costs for the establishment of the sub office will be covered by corporate allocation from CB, RBAS and SO. This is certainly good news for the country office, which now nevertheless will need to deal with a significant additional and unnecessary operational workload to process reversals and budget corrections.

All consulted stakeholders agree that unclarity and confusion regarding funding arrangements for the setup of a sub office in a high-risk context generates delays and risks which should be avoided. How then can the unclarity be explained and in future avoided? First, as per corporate PPM guidance the business case outlines funding-related risks and opportunities. It does not propose a funding arrangement ready for crisis board approval:

This business case is meant to trigger a facts-based discussion around this potential and investment, as well as an agreement on the different funding sources that would be available for this proposition: in the CO as well as in different part of UNDP’s HQ.²¹

(...)

Purely financially, even a lower \$200mln portfolio over a period of 2 years, (calculating 3% GMS and 3% DPC) would yield a revenue for the sub-office of \$4mln every year, which by far exceeds the yearly running costs of \$2.2mln. During the same period, under the same assumptions, also the one-off investment costs of \$2.0mln will have easily been recovered.

In a dramatic negative scenario, in which the Hodeidah sub-office would need to be abandoned, UNDP stands to lose a major part of the investment costs (buildings, equipment etc) while staff costs and other recurring expenses would need to be tapered down as soon as possible. In this respect, taking a phased approach towards increasing programmatic and operational capacity of the sub-office

¹⁹ Following the “regionalization” of XB resources, COs cannot build a strategic reserve through delivery anymore. Instead, strategic allocations are provided by the regional bureau. IN light of overall regional needs, however, this re-distribution mechanism is often insufficient to serve all needs of country offices.

²⁰ Calculated at a total of US\$ 9 million.

²¹ Emphasis added.

will help to mitigate the risks related to a total breakdown in the negotiations and a relapse into conflict.

Secondly, the crisis boards in December 2018 and May 2019 only took a partial decision on funding arrangements. In fact, the decision of the crisis board during its meeting on the 2nd May 2019, which approved the business case for the establishment of the sub office, reads as follows (emphasis added):

The Crisis Board endorsed the business case for the establishment of Al-Hodeidah sub-office, **whereas funding options will be discussed offline across bureaus**. Regarding the investment funding model, the following contributions were made available at the meeting:

- The Crisis Bureau will support with an allocation of US\$ 500,000 in staffing costs.
- The Security Office will cover costs for security upgrades of office premises (amount to be confirmed).²²

In view of the above, UNDP should consider in future to (a) consult around and subsequently include a clear funding arrangement in a business case for a sub office, (b) as much as possible ensure financial decisions to be taken during a crisis board are adequately prepared, and (c) fully and clearly document all financial decisions – including the readiness of the regional bureau to contribute funding - in the crisis board minutes.

15. The CB lacks an adequate financial instrument to support country offices in recurrent and protracted crisis contexts. It is recognised that corporate resources to support country offices in crisis are limited, while country offices in protracted crisis countries will regularly (recurrently) need financial up-front investments. The Hodeidah case illustrates that even country offices with a relatively large existing programme portfolio will not be able to absorb required up-front investments. However, the country offices would be able to reimburse financial resources gradually, subject to the level of resources mobilized through initial corporate investments. The establishment of a financial instrument that combines TRAC 3 grants with strategic reserve loans would allow to address this gap. The instrument would, based on a standardised but adjustable formula, establish the ratio between grant and loan component.²³ It would also create a positive incentive structure for country offices to delivery on resources mobilisation and delivery targets as well as an additional, constructive accountability and follow-up between CO and Crisis Board through a reimbursement monitoring mechanism and thereby address the perceived lack of corporate follow-up.

The reimbursement mechanism needs to be carefully prescribed and guided to avoid accountability issues with donors regarding the use of project resources. A model calculation (see annex 6.9) illustrates that the use of GMS generated through newly mobilised funding and a realistic and legitimately charged DPC for project use of sub office capacities and facilities would allow to reimburse a loan of 2 million US\$ over the period of 3 years with 3 million US\$ for reinvestment, assuming US\$ 45 million of newly mobilised funding.

The calculation also shows that with an initial capitalization of 20 million, the fund would be financially viable and could service on average 5 L2 or L3 crisis per year with an average loan component of US\$ 2 million.²⁴ At the end of 6 years, the fund would have been fully recapitalised, with a total of US\$ 60 million invested into 30 crises around the world.

²² A blast assessment was required to establish overall costs [note added by authors].

²³ This formula would consider the financial support needs. It would propose a loan amount that can realistically be reimbursed based on the resource mobilization opportunities (pipeline A+B) and the expected annual delivery capacities over the coming 3 years.

²⁴ On average, UNDP is servicing 4 – 5 L2 or L3 crises per annum. See annex 6.10 for a more detailed overview.

It is proposed that the funding mechanism would be managed on a day-to-day basis by BMS / OFRM, with the crisis board serving as funds oversight and strategic decision-making body. The fund should be subject to a dedicated OAI audit procedure every 5 years.

Recommendations on Corporate Response Mechanism:

- R3. Further encourage and mainstream the close technical collaboration and communication between CB and RB, using annual work plans, performance discussions and PMDs. [Ref. Finding 6]*
- R4. Clarify role of corporate bureaus and align resources accordingly. [Ref. Finding 7]*
- R5. Introduce a corporate L3 follow-up and support mechanism. [Ref. Finding 8]*
- R6. Introduce default rapid CO capacity assessment methodology as standing practice (supported by BMS). [Ref. Finding 9]*
- R7. Introduce a crisis management qualification for UNDP operations staff. [Ref. Finding 10]*
- R8. Revamp and include crisis operations training into the DRR introduction (both at regional and corporate level). [Ref. Finding 10]*
- R9. Include the review of use of mainstreamed crisis procedures during an L1-L3 crisis into UNDP country office audits. In case procedures were not used, the audit should formulate a negative audit finding. [Ref. Finding 10]*
- R10. CB to engage with OAI to support the creating of an audit approach that reviews the use of procedures during surge settings. [Ref. Finding 10]*
- R11. Introduce the “3+6 surge” mechanism (surge, transition, institutionalization). [Ref. Finding 11]*
- R12. For sub office establishment and surge responses in complex (L2/L3) settings, establish and train rapid response teams (including OM and Construction Engineer) [Ref. Finding 12]*
- R13. Include a security specialist by default in all L3 post-conflict surge responses and ensure the entire period of covered. [Ref. Finding 13]*
- R14. Introduce a revolving fund with XB/GMS reimbursement scheme serving L2 and L3 crises, especially start-up funding for sub offices. [Ref. Finding 14]*

Table 1: Usage of Mainstreamed Fast-Track Procedures for the Hodeidah Response

Area	Special Measures	Used?
Procurement Management	Individual Contract	Yes
	Increased Delegated Procurement Authority (IDPA)	Yes
	ACP/BoM Review	No
	Low-Value-Shopping/Purchase	Yes
Human Resource Management	Fixed-Term Appointments	Yes
	Temporary Appointments	Yes
	Service Contract recruitment	Yes
	Staff Administrative Services	No
Financial Resource Management	Project Cash advances	No
	Petty Cash	Yes
	Single Signatory	No
Partnerships	Partnerships Agreements	No
ICT Management	ICT Supply Services	Yes
Project Management	DIM Authorization	Yes

Figure 11 – Components of proposed revolving fund and additional instruments

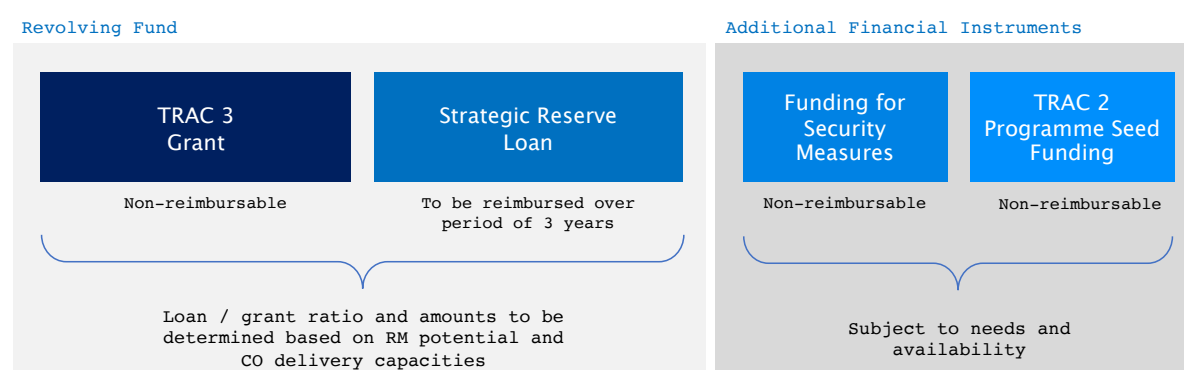
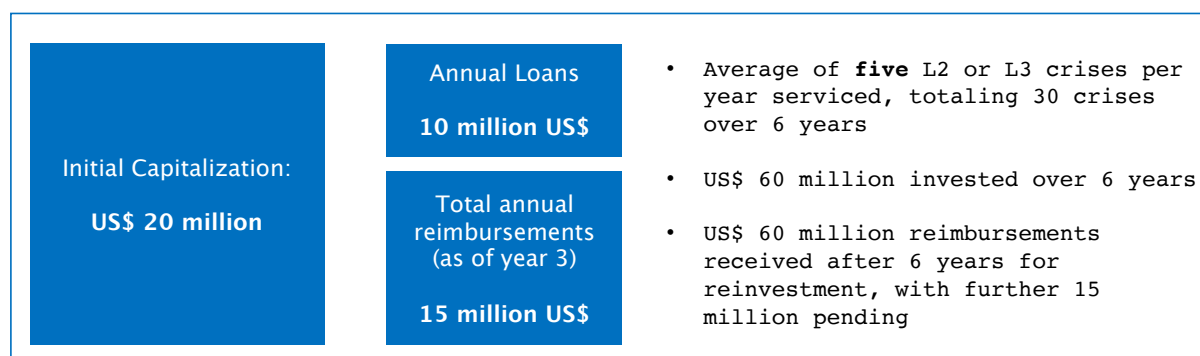


Figure 12: Financial capacities and viability of the proposed fund



Deployments

16. Surge advisors were identified and deployed with adequate speed despite the challenges of a complex and high-risk environment. As shown in table 2, most of the surge advisors including the Deputy Head of UNMHA and the Strategic Advisor / Head of Sub Office were deployed by beginning of February, one month after the start of launch of the surge phase. While the immediate availability of a crisis-experienced senior colleagues for the positions of Deputy Head of UNMHA and Strategic Advisor / Head of Sub Office was partially due to favourable circumstances (timing-related “luck”), this confirms the functionality of the surge deployment mechanism and its tools, as well as the experience and dedication of crisis bureau colleagues to use the mechanism in complex settings.

17. The deployed team was of unusually high quality, partly due to careful additional due diligence during selection and strong communication with the country office. All internal and external stakeholders consulted during the review have confirmed that the quality of all surge deployments was high – i.e. that the profiles and competencies of the deployments matched the requirements as well as circumstances. Such positive feedback is very unusual and can be ascribed to the fact that the crisis bureau desk officer, in close collaboration with the crisis bureau roster managers, the country office and the regional bureau performed careful due diligence in selecting the right profiles instead of mechanically using existing systems. In addition to a review of technical qualification, this involved – based on experiences and additional feedback from colleagues - a consideration of candidates’ ability to perform in the high-risk environment, to integrate into the existing team, and to function in the specific cultural setting.

This selection procedure is labour-intensive and cannot be performed for all countries supported by the crisis bureau. It should, however, be mainstreamed for crises with high reputational, operational and security risks – typically L2 and especially L3 crises. In addition to the establishment of rapid response teams proposed in the previous section, UNDP should also consider creating an enlarged “inner circle” of Surge Advisors and Express consultants that have received additional, more intense training and can be used for key positions in these specific L2/L3 circumstances.

18. Currently existing contractual modalities are not appropriate for a surge deployment in high-risk environments. The use of the individual contractor (IC) modality, the default modality for deployments of colleagues from the express roster, would not have been appropriate for deployments in Hodeidah, at the time a quasi-active war zone with a front line only 10 km away from the city centre. This became clear when none of the identified candidates managed to procure an adequate insurance coverage and triggered a relatively lengthy discussion within the crisis bureau and with the country office regarding alternatives. After 2 weeks of discussions and research, the crisis bureau finally settled for the temporary assignment (TA) modality, which in the opinion of the authors was the right choice under the given circumstances. The TA modality, however, has 2 important inconveniences: 50% of the mandatory corporate pro-forma costs constitute contributions to different corporate schemes and funds, which almost doubles deployment costs; and recruitment time for TAs is significantly longer since it involves a number of additional steps including the creation of a position in the system, the offer, medical clearance etc.²⁵ As such, the TA modality as it stands should only be temporarily used as corporate default modality for high-risk environments, while a new contract modality is being developed.

Contract modalities, especially in high-risk environments, should fulfil the following 4 key requirements: inclusion of the colleague into the local UN security umbrella including a possible evacuation; access to UNDPs core systems (ATLAS, Intranet); adequate life and health insurance; and issuance of an LP. The latter is particularly important since it speeds up visa processes, facilitates the crossing of checkpoints

²⁵ See annex 6.11 with the as-is process and a proposed simplification (to-be process).

and grants the colleague privileges and immunities, which provides protection against arbitrary detention and full UN-support in the case of hostage-taking. In addition, there are 5 desirable elements to a contract modality in the context of a crisis response, notably a simple and fast recruitment process; a simple contract extension process; adequate conditions (the “contract package” to attract high-quality personal; institutional proximity, i.e. the degree to which a person feels as a part of UNDP and represents the organisation accordingly); and value for money.

Below figure 13 compares four existing contract / deployment modalities for international deployments based on the 4 key requirements and 5 desirable aspects. As can be seen, only the TA modality fulfils all 4 requirements and is therefore currently the only recommendable modality for high-risk environments. Its main drawbacks are the costs and the recruitment time.

The IC modality does not provide health insurance coverage and an LP. It is a cost-effective modality which can be processed very quickly. Contract extensions, however, need additional justification and institutional adherence is significantly lower than with an TA.

3rd party deployments, i.e. deployments done through private-sector companies for UNDP, can be processed rapidly once the company is procured. However, these services are very expensive, contractors often do not have adequate conditions, and the institutional adherence is low. In addition, these deployments, albeit used often by UN agencies in high-risk environments to transfer risks and – truthfully – to circumvent deployment limitations UN staff is subjected to, come with a host of ethical issues, which have recently been summarised by the director if the UNDP security office in his back-to-office report after his mission to Somalia (see annex 6.12).

Deployments of experts on mission through stand-by partners, finally, are a good option except that they also do not allow for the provision of LPs. ATLAS and other system access can be provided. However, they often have no or little UNDP experience and institutional adherence is low. These positions are therefore adequate for expert positions, not for management or representational positions.

Based on this comparison, figure 14 proposes high-level guidance on the use of contract modalities in light of contextual and position requirements. In high-risk environments, only TA and Expert-on-Mission (EoM) modalities should be used for the time being. TAs should be used to deploy management, coordination and representation capacities, while the EoM modality should be used for the deployment of experts and technical coordination capacities. The TA recruitment process can be significantly shortened through the creation of 10-15 “stand-by” positions in the system for the CB, the default use of the Express Roster for TA recruitments without interview and additional vetting, and a default medical clearance to be introduced for all Express Roster members that would like to be part of the inner circle of consultants.

If UNDP manages to negotiate an adequate insurance package for ICs with a reputable insurance offeror, the IC modality could additionally be considered for short-term deployments of experts (up to 4 weeks). However, the lack of privileges and immunities will expose these deployments and therefore needs to be considered when taking decisions.

At the same time, UNDP should rapidly advance the development of a new contract modality. This new modality could simply be a revised TA modality which allows for fast (direct) recruitment without position creation and medical clearance; and significantly reduced pro-forma costs. This resembles the “ALD” modality which was abolished in 2010. Current corporate discussions around an “International Service Contract” should be informed accordingly.

19. Deployments highly valued the mission briefing and debriefing systematically provided, as well as regular checking-in by the CB desk. According to the crisis response SOPs a standard practice, systematic mission briefings and debriefings happen in reality only in 20 – 30 % of deployments despite best intentions of regional and crisis bureau colleagues because of capacity shortages. In the context of the Hodeidah response, this mechanism supporting mission preparedness and closure was performed for all deployments. In addition, several deployed persons highlighted that regular “checking-in” by the crisis bureau desk fought a possible feeling of “being forgotten in Hodeidah” and supported their well-being. Both practices, the briefing / debriefing and the checking-in, are highly commendable. However, it is recognised that they require a significant time investment which cannot be maintained with the current crisis bureau staffing level. Since this service cannot be outsourced, UNDP will need to expand capacities accordingly.

20. While the majority of deployed colleagues did not feel the need for a regular opportunity to speak to a trained counsellor, it would have been useful and important in 2 specific cases. Typically, colleagues encountering burn-out symptoms only recognise these and the need to seek help when it is too late. All consultant colleagues recognised this and confirmed the usefulness of a regular “mandatory” and friendly check-in from a professional counsellor to be done with all deployed colleagues. UNDP should therefore consider requesting the Rome Institute, with which UNDP recently concluded an LTA, to systematically perform this service, at least for colleagues deployed in high-risk contexts.²⁶

Recommendations on Deployments:

R15. *Mainstream the “careful selection practice” for L2/L3 and ensure CB has adequate capacities to perform this task. [Ref. Finding 17]*

R16. *Establish a dedicated contract modality for L3 (insurance coverage, LP, staff status, reasonable pro-forma costs, fast-track recruitment) [Ref. Finding 18]*

R17. *Negotiate an adequate insurance package to be offered of ICs to be deployed in high-risk environments. [Ref. Finding 18]*

R18. *Ensure LPs are fast-tracked and delivered before / at EOD (validity can be restricted to 6 months). [Ref. Finding 18]*

R19. *Introduce systematic mission briefing & debriefing, and establish required capacities. [Ref. Finding 19]*

R20. *Introduce a standard procedure for regular well-being counselling (Rome Institute) [Ref. Finding 20]*

²⁶ Through the Rome Institute, UNDP is currently offering three pilot psychosocial support services: Pre-deployment psychological preparation briefing for staff deployed to D&E duty stations; Counselling during the assignment/mission; and End-of-assignment debriefing for staff deployed to D&E duty stations. For more details on the services included in the LTA with the Rome institute, please click [here](#).

Table 2: Surge Advisor Deployments

Title	Start Date	End Date	Contract Modality
Deputy Head of Mission UNMHA	1-Feb-19	24-June-19	Temporary Assignment
Strategic Advisor/Head of Sub-Office	6-Jan-19	6-Jul-19	Temporary Appointment
Communications Advisor	1-Mar-19	31-May-19	Temporary Appointment
Field Security Specialist	1-Feb-19	16-Mar-19	RLA with OHCHR
Special Assistant to DHM	31-Jan-19	11-Apr-19	Detail assignment, RCO Somalia
Peace Support Operations Team Leader	16-Feb-19	15-May-19	Temporary Appointment
Peace Support Facility Manager	27-Feb-19	26-May-19	Temporary Appointment
Planning / Stabilization Specialist	3-Feb-19	3-Jun-19	Detail Assignment,
Communication Specialist	18-June-19	17-Dec-19	Temporary Assignment
HR Associate (based in Amman)	19-June-19	18-Sept-19	Detail Assignment, Pakistan CO

Figure 13: Comparison of Contract Modalities

Temporary Assignment (TA)						Individual Contractor (IC)					
Key requirements	Sec	Atl	Ins	LP		Key requirements	Sec	Atl	Ins	LP	
Recruitment process						Recruitment process					
Extension process						Extension process					
Adequate conditions						Adequate conditions					
Institutional Adherence						Institutional Adherence					
Value for Money (Cost)						Value for Money (Cost)					

3 rd Party						Expert on Mission					
Key requirements	Sec	Ins	Atl	LP		Key requirements	Sec	Ins	Atl	LP	
Recruitment process						Recruitment process					
Extension process						Extension process					
Adequate conditions						Adequate conditions					
Institutional Adherence						Institutional Adherence					
Value for Money (Cost)						Value for Money (Cost)					

Figure 14: Proposed guidance for usage of international contract modalities

Modality	Low Risk Env.	Medium Risk Env.	High Risk Environment
IC	Yes	Yes	No
TA	No	No	Yes
3 rd Party	Yes	Yes	No
Expert on Mission	Yes	Yes	Yes

	Expert	Management / Coordination	Representation
IC	Yes	No	No
TA	No	Yes	Yes
3 rd Party	Yes	No	No
Expert on Mission	Yes	Only technical groups	No

Corporate Implementation Support

21. Part of the operational workload for the deployment of colleagues through Temporary Assignment (TA) contracts was absorbed by the Crisis Bureau, which allowed to maintain the speed of deployment. Operational support to absorbing recruitment-related workload peaks was provided by the crisis bureau and highly appreciated. The support was critical in the sense that the country office did not receive dedicated operational support as part of the surge package, as outlined above. It meant, however, that crisis bureau colleagues performed this task in addition to their existing responsibilities and often outside of regular working hours. It is therefore recommended that future surge-related workload peaks in L2/L3 settings should be absorbed by a dedicated, flexible corporate support capacity (see below finding 23 for additional details).

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22. The sharing of process steps between crisis bureau and country office created confusion and led to serious delays of payments. There are several examples for significantly delayed processes including the payment of DSA to deployed colleagues. In one instance, the DSA for an assignment completed in May was still not paid in October. It seems that one shared reason across examples is that the CO, CB and GSSC were involved in the processing of the payment; that experience at CO level and available workforce capacities at CB level for the processing of such transactions was low; and that communication between the 3 entities was not ideal. As per current practice, the country office remains the owner for most deployment-related payments and the processing of contracts. The original idea behind this design might have been to avoid the creating of unnecessary additional capacities at corporate level. As clearly shown in the Hodeidah case, however, processes should be assigned to and executed at either CO or CB level to avoid un-necessary back-and-forth and confusion.

23. Corporate bureaus (including communications, partnerships, procurement and human resources) do not have the capacity to provide operational / implementation support to country offices in crisis. As confirmed by corporate bureaus and experienced by the Yemen country office upon request during the Hodeidah operation, corporate bureaus are not designed and staffed to provide operational support. Seen together with the previous findings, it seems advisable for UNDP to establish a flexible surge operations support cell to absorb temporary workload peaks in all areas for L2/L3 crises where country offices struggle to cope with the additional workload. This cell would require CB level coordination and a capacity skeleton but could be staffed virtually using colleagues based in various locations. Required nimbleness / flexibility can further be enhanced through LTAs with 3rd party providers, so as to allow the cell to grow and shrink as required.

24. Scenario planning and preparedness has to some extent been done by the Yemen country office but would benefit from corporate systematisation and support. The scenario work done during the AAR (see chapter 5) confirms that the protracted and highly volatile context in Yemen requires continuous and dedicated preparedness work – and Yemen is certainly not the only case. Solid scenario and preparedness work require capacities, tools and experience, so that country offices do not need to invest significant capacities to develop their own methodology and conduct preparedness exercises. The CB should therefore consider to further develop existing early warning tools and methods into a more operations-oriented scenario and preparedness planning approach offered to countries facing protracted or recurrent crisis.²⁷

25. Existing crisis programming packages do only partially fit transition contexts such as Hodeidah / Yemen. The currently existing packages are more geared towards supporting post-disaster settings. It needs to be recognised that protracted and post-crisis operations have always been important and in the past 5 years gained additional significance from UNDP considering both financial and operational scope. This is among others documented in the extensive study of UNDP's approach to stabilization conducted by the UNDP Crisis Response Unit (predecessor of the current Crisis Bureau) in 2016. Moreover, UNDP has in recent years set up dedicated stabilization facilities in Iraq, Libya, the Lake Chad Basin and Yemen. While some of the elements are certainly also relevant in protracted conflict and post-crisis settings, it would be useful to expand the set of existing crisis packages with (a) the stabilization approach, emerging as a new UNDP signature approach, and (b) a package specifically designed for post-conflict political transition settings.

26. Corporate external communications, and communication support, during the surge response was timid and opportunities to corporately showcase UNDP's role in Yemen missed. As emphasised by

²⁷ A good example for such support is the experimental and yet positive experience from South Caucasus where conflict and political scenario work of the humanitarian team was complemented by operational and programme preparedness measures at CO level; as well as the Pacific and Caribbean disaster preparedness exercises led by CRU/Crisis Bureau.

actors at country and corporate level during the review, the highly politicised operating environment in Yemen was not conducive to proactive communication efforts. As shown by a number of concrete examples during the surge period, external communication, especially through social media channels, can easily be misunderstood or purposefully misinterpreted. It is therefore not surprising that communication efforts both at corporate and country level appeared to be timid and cautious. As stated by one HQ-level interviewee, the risks clearly seemed to outweigh possible benefits.

The authors of the present report would like to propose a nuance to this view. The risks involved in proactively communicating UNDP's engagement in the implementation of the Stockholm agreement certainly required tact and political judgement. At the same time, UNDP's current approach limits broad international outreach and marketing efforts as a key post-conflict actor supporting communities and peace efforts in complex environments. The solution, as proposed by country office colleagues, could be the creation of an adequate professional capacity and approach, namely in the form of a headquarters-based spokesperson of the right level and ability. This function would be supported by an SOP for L3 communications and a STRATCOM & Marketing capacity.

Moreover, UNDP should consider creating a closer relationship between the corporate BERA communications office, the regional bureau communication advisor (if exists) and the country office. Depending on the CO setup and capacities, specifically trained "inner circle" communication consultants deployed in L2/L3 settings should be used to facilitate and enhance this communication triangle.

Recommendations on Corporate Implementation Support:

- R21. Establishment of a flexible surge operations support center at HQ level to absorb temporary workload peaks in all areas. [Ref. Findings 21-23]*
- R22. Clearly base operational processes supporting surge operations in either the CO or the corporate support structure to avoid process confusion and delays. [Ref. Finding 22]*
- R23. In protracted settings, introduce systematically scenario preparedness planning supported by joint RB/CB/GPN capacity. [Ref. Finding 24]*
- R24. Expand the UNDP existing crisis packages with (a) the stabilization approach and (b) a package specifically designed for post-conflict political transition settings. [Ref. Finding 25]*
- R25. Establish a STRATCOM & Marketing capacity for L3 settings (led by BERA). [Ref. Finding 26]*
- R26. Designate a dedicated HQ-based spokesperson for L3 settings, especially in politicized contexts such as Yemen. [Ref. Finding 26]*
- R27. Strengthen linkage and interaction between Surge COMS deployment and HQ COMS office (invest into Surge COMS consultants) [Ref. Finding 26]*

3.2 Country Office

Country Office Response Structure and Capacities

27. The delinking of the RC function from UNDP led to temporary confusion regarding roles in supporting the Stockholm agreement. According to key bilateral donors, it took some months to overcome this period of confusion. Moreover, discussions with stakeholders point to moments of tensions and friction regarding the distribution of roles regarding support to the Stockholm agreement and implementation coordination. Irrespective of this period of confusion and tension, however, the RC, RCO and UNDP continued a constructive and mutually supportive relationship which illustrates foresight and maturity that was beneficial to both parties in continuously supporting the broader peace agenda. The fact that UNDP is leading three out of four areas of the transition plan currently under development at the request of the RC epitomises the relationship of mutual support and benefit.

28. The surge response was guided by strong senior management vision, leading to strong positioning of the country office. While the corporate strategic support outlined in the previous chapter was crucial, much of the positioning work was performed at the country level engaging the Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary General to Yemen, different counterparts and authorities, and representatives of bilateral and multi-lateral donors. The fact that UNDP was closely involved in preparations of the Stockholm peace agreements and that it was requested to support the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreement illustrates the unusually strong positioning further documented in the report of the SG to the PSC (see annex 6.7).

29. The country office senior management, especially the UNDP RR, was directly involved and hands-on in the coordination of the surge effort, and communication between CO and the Strategic Surge Advisor was good. Arguably, more responsibility for surge coordination could have been transferred to the strategic advisor from a strategic vs. management perspective. Yet, the involvement of the RR helped to move things forward at the required pace despite an at times unclear financial picture and in a volatile context where most actions requires senior management buy-in. Compared to other country contexts where such involvement in surge operations was lacking, the Yemen senior management involvement must be seen as positive and important.

30. Country office capacities would have benefitted from dedicated operations support. As partially discussed in the above corporate section, the surge package did not include dedicated operational support, such as an operations manager for deployment in Hodeidah and a Surge HR advisor to support surge-related recruitments. Judging from the minutes of the crisis board of 21st December 2018, operational capacities and support needs were not raised and considered during the crisis board. In the course of the surge response, however, significant operational bottlenecks were encountered related to the recruitment of surge advisors through the TA modality and the issuance of various related payments, as well as in Hodeidah with regards to the implementation of various assessments required for the establishment of physical office infrastructure. Moreover, the operational workload actually remained below what could have been expected had the war parties advanced faster with the implementation of the peace agreement, notably the redeployment of troops. Operational bottlenecks would have certainly been more serious in this scenario.

Bottlenecks encountered are confirmed by the UNDP staff survey, which identifies procurement, human resources and financial management as areas encountering effectiveness issues (see figure 15). To avoid any miss-perceptions, it is important to stress that the survey result shown in figure 15 does not indicate Yemen country office operations to be less effective than country office programmes. In the view of the authors it rather indicates as described above that operational aspects including operational capacities did not receive the same attention than programmatic aspects.

Reasons for the disregard of required operational support have been discussed earlier: it might relate to a general tendency within UNDP to focus on programmatic requirements, as well as an initial tendency of country office operations colleagues to refuse help. The latter has been experienced and documented a number of times by the authors of this report. Also, the authors have not yet seen a case where a country-level response would not have benefitted from dedicated operational support. It is therefore strongly recommended to include operational support capacities by default as part of a surge response. A rapid, standardised and remote country office capacity assessment should be included into the standard crisis response procedures, based on which operational support needs will be determined and approved as per the first crisis board. This assessment could be led by BMS / MCT, in close collaboration with CB.²⁸

In the Yemen context, the deployment of capacities in Sana'a is costly. An assessment in preparation of the first crisis board should therefore also quickly established where the proposed operations support capacities are to be located: in Sana'a integrated into the main office, in Amman as part of the liaison office and linked to the RBAS regional hub, or in New York integrated into the newly proposed Crisis Bureau operational support cell (see above corporate chapter).

31. Surge deployments located in Amman due to Visa problems fell outside an adequate management structure and were therefore under-managed and under-used. It is unsurprising that the three surge advisors working out of Amman due to visa problems experienced difficulties to perform their responsibilities. From a functional perspective, it was more difficult for the Special Assistant to the Deputy Head of Mission and the Communication Advisor to fulfil their TOR, while it was easier for the Peace Support Facility Manager since his job included a series of close consultations with donors who were all based in Amman. The three deployments certainly navigated along the lines of their job descriptions and tried to be as useful as possible. It would have been beneficial for the three, however, to be formally integrated into the Amman liaison office management structure so as to benefit from day-to-day contacts, exchanges and management guidance. This would have further enhanced the level of information flow and coordination between Amman office and Hodeidah. Moreover, in the case of the Special Assistant, the job description should have been entirely revised after an initial stand-by period to ensure this capacity was better used. To some extent, this also holds true for the communications advisor who could have supported the partnership and communications work of the Liaison Office in addition to the remote tasks she was assigned by the head of communications.

32. Despite laudable efforts from CO senior management, internal communication and exchanges between middle managers is still too low and therefore limits the common understanding of an evolving strategic vision. In a decentralised country office operation that spans offices in Sana'a, Aden, Hodeidah and Amman, frequent strategic exchanges and feedback loops are critical to ensure coherent strategy -guided positioning and decision-making. This is all the more relevant since natural information flow is heavily limited by the 4-week R&R cycle and travel restrictions for some staff from the south to the north and vice-versa. Well aware of this, the country office management has consistently organised annual strategic management retreats bringing together middle managers to develop the vision and strategy for the coming year. This is a considered a best practice and needs to be recognised.

In the UNDP staff survey conducted during the AAR, only 45% of colleagues felt that “everybody in the country office knows about our vision, goals, targets with regards to Hodeidah”.²⁹ In the view of the authors, strategic exchanges involving all middle managers need to happen on a quarterly basis in a constantly evolving country context. The country office is working on upgrading the communication

²⁸ The UNDP's Management Consulting Team (MCT) has developed a standardized tool to rapidly and remotely assess country office capacities included in its Horizon Scan. This methodology could be used and adjusted to fit the present purpose.

²⁹ See survey results in annex 6.6, question 16.

equipment in the local presences for this purpose, but additional delays might be expected. For the time being, the CO senior management (RR + 2 Deputies) will therefore need to improvise and organise quarterly strategic exchanges with the middle managers in different locations. One way to do this is to conduct joint visits among the 3 senior managers to the local presences. This would also align to the intention of the country office to introduce “adaptive and conflict programme management” as per its new 2-year country programme bridging framework.

33. Technical coordination in Hodeidah in areas of relevance to UNDP has suffered from the abolishment of the Early Recovery cluster. The RC/HC abolished the Early Recovery cluster in Yemen in 2018, also informed by the recent global review.³⁰ This coordination platform led by UNDP and integrated into the humanitarian coordination and advocacy system was providing an opportunity for UNDP to define and enhance collaboration and coordination in resilience-oriented areas of its mandate, typically livelihood recovery, peacebuilding, government coordination capacity building, mine action and rule of law. In Hodeidah, the coordination gap in these 4 areas was obvious and confirmed in discussions with the members of the Regional Country Ream (RCT).

As elsewhere, some of the areas were absorbed by the Food Security and Agricultural Cluster (FSAC), but this was rather done from a perspective of immediate humanitarian interventions rather than from an early recovery perspective. Accordingly, several NGOs and UN agencies³¹ are currently conducting their own independent livelihood assessments which are – in the view of the authors of this study – insufficiently coordinated with local authorities. Moreover, IOM expressed the need for coordination in the area of rule of law, specifically capacity building of coast guards, and suggested to establish a technical coordination group in this area.

It seems recommendable for UNDP to establish a coordination group that covers the 4 above-mentioned areas and carefully guide all partners into an approach that is informed by a longer-term perspective. Based on the short exchange during the RCT meeting, this would be welcomed by agency and NGO partners. In doing so, it will be important to carefully align the groups mandate to the mandate of the FSAC in close collaboration with WFP and FAO so as to avoid un-necessary overlaps. The group should not attempt to officially link into the existing humanitarian coordination system but ensure regular exchanges. However, it should be managed and organised inspired by the positive aspects and lessons from the Early Recovery cluster, including the use of professional information management systems.

The mandate for UNDP to coordinate this group can be derived from the fact that UNDP is now leading 3 of 4 pillars of the Yemen Transition framework, notably stabilization, transitional governance and rule of law / security. It is also informed by the fact that UNDP is co-leading the HDP-NEXUS globally and in-country together with OCHA. To ensure that the group can function successfully and continuously, buy-in of and regular exchanges with the Supreme Council for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, the successor of NAMCHA, need to happen. Further, it is proposed that this group will have a pilot function and that the exact definition of the mandate and institutional linkage to the national level of this group evolves naturally over the course of the coming months.

Recommendations on Country Office Response Structure and Capacities:

R28. For future surge support, assess country office operations capacities in view of needs prior to the design of the surge package. [Ref. Finding 30]

³⁰ For the evaluation, see:

http://earlyrecovery.global/sites/default/files/evaluation_of_the_global_cluster_for_early_recovery_-_2018.pdf

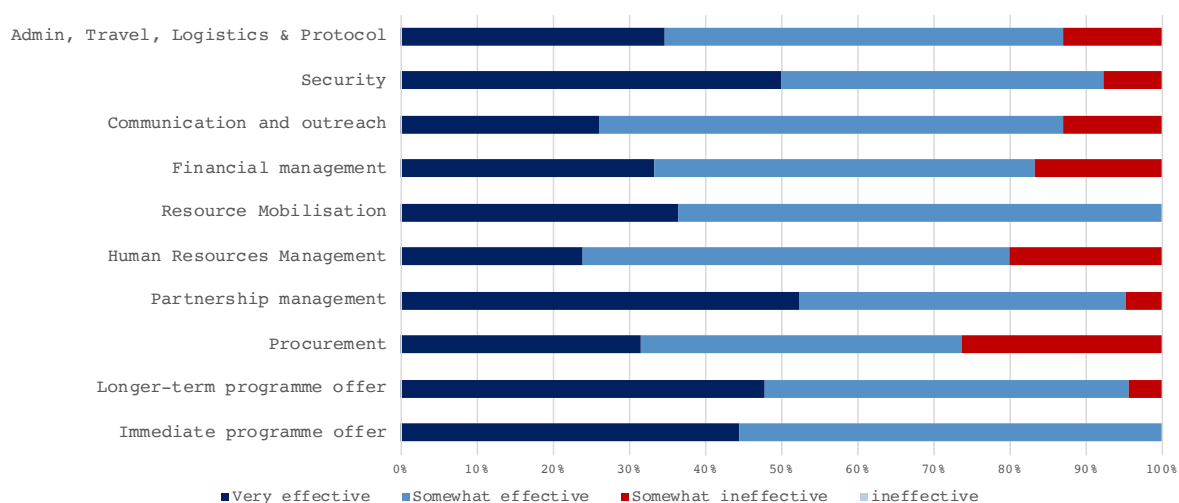
³¹ These are: ADRA, NRC, ICRC, WFP and IOM.

R29. Assign matrix management responsibility to Amman liaison office for surge staff based in Amman, and revise job descriptions as required to maximize use of these capacities. [Ref. Finding 31]

R30. Introduce regular (quarterly) feedback loop between CO middle managers (aligned with adaptive management). [Ref. Finding 32]

R31. Establish a technical coordination group in Hodeidah covering the areas of livelihood recovery, peacebuilding, government coordination capacity building and rule of law, and launch key assessments in close collaboration with SCMCHA. [Ref. Finding 33]

Figure 15: Survey Question 6 on effectiveness of response components



Sub Office and Remote Management Structure

34. The establishment of the sub office was based on a relevant business case. As per UNDP rules and regulations for the management of local presences, a business case was developed and subsequently approved by the crisis board to establish the sub office in Hodeidah. Arguably, UNDP's strong involvement today in the Yemen transition plan has been prepared by its credible support to implementing the Stockholm peace agreement in Hodeidah. As such, the relevance of the business case is anchored in UNDP's involvement in the implementation of the peace agreement and, as outlined well in the document, UNDP's local presence in Hodeidah created programmatic opportunities in Hodeidah and beyond.

35. The time span from the submission of the first draft of the business case to the crisis board (17 February) to the approval (2nd May) was unnecessarily long. Upon inquiry, it was clarified that the 2 months were used for corporate consultations and the clarification of funding arrangements. Moreover, the slow pace in Hodeidah regarding the first implementation steps of the peace agreement reduced the level of urgency. Arguably, a more rapidly strengthened presence of UNDP on the ground could have created more momentum, inter alia, in establishing UNDP's labour-intensive waste management programme. The authors therefore believe that the approval period in an L3 setting should have been significantly shorter.

36. While the establishment of the initial team went with impressive speed, the physical office is still not established due to local circumstances. Generally speaking, the setup of physical structures in high-risk environments takes time. In the Hodeidah case, additional complications in the form of changing government approval as to where UN agencies can establish their offices occurred. This complication equally impacted the establishment of offices of UNICEF, OCHA, IOM and partially WFP who similar to UNDP have rented office space and started renovations in locations for which government approval now is being reconsidered. This illustrates the general operating environment and related risks that UN agencies need to accept in such environments. Supported by the RC, UNDP and sister agencies are currently working on an acceptable agreement with local authorities to resolve the issue.

37. The modular design of the sub office structure was adequate and judicious. Weighing risks and opportunities, the business case rightly identifies required upfront investment costs and proposes a modular setup of the sub office staffing (see figure 16). This approach is was adequate and necessary. In fact, the financial sustainability of the sub office is not yet guaranteed. Sufficient Hodeidah-specific funding has not yet materialised given the resistance and slow progress of parties to the peace agreement to implement the Stockholm agreement. Recent developments, however, give some positive indications regarding the feasibility of implementing the port rehabilitation and revenue management components funded through the PSF, which would significantly contribute to SO sustainability.

38. Contractual modalities used for the sub office team are various, seemingly unsystematic and need to be harmonised. As shown in table 3, the country office has used 4 different modalities to recruit sub office staff. As much as the authors of the present report could establish the use of modalities has not been guided by clear principles and therefore creates tensions and dissatisfaction among sub office staff. The country office has received a waiver for competitive recruitment signed by the Regional Director on the 29th of December 2018 for the recruitment of 10 TAs and 20 SCs in 2019. The sub office staff should have therefore been exclusively recruited using TAs and SCs, with a clearly established principle distinguishing between the two modalities. In the current situation, the country office instead needs to undertake a time and capacity-consuming clean-up exercise, redo recruitments and / or process contract extensions. To be clear, similar situations have been observed in a number of surge settings in other countries and it is therefore of corporate urgency to establish clear guidelines regarding contractual modalities in sub office and surge settings. The guidelines should not compromise on recruitment speed and other requirements.³²

39. The financial framework of the Hodeidah sub office requires clarification. As per detailed discussions with colleagues in Sana'a, the Hodeidah sub office funding architecture is not clearly established, and expenditures charged against various budgets. Similar to the use of contract modalities, this situation is common among sub offices established in surge settings. At best, it creates a lack of clarity and at worst funding gaps that are identified (too) late. To avoid the latter scenario, the country office should rapidly clarify the sub office funding architecture and establish a dedicated sub office budget. As a general principle, sub office staff and GOE should be funded from corporate upfront investments, namely regional and crisis bureau funds, and subsequently from adequate project resources through the explicit identification of costs in relevant project budgets. A flat DPC charge is to be avoided.

40. The sub office team requires induction to UNDP and on-the-job training. As can be expected, the nascent sub office team is unfamiliar with UNDP processes and regulations. The frequent change of officers-in-charge of the sub office following the departure of the Strategic Surge Advisor did not allow

³² See the chapter on deployments for more details on contract types and chapter on the corporate response mechanism regarding the use of mainstreamed fast track procedures.

for a gradual but continuous on-the-job introduction to UNDP. The relocation or recruitment of at least one experienced UNDP officer with sufficient knowledge of UNDP and ATLAS processes and would have helped to mitigate the significant training gap that the sub office is currently experiencing. Moreover, continuous circulation of experienced staff over a period of six months from the main office could have supported staff induction and should be considered by the country office moving forward. It is also proposed that the CO should conduct a general staff induction to UNDP for sub office staff and targeted on-the-job training for business-critical functions.

Recommendations on Sub Office and Remote Management Structure:

- R32.** Clarify sub office financial architecture, including the establishment of a dedicated budget. [\[Ref. Finding 39\]](#)
- R33.** Ensure all SO staff is paid from a project budget dedicated to Hodeidah operations or from the SO budget. [\[Ref. Finding 39\]](#)
- R34.** Staff re-deployment / regular circulation from main to sub office to facilitate main office – sub office exchanges and on-the-job training of new sub office staff. [\[Ref. Finding 40\]](#)
- R35.** Clarify sub office contract modalities and realign contracts and staffing accordingly. [\[Ref. Finding 38\]](#)
- R36.** Provide training for business-critical functions at Hodeidah level [\[Ref. Finding 38\]](#)

Figure 16: Modular setup of the SO staffing structure

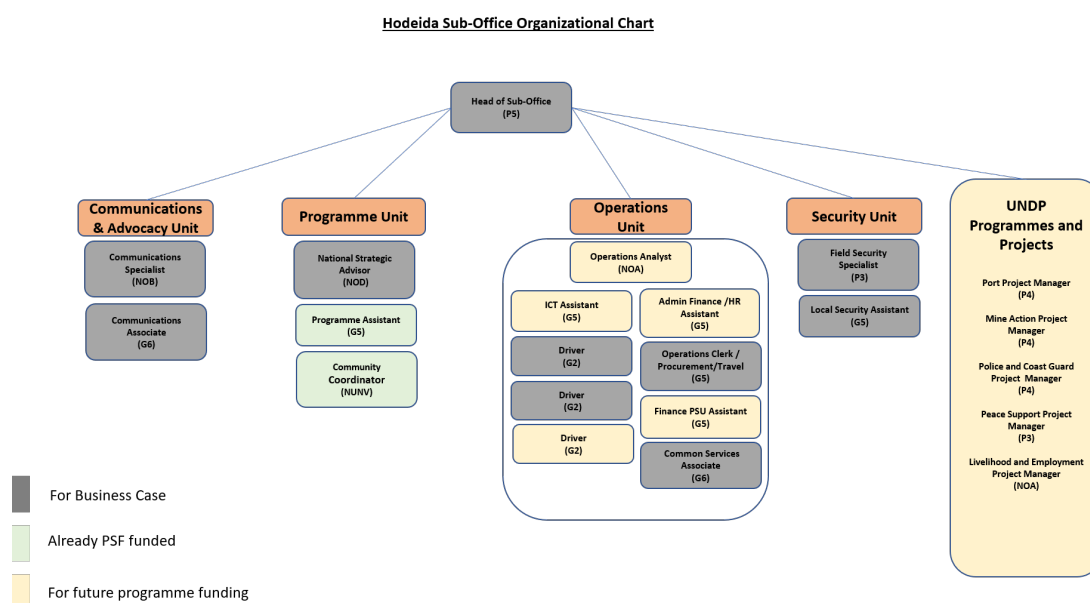


Table 3 - Overview of Current SO staff and contract modalities

Title	Contract type	Contract Expiry
Programme assistant	CTG	11-Nov-19
Office assistant	IC	15-Dec-19
Driver	TA	01-Mar-19
Project Assistant	SC	23-Sep-20
communication expert	IC	18-Nov-19
Emergency employment specialist	CTG	30-Nov-19
Mine action consultant	IC	04-Oct-19
Local Security Assistant	TA	15-Mar-20
Field Officer	CTG	30-Nov-19
Port expert	IC	18-Oct-19
Community coordinator	SC	31-Mar-20
Field Officer	CTG	30-Nov-19
Emergency nurse	SC	18-Dec-19
Driver	TA	07-Jan-20

Programmatic Response

41. The programmatic positioning of UNDP regarding 4 areas of the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreement was strategic. In addition to be of immediate relevance in the Hodeidah context, it prepared UNDP's broader positioning in the implementation of Yemen's transition plan. Due to the slow and only partial redeployment of troops, programme implementation advanced much slower than planned. Nevertheless, important milestone activities such as the assessment of the Hodeidah port and the marking of minefields in Salif and Ras Issa were implemented. The fact that UNDP moved very quickly to establish programmatic support to the implementation of the Stockholm agreement was important in this context. Given a rather unclear financial picture, the UNDP senior management took an adequate informed risk, a strategic decision that should be recognised.

42. UNDP's technical collaboration, especially in the area of Rule of Law, with OSESGY and UNMHA was appreciated. Colleagues from the office of the special representative and UNMHA were complementary and pleased with the level of collaboration in Amman, Sana'a and Hodeidah. They both explained that UNDP at times assumed a facilitator role between OSESGY and UNMHA regarding technical questions, especially the approach to establishing and training the new local security forces. In this context, the organisation of consultations regarding the future of local security forces in Hodeidah on neutral ground in Jordan, as part of UNDP's "Dead Sea RoL Consultations" was seen as very useful. In terms of partnership between OSESGY, UNMHA and UNDP, the CO is planning and should indeed further pursue this collaboration at technical level, especially in view of the broader Yemen transition planning.

43. The delay of more than 6 months UNDP encountered in contracting an identified think tank to work on aspects of the concept for local security forces was criticised by OSESGY colleagues. There is a partnership management and a procurement management aspect to this unnecessary delay. Seemingly, the delay is partially caused by insufficient communication from the outset between programme and operations colleagues. To avoid the creation of unrealistic expectations and / or delays in the future, it is recommended that programme and operations colleagues jointly agree on the operational strategy before a commitment is taken.

44. The development and implementation of a labour-intensive solid waste management project in addition to the "Stockholm programme areas" supported UNDP's visibility, recognition and reputation. The Cash-for-Work based street cleaning intervention was not originally planned as component of the Hodeidah programme. Realising, however, that the implementation of Stockholm programme components might experience serious delays and that it is important to implement programmes of

direct benefit to war-affected communities, the Strategic Surge Advisor launched the development and subsequent implementation of a labour-intensive solid waste management project. Consultations with authorities, sub office staff and agency colleagues in Hodeidah confirm that this intervention was critical in supporting UNDP's visibility and reputation in Hodeidah. The representative of NAMCHA in Hodeidah explained that it was pleasant to see how streets were suddenly cleaned up. The immediate additional income to community members was certainly much welcomed, even if UNDP experiences – as elsewhere – difficulties to ensure an exclusively principle and criteria-based selection of beneficiaries. It is recommended to expand this programme as much as funding permits and to use it as a foundation and vehicle for the launch of a broader community stabilization programme in the course of 2020.

45. The US\$ 500,000 TRAC-2 programmatic seed funding provided by the Regional Bureau for Arab states was critical to launch the solid waste initiative. It would have been nearly impossible to re-purpose available World Bank or EU for this initiative, and the decision of RBAS to provide this funding must therefore be seen as key for the successful establishment of UNDP in Hodeidah.

46. UNDP innovated in circumventing obstacles in the implementation of key programme activities. One of the most innovative aspects of UNDP's programme implementation in Hodeidah were the modalities used to bring high-level expertise from the port of Rotterdam to Hodeidah to conduct the port assessment. Obstacles encountered were (a) the difficulty to provide an adequate insurance package to experts and (b) the impossibility to run a full-fledged procurement process to source the expertise. The in the view of the authors elegant solution devised jointly by the country office and the Crisis Bureau was to establish a stand-by partner agreement with the Netherlands Enterprise Agency (NEA) through the Dutch Ministry of Foreign Affairs. This allowed UNDP to deploy the experts of the port of Rotterdam as "Experts on Mission" from a Stand-by Partner with adequate insurance coverage through the NEA and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. This solution illustrates good collaboration between CB and CO and solid partnership management with a bi-lateral donor in addition to programmatic and operational innovation.

47. There is a need and desire of main office colleagues to exchange and engage more on programmatic questions. As often the case in a decentralised structure where one programme component is surge-related and fast-paced, opportunities for fruitful programmatic exchanges between main office and sub office colleagues were limited. While understandable, it is a lost opportunity to create coherence and programmatic synergies. As a matter of experience, such exchanges will only happen if guided and required by UNDP senior management. It is therefore recommended that the newly arrived Senior Deputy Resident Representative for Programmes facilitates regular exchanges between sub office and main office. Continuously frequent travel from Senior managers and main office programme colleagues to Hodeidah would certainly be beneficial and welcome.

Recommendations on Programmatic Response:

R37. *Further strengthen technical cooperation between Office of the Special Envoy (OSESgy), UNMHA and UNDP – especially in areas of political transition (Dialogue, Constitution, SSR, Reintegration, possibly PVE). [Ref. Finding 42]*

R38. *Ensure joint up-front communication and planning between programme and operations colleagues for key programme activities. [Ref. Finding 43]*

R39. Expand CfW programme at Hodeidah level as much as possible and launch planned Waste2Energy project. Discuss and agree on approaches for Power (Electrification) and Wash at central level. [Ref. Finding 44]

R40. Increase the exchange between CO and Surge programmes, including the introduction of dedicated feedback loop sessions at programme / SO level. [Ref. Finding 47]

Operational Response

48. Operational capacities were stretched processing additional recruitment and finance cases. At the beginning of 2019, the human resource management team consisted of one G7, two G6 Associates and three HR Assistants. The finance team was composed of one G7, two G6 Associates and one G3 Finance Clerk. The HR and Finance Team are led by the NOB Operations Analyst. The two teams provided operational support to the surge deployments, mainly in the area of HR (TA recruitments) and Finance (payment of entitlements). There were relatively few procurement cases to manage for the Hodeidah programme in view of the slow Stockholm implementation.

As explained earlier, the CB New York-based team provided assistance with the TA recruitments to reduce the overall workload for the country office, and TA recruitments were processes reasonably fast.³³ Still, CO HR capacities were significantly stretched. In this context it is important to recognise the broader picture. During the first 6 months of 2019, the HR team dealt with more than 100 recruitments, including recruitments performed on behalf of other UN Agencies in Yemen. The workload of such volume put significant pressure on the HR staff and resulted in increased time for completion of the hiring process. In addition, virtual interviews were often significantly prolonged, due to unstable internet connection.

On the finance side, a number of payment processes³⁴ were significantly delayed because of process confusion (some process steps were implemented at Sana'a level, some at NY level), stretched capacities and an unclear financial architecture related to the surge operation.

Regarding procurement, during the AAR only one specific process stood out in terms of delays, namely the contracting of a think tank to conduct technical work in the area of Rule of Law together with OSESGY. A review of available Atlas data indicates that procurement activities are overall conducted with good quality (see procurement dashboard, figure 17). Out of the 675 cases processed in 2019 by the end of October, the broad majority had PO amounts below US\$ 100,000. PO amounts of 18 transactions exceeded US\$ 100,000 and totalled a financial volume of US\$ 190 million. US\$ 187 million of these were purchases for common services, and only US\$ 2.7million of transactions were related to UNDP processes. This illustrates that the procurement team is equally heavily involved in and occupied by the management of UN common processes.

In terms of approval times for POs (see table 4), while average approval times seem adequate there are 45 cases with Req-to-PO times over 120 days, and 45 cases with PO approval times above 16 days. This data points to opportunities for efficiency improvements. Regarding approval functions (see figure 17), the number of approvers per function seems adequate at first sight and compared to other country

³³ As discussed above, additional 2 weeks could have been saved if clarity on contractual modalities had been achieved immediately. With regards to opportunities to shorten the process, please see Annex 6.11.

³⁴ As part of the AAR, 2 seriously delayed processes were reviewed in detail relating to the payment of DSA to deployments.

offices. However, the 4-week R&R cycle likely impacts approval times negatively. Moreover, the number of M1 approvers as compared to the number of M2 and M3 approvers seems to be too small. Possibly, some efficiency gains can be made increasing the number of capable M1 approver. Finally, the decentralised structure is not yet reflected in the approval structure.

In light of the heavy common services workload and the already stretched capacities of the operations team, it is recommended to “outsource and cluster” as many operational transaction steps as possible (see annex 6.13 for an initial proposal). It is important to note that a number of UNDP offices including Pakistan have clustered transactional functions since over a year at GSSC level and the experience is largely positive. In addition to this recommendation, and corroborated with other findings of the AAR, a combination of business process reviews, fast-track process training and upfront joint planning between programmes and operations might help to address identified efficiency issues. Finally, for future large surge-specific operations such as a rapid build-up of Yemen’s transition programme, the CB surge operations support cell to be newly established should take full responsibility for finance, recruitment and procurement processes.

49. Country office staff, both programme and operations, does not have sufficient knowledge of available procedures in an L3 surge context and how to apply them. Partially discussed in the corporate section, there is a lack of knowledge as well as “cultural resistance” regarding the adequate use of mainstreamed fast-track procedures. Email exchanges reviewed as part of the AAR illustrate the typical divide between surge team colleagues pushing for maximum process speed within allowable procedural limits and main office operations colleagues insist on safeguards and are concerned about precedents that would compromise regular country office processes. While this divide can ultimately only be resolved through senior management guidance, targeted training and “surge preparation” of CO operations colleagues covering business-critical functions on operational fast-tracking options is recommended.

50. Existing country office business processes are not yet adapted to the increasingly decentralised structure. Important structural changes and especially increasing decentralisation always require a comprehensive review of business processes, managerial functions and approval profiles. Admittedly, such a review is a time-consuming process when done as it should in a collaborative and inclusive way. At the same time, it is an opportunity to increase process knowledge among CO colleagues and to create a common understanding when and how processes are being used, and therefore addresses possible divides between operational cultures in the office. The authors therefore believe that it is worthwhile investing in such a review, at least for surge-critical functions, including adequate delegation/expansion of approvals. It is noted, as per discussions in Sana’a, that the CO digitalization project spearheaded by the DRR/O will positively impact processes. It is therefore proposed to establish a joint planning and process map combining digitalisation steps and process review, ensuring that business-critical processes can be immediately reviewed and adjusted while advancing coherently on digitalization.

51. The low internet bandwidth poses obstacles to the effective use of communication technology in the decentralised setting. Communication between country office locations as well as virtual process management, including the transmission of larger, scanned documents is compromised by the slow and at times patchy internet connectivity. The country office is obviously well aware of this and has tried to broaden the bandwidth through the installation of additional telecommunications equipment. Obstacles related to import permissions, however, have not yet allowed to ship these items to Sana’a. In view of the ongoing decentralisation of the country office³⁵, it will be important to explore additional options to increase bandwidth in Sana’a and Aden. The support of colleagues from the Emergency

³⁵ Please refer to the newly finalized “Guidance Note for UNDP Yemen Sub-Offices and the Amman Liaison Office” for further information on the decentralized model of the Yemen CO.

Telecommunication Cluster could be helpful in this context. In the meantime, certain process steps requiring a stable internet connection such as recruitment panels for international staff should be systematically conducted in Amman – and necessary skeleton capacities created, supported by the regional hub.

52. The overall financial architecture of the country office has not yet been adapted to the decentralised structure. Specifically, and as discussed earlier, the sub offices in Aden and Hodeidah do not yet have dedicated management budgets and funding sources are not yet clearly identified and aligned. In view of plausible future scenarios (see separate scenario report) it is proposed that country office financial sustainability as well as financial contingency planning be made a priority for the first quarter of 2020.

53. Arbitrary visa approval processes have been a major obstacle to staff deployment and programme implementation. One third of the Surge Advisors to be deployed in Yemen had to work out of Amman. When asked for guidance, the representative of NAMCHA in Hodeidah recommended to systematically brief the authorities about incoming staff and missions. In his view, this should be done by a senior manager on a monthly basis both at Sana’a and Hodeidah level. While it is not certain that this approach will make a major difference, the authors believe that it is certainly worth trying. The approach might also build additional confidence and trust between UNDP and authorities regarding deployments and future plans.

54. National staff in Hodeidah is not protected against arbitrary detention by local authorities. During the AAR period 4 national sub office colleagues were arrested and detained by local authorities. This incidence illustrates that arbitrary detention and unnecessary delays at checkpoints happen frequently in the current environment and that national colleagues operating in Hodeidah have little protection from arbitrary detention. It is therefore strongly recommended to issue UNLPs for national colleagues on service contracts. WFP has successfully done so, and the same should therefore be feasible for UNDP.³⁶

Recommendations on Operational Response:

- R41. Outsource administrative/operational tasks for areas where staff presence in the CO is not required. [Ref. Finding 48]***
- R42. Targeted training / preparation of CO operations colleagues covering business-critical functions. [Ref. Finding 49]***
- R43. Carry out a business process review exercise for surge-critical functions, including adequate delegation/expansion of approvals. Consider combining the process review with process training. [Ref. Finding 50]***
- R44. Explore additional approaches to increase bandwidth in Sana’a and Aden. [Ref. Finding 51]***
- R45. Create skeleton operational capacities in Amman, and transfer process steps requiring stable internet connectivity to Amman. [Ref. Finding 51]***

³⁶ This information has been checked and confirmed by the head of WFP in Hodeidah in November 2019.

R46. Organize monthly briefings with local and national authorities on incoming staff and missions to facilitate visa approval processes. [Ref. Finding 53]

R47. Issuance of UNLPs for Service Contract Holders. [Ref. Finding 54]

R48. Comprehensive review of country office financial sustainability and staff sources of funding (staff budgeted on projects). [Ref. Finding 52]

Table 4 - Procurement, Overview of Transactions 2019 (source: Atlas)

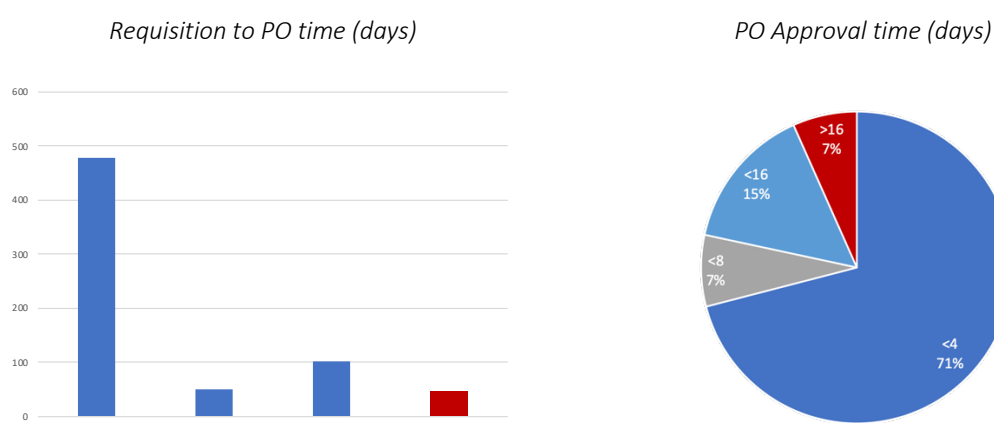


Figure 17 - Yemen Finance Profiles by Function (Source: Argus)

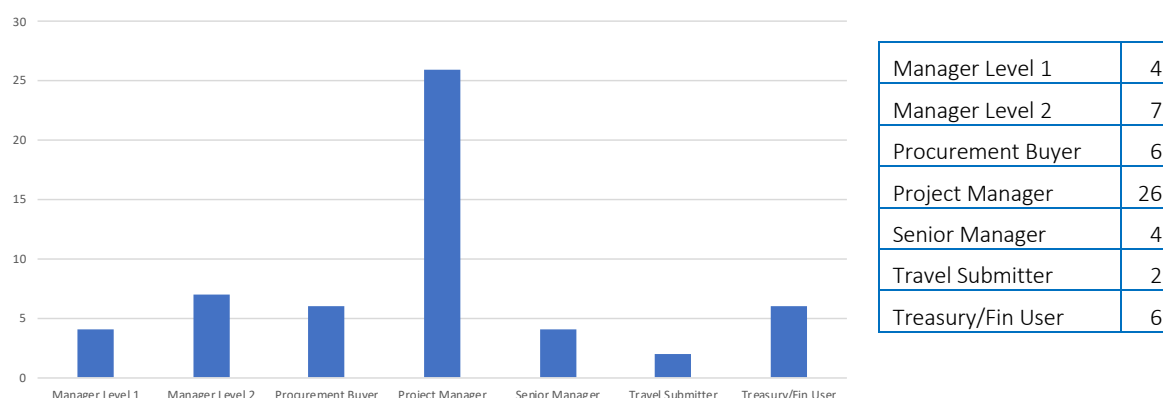


Figure 18 - Yemen Procurement Dashboard 2019 (source: Intranet)

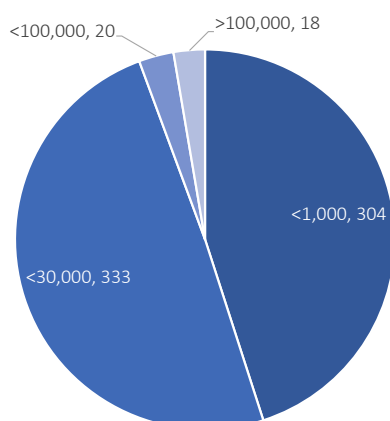
Republic of Yemen - Sana'a - Compliance

Indicator	Unit	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
NEW - # of ACP and RACP cases reviewed	Number of Cases	2	6	2	5	1	14	12
NEW - Value of ACP and RACP cases reviewed	USD	\$542,476	\$1,307,073	\$1,971,286	\$1,888,922	\$471,150	\$2,928,788	\$8,946,330
NEW - % of ACP and RACP cases approved	Percentage	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%
NEW - % of ACP and RACP cases approved on First Review	Percentage	100.00%	50.00%	100.00%	60.00%	100.00%	92.86%	100.00%
NEW - Average Quality Rating of ACP and RACP cases	Percentage	80.00%	60.00%	80.00%	60.00%	80.00%	80.00%	80.00%
NEW - # of CAP cases reviewed	Number of Cases	24	23	14	20	14	27	19
NEW - Value of CAP cases reviewed	USD	\$1,884,426	\$1,788,478	\$1,489,128	\$1,989,268	\$1,411,343	\$2,245,575	\$1,638,982

After-Action Review

UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

Figure 19: Procurement Categories by PO Amount (source: Atlas)



Communication and Resource Mobilization³⁷

55. International partners have a positive perception of UNDP in Yemen, and of UNDP's efforts in Hodeidah. This was expressed in discussions with international bi-lateral and multi-lateral donors in Amman, and also transpires from the partner survey conducted during the review. In the view of the authors of this report, this is a significant achievement given the complex and politicised context in Yemen and Hodeidah. Donors also expressed their satisfaction with the regular personal updates provided by the Strategic Surge Advisor in Amman with regards to the progress made in Hodeidah. Donors also emphasised that more information regarding the ongoing emergency-employment program would be highly welcome.

56. The resources mobilization efforts of the country office were overall successful despite a slowly advancing Hodeidah response. While the country office did not yet manage to achieve the best-case funding level outlined in the business case, the country office managed to mobilize a significant amount of funding for the Hodeidah operation. Notably, US\$ 24 million have been mobilised for the Peace Support Facility, for the time being mostly targeting Hodeidah. In addition, the country office also managed to mobilise US\$ 80 million for a newly developed broad Yemen local governance project, of which some funding will be made available to Hodeidah and its region. This "barbell" approach³⁸ to resources mobilization, i.e. parallel efforts to pursue the organization's core areas while at the same time exploring and opening up new areas of which some might succeed and others might not, is recommendable, especially in view of the plausible scenarios for 2020/21 (see separate scenario report). While the country office should as much as possible build up PSF and / or transition funding, it should also continuously invest into additional areas so as to minimise as much as possible financial sustainability bottlenecks in the event of failure of the transition process.

57. Hodeidah is a highly politicised context that requires a careful and guided approach to communication. Several communications-related incidents have illustrated that the Yemen context is highly politicised and that UNDP's communication efforts therefore need to be strategy-based and guided. In other words, official communications from the country office cannot be as free and decentralised as in other country contexts. Currently, the country office head of communications spends an immense amount of time reviewing, sanitising and quality-assuring communication

³⁷ Please also refer to the observations and recommendations provided by the communications consultant deployed to Yemen as part of the surge package, shared with the AAR team and captured in annex 6.14.

³⁸ Term and concept borrowed from Nassim Nicholas Taleb, explained in his book "Antifragile".

products. This by definition reduces the amount of time available for strategic thinking, guidance and training.

58. The country office does not yet have a communications strategy and protocol for Hodeidah. A strategy and protocol if well done can help guide Hodeidah-based colleagues and therefore free up time for the head of communications for more strategic work. Given the sensitive local context, it is also recommended to base an experienced international staff focussing on communications in Hodeidah. The attempt of the country office to do so has failed due to a de-facto visa refusal for a communications specialist for Hodeidah. It seems that this refusal might also be related to the position title and job description including elements of journalism and information gathering. Accordingly, UNDP should consider using the title of programme specialist in Hodeidah to cover communication-related tasks.

59. The local perception of the United Nations, and by extension UNDP, is negative. Both in Sana'a and Hodeidah, national UNDP colleagues are exposed to heavy criticism of the national population. During the review, daily demonstrations against the UN took place in Sana'a, and Hodeidah colleagues explained that the local population is misinformed about the rationale and activities of the UN. It is therefore recommended that UNDP establishes a partnership with local journalists and media outlets and, recognizing the overall politicised environment, systematically provides information about activities targeting and benefiting the local population. In Hodeidah, the emergency employment programme represents a good basis for such communication efforts. Additional communication actions targeting the local population should also be considered.

60. UNDP Yemen has an excellent basis of information and data that should be systematically used for fact-based communication. The studies carried out by the country office on the cost of conflict in Yemen are an excellent example of strong information and data that UNDP owns and should use more systematically for communication purposes. Beyond high-level communication events such as the launch of these studies, the information could be used for regular, small communication pieces targeting the population in Yemen and the regular international person interested in development and conflict issues. Risks obviously need to be managed, ensuring that these pieces are "a-political" in the sense that they predominantly concentrate on the situation of the population.

Recommendations on Resources Mobilisation and Communication:

R49. *Develop, implement and monitor a SO communication strategy (linking into CO strategy). [Ref. Finding 57 - 58]*

R50. *Launch a dedicated "apolitical" communication campaign in Hodeidah targeting communities and grand population. [Ref. Finding 59]*

R51. *Train SO project staff on key communication functions related to gathering of pictures, footage and data. [Ref. Finding 57-59]*

R52. *Use assessment data to shape quality public information and public interest products (Humans of Hodeidah ...). [Ref. Finding 60]*

R53. *Build relationships with key Yemeni media outlets and journalists, in collaboration with authorities. [Ref. Finding 60]*



4 Prioritizing Recommendations

It is unrealistic to expect that all the above 53 recommendations will be diligently and successfully implemented. Limited capacities and resources will require prioritization.

It is also recognised that the above-proposed recommendations have different levels of impact, urgency, feasibility and costs. These four interconnected elements will typically be considered in deciding on priorities and - by extension – on which recommendations will be implemented and which will be shelved.

The risk of considering feasibility and resources implication as part of the initial decision-making is that critical recommendations might be discarded without further discussion simply because there is a sense that they are not implementable for “political reasons” or that in the current restrictive resource environment required funding cannot be allocated. Much rather, decision-making should be guided by UNDP’s vision for the future and a strategic discussion between UNDP senior managers.

This report thus proposes a prioritization that is predominantly based on the consideration of (1) the possible impact and (2) the urgency of each recommendation. **Impact** is defined as the degree to which the implementation of the recommendation will strengthen UNDPs crisis response worldwide, for corporate recommendations, and the degree to which the implementation will strengthen UNDPs current and future response in Yemen, for CO recommendations. **Urgency** is defined as the degree to which the recommendation needs to be implemented immediately to have the required impact and / or to prevent risks associated with not implementing the recommendation.

This methodology can inform corporate and CO work plans. Important and urgent recommendations would be implemented immediately, important but less urgent recommendations during the following 6 months; and recommendations with lower levels of importance and urgency should be assessed regarding their costs and feasibility and possibly de-prioritized (see figure 20).

Feasibility and costs have been used to identify “low-hanging fruits”, i.e. recommendations that can be easily implemented and do not have a significant cost while promising a reasonable level of impact. **Feasibility** is defined as the degree to which the implementation of a recommendation does or does not require complex technical work and lengthy coordination processes. **Costs** were assessed as implementable without an additional allocation of resources (rated as 1), with a modest allocation of additional resources (rated as 2), and with a significant allocation of additional resources (rated as 3).

Based on this methodology, the 53 AAR recommendations have been ranked by their level of priority. Below figure 21 provides an overview of the resulting distribution of recommendations over priority levels.

The following **top priority recommendations** were identified and are proposed for **immediate implementation** (first 3 months):

Level	No	Recommendation	Lead
Corporate	6	Introduce default rapid CO capacity assessment methodology as standing practice (supported by BMS).	BMS
	11	Introduce the “3+6 surge” mechanism (surge, transition, institutionalization).	CB
	13	Include a security specialist by default in all L3 post-conflict surge responses and ensure the entire period of covered.	CB
	16	Establish a dedicated contract modality for L3 (insurance coverage, LP, staff status, reasonable pro-forma costs, fast-track recruitment).	BMS
	17	Negotiate an adequate insurance package to be offered of ICs to be deployed in high-risk environments.	BMS
	21	Establishment of a flexible surge operations support center at HQ level to absorb temporary workload peaks in all areas.	CB

	26	Designate a dedicated HQ-based spokesperson for L3 settings, especially in politicized contexts such as Yemen.	BERA
Country Office	29	Assign matrix management responsibility to Amman liaison office for surge staff based in Amman, and revise job descriptions as required to maximize use of these capacities.	CO
	32	Clarify sub office financial architecture, including the establishment of a dedicated budget.	CO
	35	Clarify sub office contract modalities and realign contracts and staffing accordingly.	CO
	36	Provide training for business-critical functions at Hodeidah level.	CO
	42	Targeted training / preparation of CO operations colleagues covering business-critical functions.	CO
	44	Explore additional approaches to increase bandwidth in Sana'a and Aden.	CO

The following recommendations with high impact, but a lesser degree of urgency, are proposed for **subsequent implementation** (subsequent 6 – 12 months):

Level	No	Recommendation	Lead
Corporate	2	Establish a corporate support mechanism to country offices in performing a coordination function in post-conflict contexts focusing on the areas of peacebuilding, rule of law, livelihood recovery, and government coordination capacities.	CB
	7	Introduce a crisis management qualification for UNDP operations staff.	BMS
	8	Revamp and include crisis operations training into the DRR introduction (both at regional and corporate level).	BMS
	12	For sub office establishment / surge responses in complex settings, establish and train rapid response teams (including OM and Construction Engineer).	CB
	14	Introduce a revolving fund with XB/GMS reimbursement scheme serving L2 and L3 crises, especially start-up funding for sub offices.	BMS
	23	In protracted settings, introduce systematically scenario preparedness planning supported by joint RB/CB/GPN capacity.	CB
Country Office	31	Establish a technical coordination group in Hodeidah covering the areas of livelihood recovery, peacebuilding, government coordination capacity building and rule of law, and launch key assessments in close collaboration with SCMCHA.	CO
	33	Ensure all SO staff is paid from a project budget dedicated to Hodeidah operations or from the SO budget.	CO
	34	Staff re-deployment / regular circulation from main to sub office to facilitate main office – sub office exchanges and on-the-job training of new sub office staff.	CO
	41	Outsource administrative/operational tasks for areas where staff presence in the CO is not required.	CO
	46	Organize monthly briefings with local and national authorities on incoming staff and missions to facilitate visa approval processes.	CO
	47	Issuance of UNLPs for Service Contract Holders.	BMS
	49	Develop, implement and monitor a SO communication strategy (linking into CO strategy).	CO
	50	Launch a dedicated “apolitical” communication campaign in Hodeidah targeting communities and grand population.	CO

In addition, the following recommendations are proposed to be implemented together with the above recommendations since they are highly feasible, promise good impact and have only limited resource implications. These are the “**low-hanging fruits**”:

Level	No	Recommendation	Lead
Corporate	1	Invest further into, and enhance collaboration between UNDP, DPPA/DPO and possibly IFIs aiming at formally defining UNDP’s institutional role in post-conflict settings (start-up support, technical advice and implementation support, key deployments).	CB
	3	Further encourage and mainstream the close technical collaboration and communication between CB and RB, using annual work plans, performance discussions and PMDs.	CB

	5	Introduce a corporate L3 follow-up and support mechanism.	CB
	10	CB to engage with OAI to support the creating of an audit approach that reviews the use of procedures during surge settings.	CB
	22	Clearly base operational processes supporting surge operations in either the CO or the corporate support structure to avoid process confusion and delays.	CB
	27	Strengthen linkage and interaction between Surge COMS deployment and HQ COMS office (invest into Surge COMS consultants).	BERA
Country Office	37	Further strengthen technical cooperation between Office of the Special Envoy (OESGY), UNMHA and UNDP – especially in areas of political transition (Dialogue, Constitution, SSR, Reintegration, possibly PVE).	CO
	38	Ensure joint up-front communication and planning between programme and operations colleagues for key programme activities.	CO
	48	Comprehensive review of country office financial sustainability and staff sources of funding (staff budgeted on projects).	CO
	52	Use assessment data to shape quality public information and public interest products (Humans of Hodeidah ...).	CO

It is proposed that the **remaining recommendations** should be considered and discussed at corporate and country office level, respectively, in order to establish their costs and benefits.

Level	No.	Recommendation	Lead
Corporate	4	Clarify role of corporate bureaus and align resources accordingly.	EXO
	9	Include the review of use of mainstreamed crisis procedures during an L1-L3 crisis into UNDP country office audits. In case procedures were not used, the audit should formulate a negative audit finding.	BMS
	15	Mainstream the “careful selection practice” for L2/L3 and ensure CB has adequate capacities to perform this task.	CB
	18	Ensure LPs are fast-tracked and delivered before / at EOD (validity can be restricted to 6 months).	BMS
	19	Introduce systematic mission briefing & debriefing, and establish required capacities.	CB
	20	Introduce a standard procedure for regular well-being counselling (Rome Institute).	CB
	24	Expand the UNDP existing crisis packages with (a) the stabilization approach and (b) a package specifically designed for post-conflict political transition settings.	CB
	25	Establish a STRATCOM & Marketing capacity for L3 settings (led by BERA).	BERA
Country Office	28	For future surge support, assess country office operations capacities in view of needs prior to the design of the surge package.	BMS
	30	Introduce regular (quarterly) feedback loop between CO middle managers (aligned with adaptive management).	CO
	39	Expand CfW programme at Hodeidah level as much as possible and launch planned Waste2Energy project. Discuss and agree on approaches for Power (Electrification) and Wash at central level.	CO
	40	Increase the exchange between CO and Surge programmes, including the introduction of dedicated feedback loop sessions at programme / SO level.	CO
	43	Carry out a business process review exercise for surge-critical functions, including adequate delegation/expansion of approvals. Consider combining the process review with process training.	CO
	45	Create skeleton operational capacities in Amman, and transfer process steps requiring stable internet connectivity to Amman.	CO
	51	Train SO project staff on key communication functions related to gathering of pictures, footage and data.	CO
	53	Build relationships with key Yemeni media outlets and journalists, in collaboration with authorities.	CO

For the full set of assessed and rated recommendations based on the above described methodology, please refer to annex 6.15.

Figure 20 - Approach used to assess and prioritize recommendations

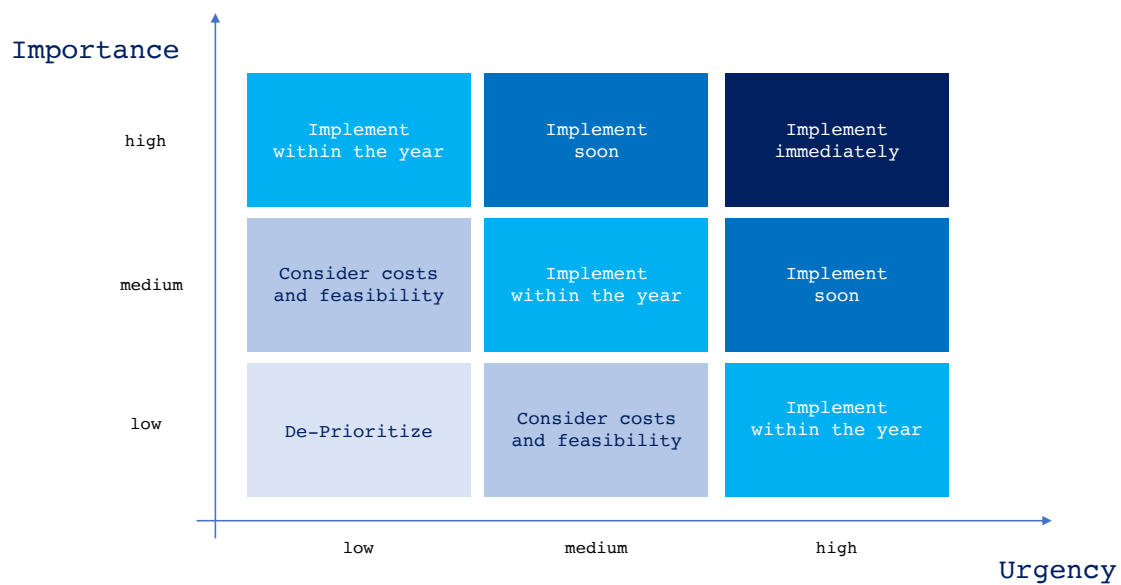
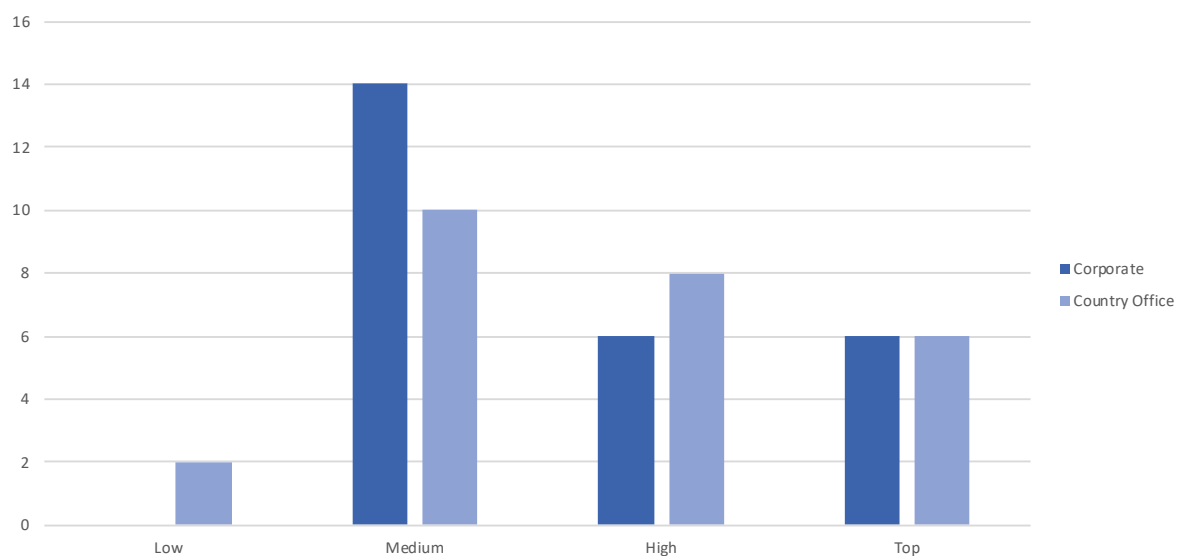


Figure 21 - Distribution of AAR recommendations by priority





5.1 AAR Programme

New York & Amman

			UNDP	Mission Team	External
7 – 14 th Oct Document Review, Surveys, Interviews, Mission Preparations	15 Oct: Travel to New York	16 Oct	8.00 – 10.00 CB Mission Briefing	9.30 – 11.30 Focus Group on Contractual Modalities	10.00 – 11.00 Yemen mission Planning
			10.00 – 11.00 BMS Procurement	12.00 – 13.00 Security Office	10.00 – 11.00 BERA Partnership Group
			11.00 – 13.00 UN DPPA / DPO	Lunch	Results consolidation
			Lunch	14.00 – 15.00 Communications	13.00 – 14.30 Lunch / Crisis Preparedness
			15.00 – 16.00 BMS Human Resources	15.00 – 17.00 Focus Group on Cross-Bureau Collaboration	14.30 – 16.00 CB Deputy Director
			16.30 – 18.00 CB Deployments		16.00 – 17.30 RBAS Deputy Director
		17 Oct			
		18 Oct			
21 – 24 th Oct SSAFE training	19 th and 20 th Oct: Travel to Amman	27 Nov	10.00 – 11.30 Donor Round Table	11.30 – 13.00 Office of Special Envoy	
			Lunch		
			14.30 – 16.00 Head of UNDP Regional Hub		
			16.00 – 18.00 Day Debrief		
25 / 26 th Oct: Mission Preparation and Planning	28 Oct Nov: Travel to Sana'a				

Sana'a & Hodeidah

29 Oct	30 Oct	31 Oct	31 Oct	3 Nov	4 Nov
8.30 – 13.00 Management Retreat	8.30 – 10.30 Management Retreat	09.00 – 12.30 AAR and Scenario Planning with CO Senior & Middle Managers	9.00 – 13.00 Preparedness and Business Continuity Planning	8.00 – 9.00 Head of Sub Office a.i.	28 Oct
	11.00 – 13.00 Programme Team			9.00 – 11.00 SO Staff Meeting	10.00 – 11.30 NAMCHA
				12.00 – 13.30 Regional Country Team	12.00 – 13.00 Preparations for PM
Lunch	Lunch	Lunch in Old City	Lunch	Lunch	Lunch
14.00 – 15.30 Operations Team	14.00 – 16.30 Results Consolidation		15.00 – 16.00 Resident Coordinator	14.30 – 16.00 UNMHA	14.00 – 16.00 Scenario Planning with SO team
15.30 – 16.30 OSEGY Sana'a		15.00 – 18.00 Results Consolidation	16.00 – 18.00 Results Consolidation	16.00 – 18.00 Day Debrief and Consolidation	16.00 – 18.00 Day Debrief
16.30 – 18.00 Day Debrief & Planning	16.30 – 18.00 Debrief RR & SM				

After-Action Review

UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

5.2 Interviews and group sessions conducted

Individual Discussions and Interviews

Name	Organization & Title
A. Heather Coyne	Senior Security Sector Reform Officer Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen
Abdullah Al-Ahdel	Deputy Head, National Authority for the Management and Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs in Hodeidah
Abraham De Beer	Security Specialist, UNDP Yemen
Abubaker Siddique	Head of Office, WFP Hodeidah
Adam Cathro	Communications Specialist, Office of Communications, Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Adenike Akoh	Procurement Specialist, Strategy and Policy, Corporate Procurement Office, Bureau for Management Services, United Nations Development Programme
Alberto Nata	Stabilization Specialist and Surge Advisor deployed to UNDP Hodeidah, UNDP Yemen
Ana Kantor	Security Sector Reform Officer, Office of the Special Envoy of the UN Secretary General to Yemen, Amman
Anjali Kwatra	Manager, Media & Advocacy, Office of Communications, Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Anne Dalitz	Programme Analyst, Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), United Nations Development Programme
Ashraf Abdelmoneim Ali	Programme Management Specialist, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Asmaa Shalabi	Head of Amman Liaison Office, UNDP Yemen
Auke Lootsma	Resident Representative, UNDP in Yemen
Aurelie Boukoubza	Programme Specialist (Arab States), Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Ayman Makki	Officer in Charge, Office of the Special Envoy of the UN Secretary General to Yemen, Sana'a
Bettina Woll	Chief of Staff, Joint Directorate, CB / BPPS
Brittany Gleixner-Hayat	Senior Stabilization Advisor & Donor Outreach Specialist, United States Agency for International Development in Yemen.
Bruno Lemarquis	Deputy Director, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Carola Mueller Holtkemper	Ambassador of the Federal Republic of Germany to the Republic of Yemen
Carolyn Williams-Gerdes	Independent Communications Consultant, and Surge Advisor deployed to Amman
Céline Degen	Head of Office, ICRC in Hodeida
Cris Stephen	Senior Political Affairs Officer, United Nations Departments of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Peace Operations (DPPA/DPO)
David Akopyan	Senior Advisor, Regional Bureau for Arab States, United Nations Development Programme
Dennis Curry	Stabilization Facility Expert and Surge Advisor deployed to UNDP Yemen
Dylan Lowthian	Communications Specialist, Office of Communications, Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Fabrizio Andreuzi	Programme Specialist (Surge Systems), Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Francis Butichi	Officer in Charge, UNICEF office in HODEIDAH
Hari Kafle	Procurement Specialist, UNDP Yemen
Hazem Aljunde	Head of Al Hudaydah Sub Office, United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA), Yemen
Isaac OOKO	Head of Office, NRC in Hodeidah

Jaap van der Zeeuw	Deputy Head of Mission, Embassy of the Netherlands to the Republic of Yemen
Jan-Jilles van der Hoeven	Independent Consultant, and former Senior Deputy Resident Representative of UNDP in Afghanistan
Jan-Thomas Hiemstra	Chief, Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Jens Toyberg-Frandzen	Senior Surge Advisor deployed as Deputy Head of UN Mission to Hodeidah (UNMHA)
Kate Brandli	Coordination Officer, Office of the Special Envoy of the UN Secretary General to Yemen, Amman
Leanne Rios	Team Lead, Communications and Advocacy, UNDP Yemen
Lesley Wright	Communications Consultant, Office of Communications, Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Liping Yang	Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Lisa Lange	Management Specialist, Management Consulting Team, Directorate, Bureau for Management Services, United Nations Development Programme
Lise Grande	Humanitarian and Resident Coordinator of the United Nations in Yemen
Luc Vandamme	Director, Security Office, Bureau for Management Services, United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
Majed Yagout	Special Assistant to the RR, and Programme Analyst, RoL, UNDP Yemen
Margaret Cameron	Human Resources Advisor, Office of Human Resources, Bureau for Management Services, United Nations Development Programme
Maysa Khalil	Head of Office, IOM in Hodeida
Melanie Hauenstein	Regional Advisor, Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), United Nations Development Programme
Mohammad Al-Batayneh	Results-based Management and Evaluation Specialist, Regional Hub of Arab States in Amman, UNDP
Nahid Hussein	Senior Deputy Resident Representative for Programme, UNDP Yemen
Nan Oo Kyi	Programme and Administrative Associate, Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Natasha van Rijn	Team Leader for Peace Support Operations and Head of Sub Office a.i. in Hodeidah, UNDP Yemen
Nesreen Al-Hebshi	Nesreen Al-Hebshi, Management Specialist (BCM and ERM), Bureau for Management Services, United Nations Development Programme
Nick Hartman	Director, Partnerships Group (PG), Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Nicoleta Dimitriu	Crisis Response Consultant, Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Ola Karakra	Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Peter Liskola	Security Sector Reform Specialist to UNDP and OSESGY, Amman
Rashid Mogga	Resources Management Specialist, UNDP Yemen
Rebecca Reynolds	Deputy Team Leader, Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Rima Al-Hassani	Regional Specialist, Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), United Nations Development Programme
Sabine Friedrichs	Partnership Analyst, Partnerships Group (PG), Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), United Nations Development Programme
Safaa Ali	Senior Deputy Resident Representative for Operations, UNDP Yemen
Salma Elhagyoussif	Head of Sub Office in Amman, UNDP Yemen
Samar Bustanji	HR Associate, UNDP Yemen
Sarah Poole	Deputy Director, Regional Bureau for Arab States
Saumik De	Recovery Specialist, Country Support Management Team, Crisis Bureau, Global Policy Network, United Nations Development Programme
Sergelen Dambadarjaa	Advisor, Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), United Nations Development Programme

Silke von Brockhausen	Coordination and Political Affairs Officer, United Nations Mission in support of the Hudaydah Agreement (UNMHA), Hodeidah
Stean Tshiband	Early Recovery Advisor, UNDP Yemen
Surayo Buzurukova	Team Leader, Rule of Law, UNDP Yemen
Susanne Dam-Hansen	Manager of UNDP Regional Hub in Amman a.i.
Tareq Gholasi	Operations Analyst, UNDP Yemen
Theodore Murphy	Regional Communications Specialist, Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), United Nations Development Programme
Won Hyuk Im	Police Advisor to UNDP and OSESGY, Amman
Yoonie Kim	Political Affairs Officer, Middle East Division, United Nations Departments of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Peace Operations (DPPA/DPO)

Group Sessions

Title	Description of Participants	Location
Focus Group Discussion on Contractual Modalities	NY-based representatives of Procurement office, HR office, Crisis Bureau, Regional Bureau for Arab states and BMS coordination.	New York
RACI exercise on surge-related functions and roles	Members of the Crisis Management Support Team (CMST)	New York
Facilitated After-Action Review Brainstorming	Country Office Senior and Middle Managers	Sana'a
Scenario Planning Exercise	Country Office Senior and Middle Managers	Sana'a
Facilitated After-Action Review Brainstorming	All sub office staff	Hodeidah
Scenario Planning Exercise	All sub office staff	Hodeidah
AAR mission debrief	Representatives of CB, BMS, RBAS and BERA	New York

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UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

5.3 List of reference documents

Please note that documents and sources mentioned and referenced in the AAR main text are not mentioned again in the below list.

- Damage and Capacity Assessment, Ports of Hodeidah, Salif and Ras Issa, Port of Rotterdam, June 2019.
- UNDP Project Document, Peace Support Facility.
- After Action Review of UNDP's Response to the Yemen Crisis (August 2015 – March 2016).
- Business Case for the Establishment of a UNDP Sub Office in Al Hodeidah, Yemen.
- UNDP Crisis Board Meeting Minutes for the meetings of 31 October 2018, 21 December 2018, and 2 May 2019.
- UNDP Yemen Country Programming Framework, July 2019 – June 2021.
- UNDP Yemen in Hodeidah, Brochure.
- UNDP Hodeidah Sub Programme Overview.
- Guidance Note for UNDP Yemen Sub-Offices and the Amman Liaison Office, 2019.
- Meeting Minutes, Strategic Dialogue on International Peace Support for Yemen, Federal Foreign Office Berlin, Germany
- UNDP Standard Operating Procedure for Immediate Crisis Response.
- Terms of Reference, Interagency Planning and Implementation Support Group for Stockholm Agreements (Yemen)
- Proposal for the United Nations support to the implementation of the Stockholm Agreement on Hudaydah of 31 December 2018
- Terms of Reference for the Surge Advisors deployed to the Yemen Country Office as part of the Surge response from Jan – June 2019.

5.4 Analytical Framework

The analytical framework used for the AAR includes the areas identified in the terms of reference and aligns these with the categories used in the CB classification of recommendations from After-Action Reviews (see CB database of AAR recommendations). The framework distinguishes between the corporate response level, and the country office response level. This distinction is made based on core responsibilities for respective areas and elements to be considered.

At corporate level:

TOR	Area (as per CB categories)	Key aspects to be assessed
Corporate Response Level		
Strategy & Leadership	Corporate Response Strategy	- Overall corporate value proposition in crisis, and its relevance in Yemen - Provision of overall vision and guidance for Hodeidah response - Corporate prioritization and decision-making for a level 3 crisis and in addressing Yemen requirements - Strategic corporate partnerships supporting crisis response, and their relevance in Hodeidah - Corporate senior-level engagement in critical internal and external communication - Corporate support to overcome implementation bottlenecks - Risk-informed approach as integrator in clarifying the roles and responsibilities with regards to the peace agreement
	Corporate Response Mechanisms	- Response Oversight & Management - Relevance and use of Crisis Response Packages - Effectiveness of mainstreamed fast track procedures - Availability and use of funding / investment support - Preparedness (procurement, deployments, funding) - Application of the UNDP Crisis Response SOPs (compliance) in Yemen - Distribution of responsibilities and interaction at corporate level: CB, RBAS, BMS, BERA - Distribution of responsibilities and interaction between HQ and CO - Coordination of corporate support to CO - Adequacy of selected profiles to operate in crisis environment - Preparation of deployments for crisis environment - Support to well-being of individual deployments during deployment - Support to team building and dynamics of surge team during deployment - Facilitation of CO team – Surge team dynamics during response including collaboration with and ownership from CO staff (national and international)
Deployments	Deployments	- Availability of crisis-related expertise to support the Yemen response (external, internal): quality, speed, performance - Adequacy of contractual modalities - Use and relevance of the Express roster - Use and Effectiveness of stand-by partners - Transfer of knowledge for post-surge period
[new] Corporate Support	[new] HQ Implementation Support in a level 3 context (Yemen)	- HQ support to CO crisis programming - HQ support to CO crisis operations management - HQ support to RM and Communications - Existing and potential new support to CO beyond 6-month crisis package (especially to former L3)

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UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

At country-office level:

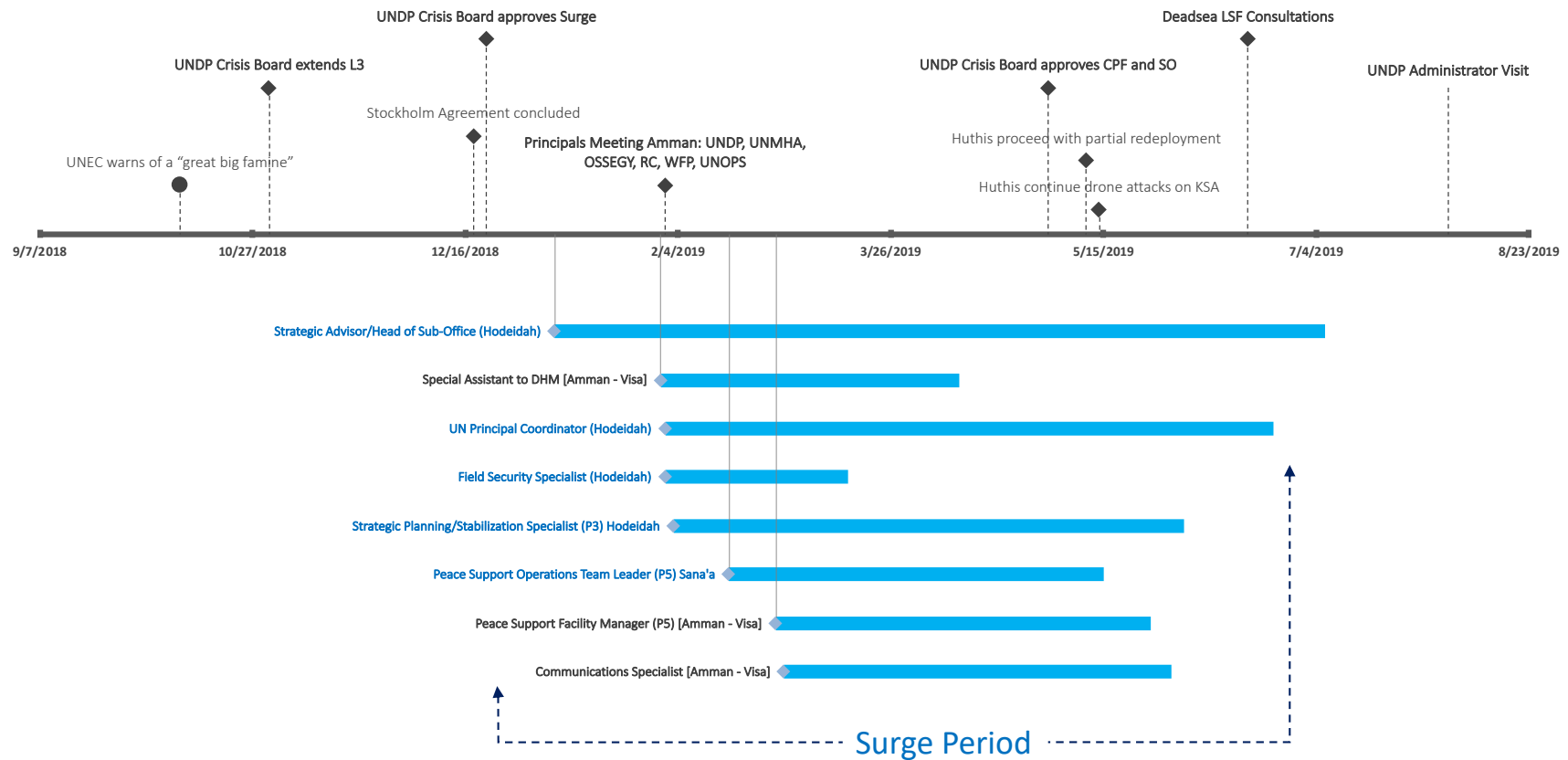
<i>TOR</i>	<i>Area (as per CB categories)</i>	<i>Key aspects to be assessed</i>
CO Response Level		
Country-level response mgmt	Local Crisis Coordination	- UNDP's support to: - UN coordination (especially following de-linking) - ER / Nexus coordination - Donor coordination - Developing Government Crisis coordination capacities
	Country Office Response Structure and Capacities	- Senior management vision and guidance, and CO Strategic positioning - Use and re-direction of existing programme and Funding streams - Pre-crisis Programme and Operational capacities - Use and relevance of a Rapid CO Capacity Assessment - Additional workload implied for the Country Office - Management & leadership structure of crisis response - Conduciveness of environment for development of innovative solutions for crisis response implementation - Programme , Operations and Partnership Innovations
	[new] Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	- Relevance of the business case - Effectiveness of the sub office, as compared to business case targets - SO-CO relationship and interaction (Programme, Operations, Communication, Representation) - Cross-unit collaboration (COMS-PROG-M&E, PROG-COM-RM, COORD-COM-RM, Partnerships-OPS, PROG-OPS) - SO structure and management
Programme	Programmatic Response	- Programmatic positioning strategy and offer - Programmatic partnerships - Level and type/modality of funding made available through CO / HQ (incl. revolving fund) - Results achievement - Programmatic sustainability (continuous relevance, funding) - Immediate support to Stockholm Agreement (quality and speed of technical and operational support)
Operations	Operational Response	- Procurement - Resources management - Operational Partnerships - Financial and Cash management - Recruitments / sourcing of talent and expertise, and efficient processing of recruitments - Security: mechanism and processes used for deployments in the highly insecure environment
Communication & RM	Communication	- Communication strategy - Communication Products - Outreach and media / external presence, and platforms, vehicles, channels used - Coordination between CO regular communication function and crisis coordination - Internal communication of vision, goals, targets and facilitation of cross-unit communication
	Partnerships and Resource Mobilization	- RM strategy, approach and outreach (products, platforms, channels used) - RM partnerships - RM results – level of mobilization overall and against target - National and international partner's perception to the UNDP response

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UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

5.5 Detailed timeline of the surge response

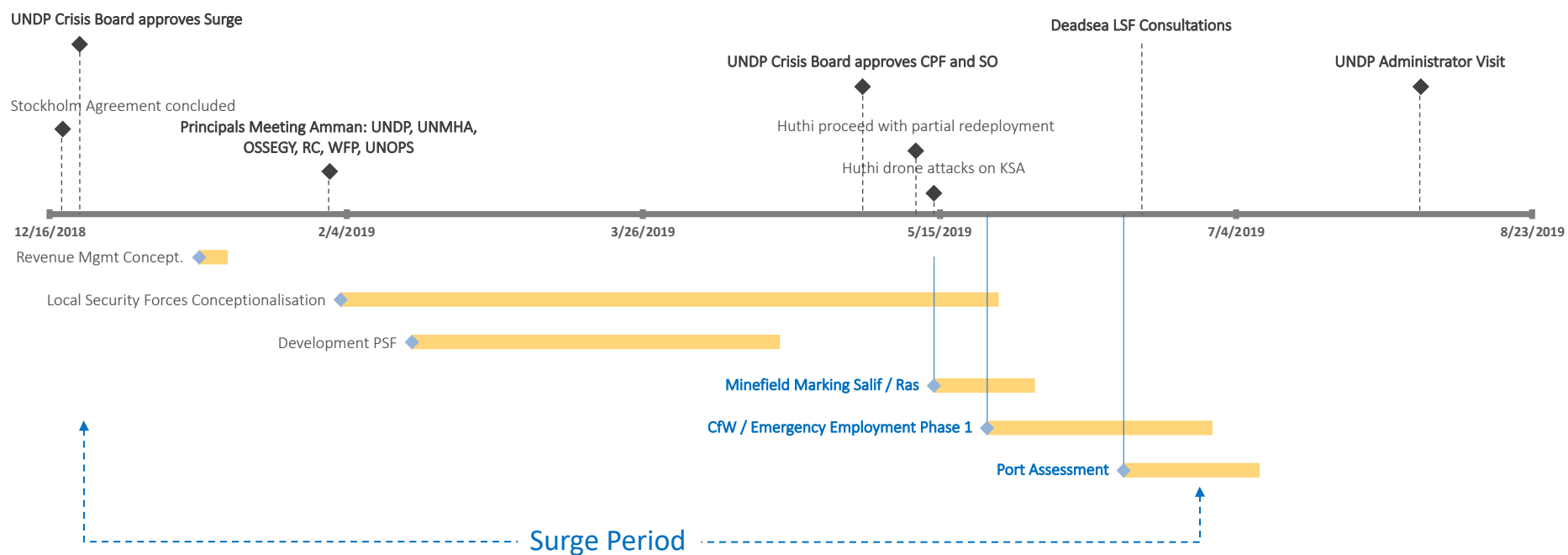
Surge deployments



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Surge-supported programme interventions



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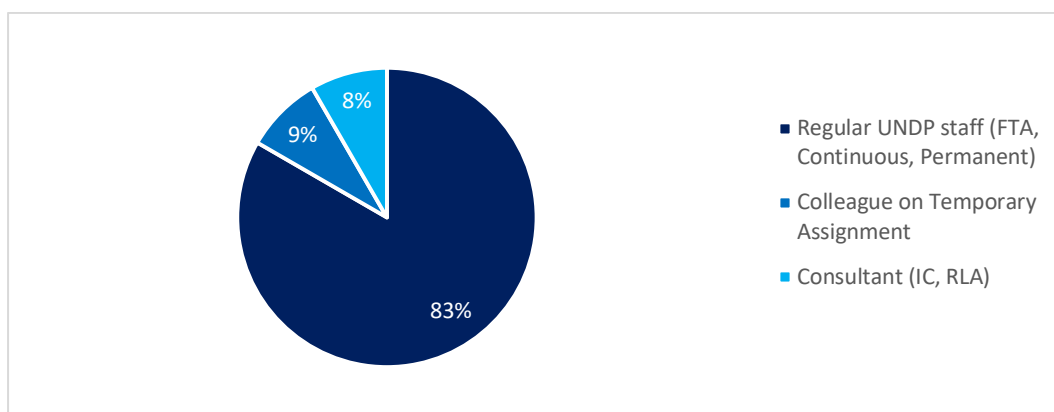
5.6 Survey Results

UNDP Staff Survey

Total Responses: 36

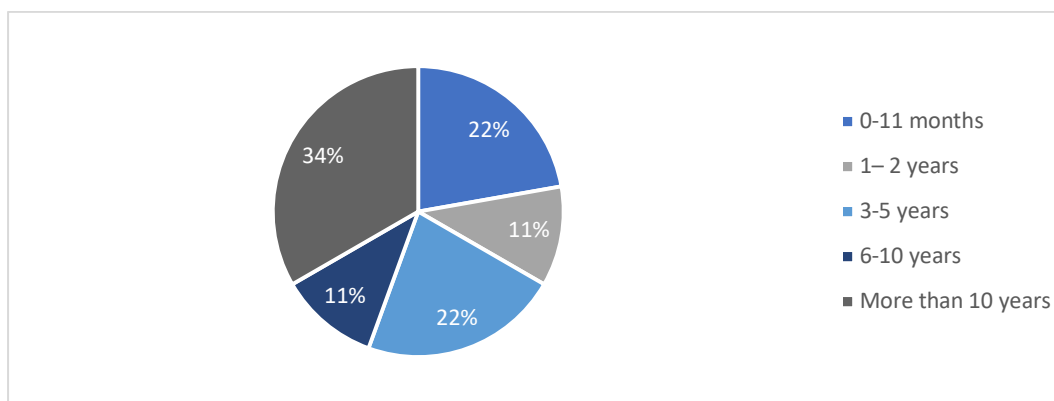
Question 1

You are a:



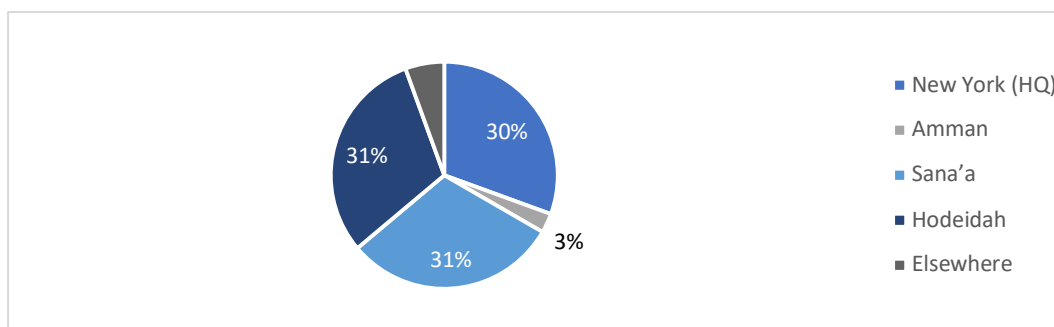
Question 2

You have been with UNDP on this contract for:



Question 3

As part of the crisis response, you are / were based in:

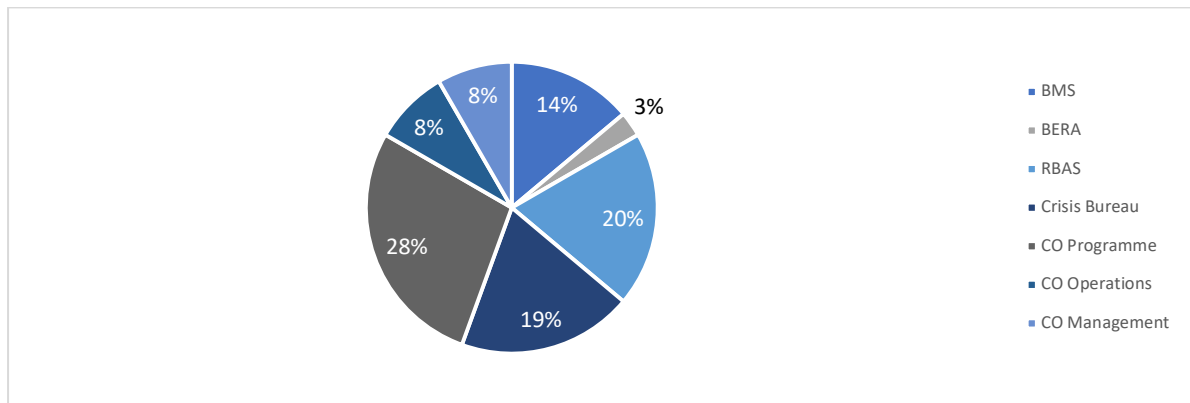


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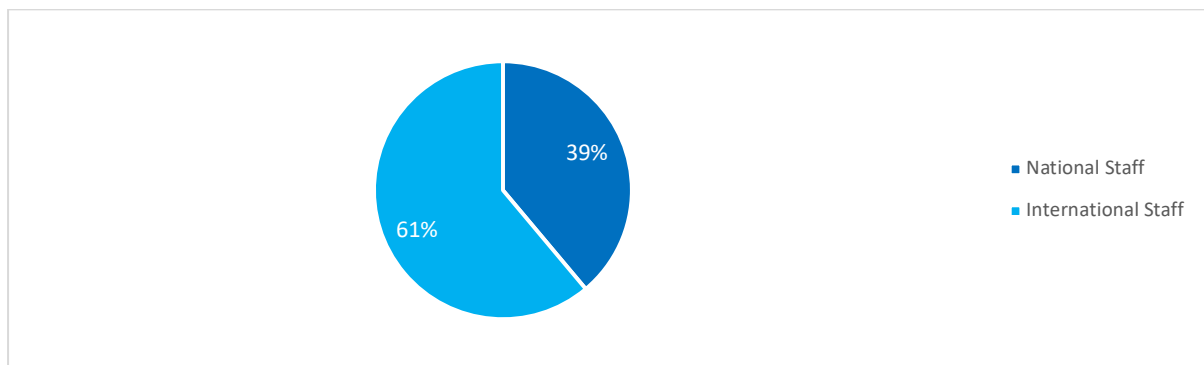
Question 4

You are part of:



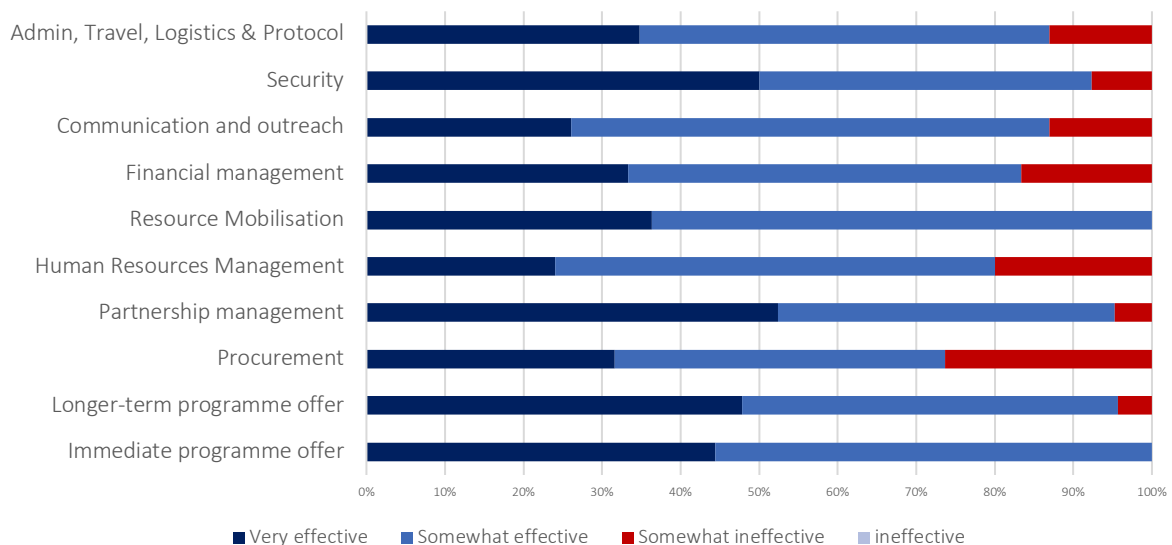
Question 5

You are:



Question 6

Based on your involvement and knowledge, what would you say are the two areas with the greatest achievements and “wins” for UNDP with regards to the Hodeidah (Yemen) response?

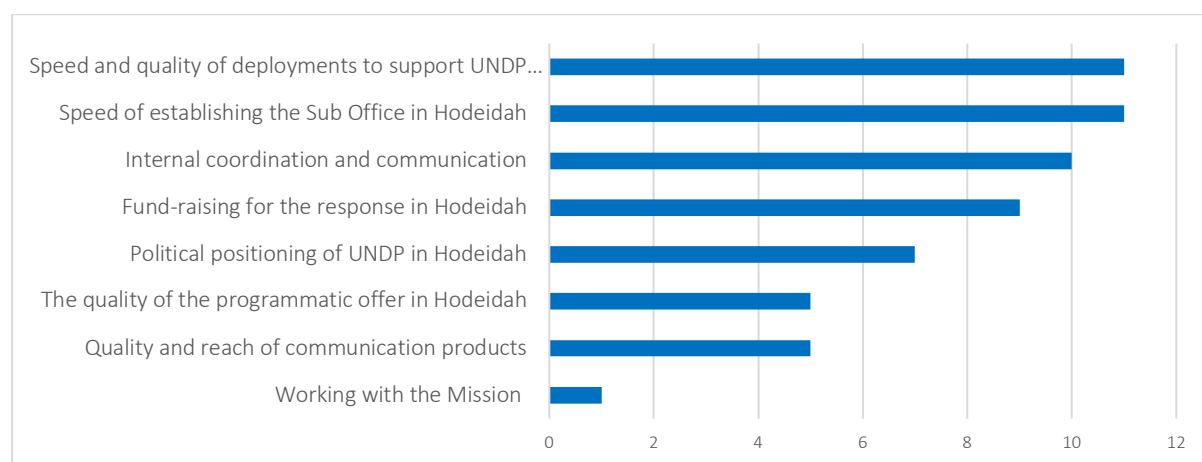


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UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

Question 7

Based on your involvement and knowledge, what would you say are the two areas with the greatest challenges for UNDP with regards to the Hodeidah (Yemen) response?

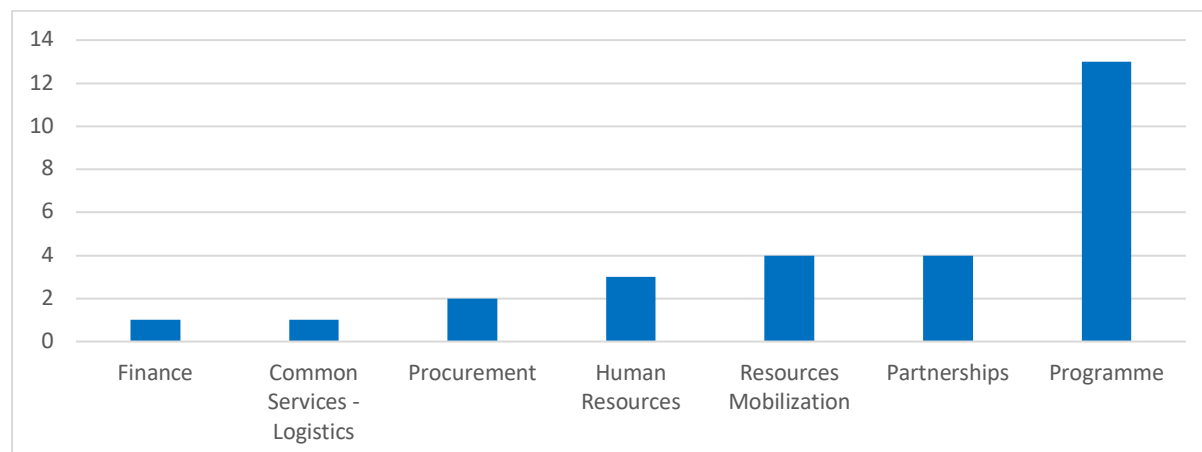


Other:

- the delay in implementing the peace agreement (1)
- Receive the political coverage to implement activities related to the ongoing negotiations (1)

Question 8

In which of the following areas did you see the most innovative approaches developed and used by UNDP in implementing the crisis response?



- Not sure: 6

Question 9

Please briefly describe – in one sentence - the most important innovation(s) with potential for corporate consideration and mainstreaming.

- Working closely with local partners to enhance partnership and trustworthy
- The most important innovation is a multi-agency Think-Tank to support technical programming aspects, and align them to the peace process negotiations' outcomes
- Due to the crisis location - Hodeidah, the deployment was done through TA contract instead of regular IC. In this regards, HQ Crisis Bureau supported whole TA recruitment process from position creation to on boarding of TA

After-Action Review

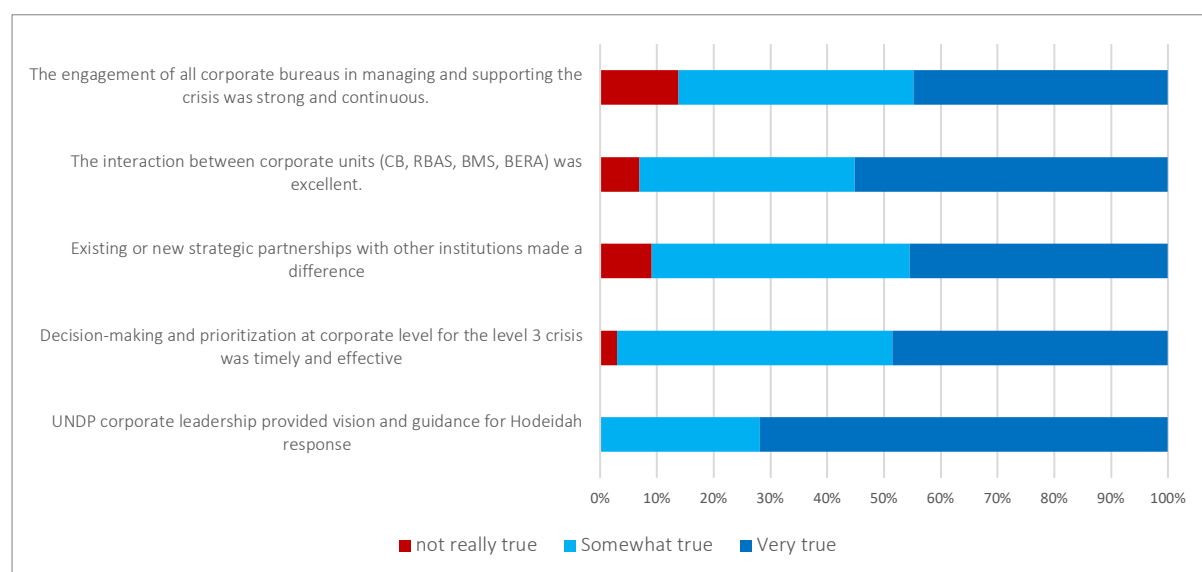
UNDP's Surge Response in Hodeidah (Yemen) from January to June 2019

staff. This is a good example that HQ took lead in the process of TA deployment and support to COs where capacity is needed.

- Rapid deployment and a quick employment programme.
- Public private partnerships to leverage resources and expertise.
- Positioning UNDP, preparedness and developing a programme offer.
- Business case for establishing local presence is funded through catalytic and risk informed funding allocation from the Crisis Board (ideally through a revolving fund)
- The close coordination between UN actors in resources mobilization
- Providing of operations manager with finance here in Al Hodeidah office to facilitate the implementation of projects
- I think the most important innovation is port reactivation and maintenance.
- Better alignment of operations support to support programming
- Solid partnerships established with Port of Rotterdam and other private and commercial actors in the name of supporting Hodeida port under the Stockholm agreement.
- Finding ways to bring consultants on board with contractual modalities that would guarantee their safety and easy access to the ground.
- The most important innovation would be the mainstreaming the deployment of experts on TAs for assignments to high risk environments (especially E duty stations). This should be the case for all ExpRes assignments either part of a SURGE/support plan (funded by CB) or ad-hoc request from a CO (in this case the CO should be advised that TA would be the most appropriate form of deployment). Happy to clarify this further if needed.
- Hodeida cleaning for confidence building with community
- PSF - hybrid program with OSESGY, RCO and UNDP in the post de-linking world
- To me having a dedicated procurement team to support the agreement and expedite the implementation of agreement is an innovative step that should be taken into considerations for similar situation to avoid unnecessary delays at the existing procurement units.
- Designing the improvement of the three ports of Hodeidah in a way to start a quick emergency intervention with the limited resources at the moment with a possibility to extend and expand in the future.
- Develop an MOU with DPPA to allow for closer support to Missions
- We need a clear planning tools for all operations activities and to be communicated in advance so that efficient services are provided.
- Search for one vision to be managed by all and find pout one way of communication that should be worked on and developed

Question 10

Please briefly describe – in one sentence - the most important innovation(s) with potential for corporate consideration and mainstreaming.

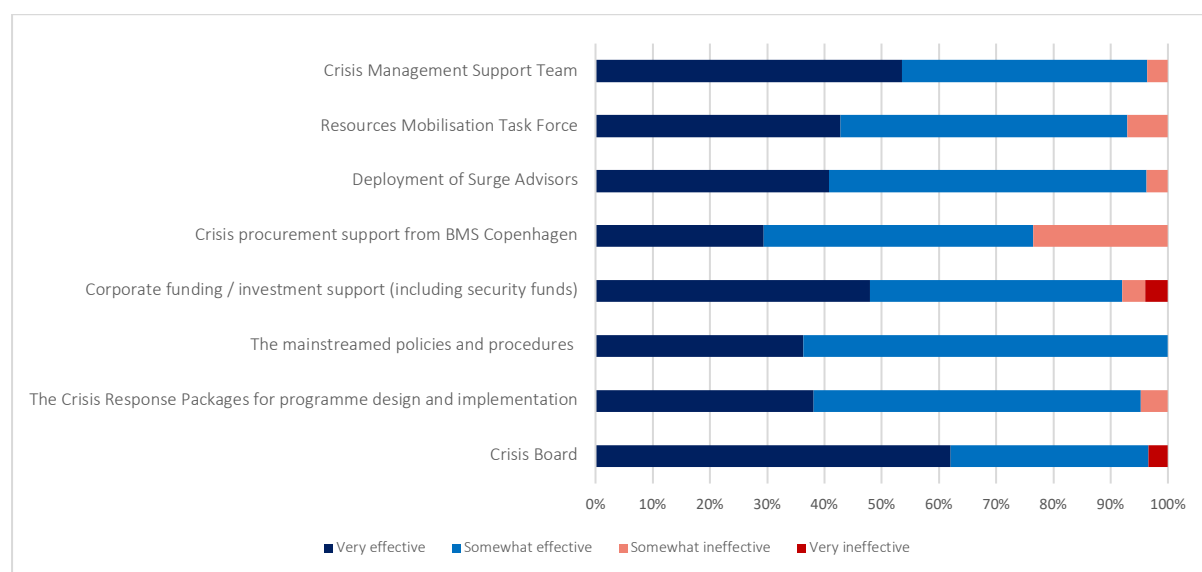


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Question 11

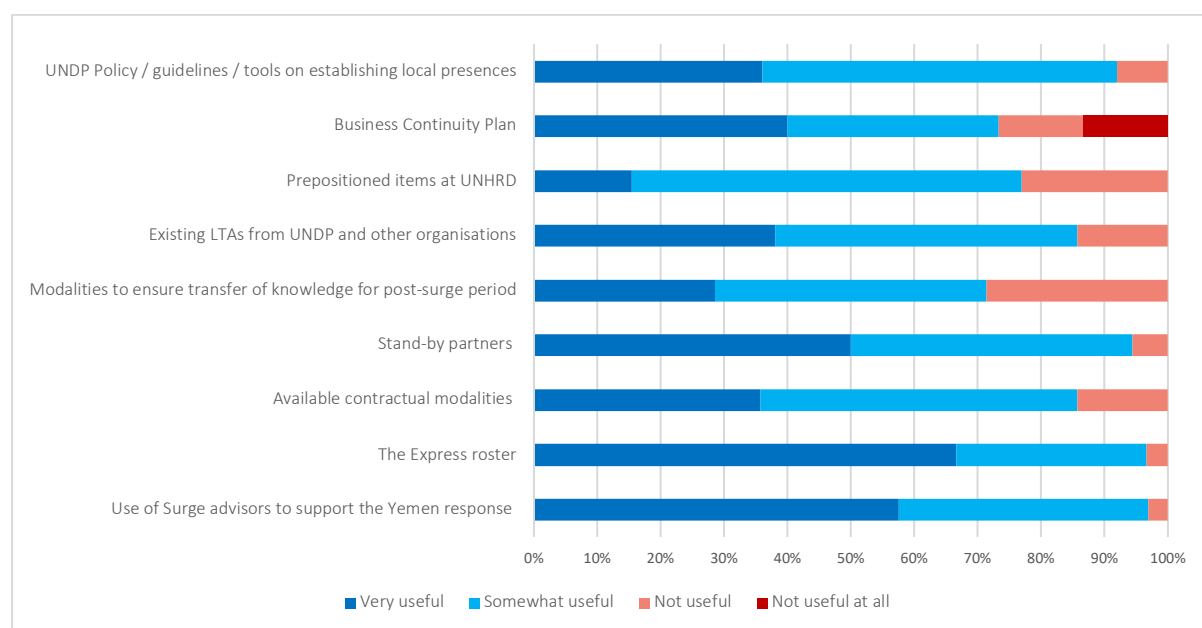
Please rate the usefulness / effectiveness of the following components of UNDP's corporate mechanism for the Hodeidah response:



Undecided / don't know (by component): 8,22,9,19,11,14,15,7.

Question 12

How useful were the following tools:



Undecided / Don't know (by tool): 11, 21, 23, 15, 15, 18, 8, 6, 3.

Question 13

Optional - Please provide any comments on UNDP systems and tools you consider important

- IC policy is sometimes rigid to implement in the crisis deployment setting.
- Visa delays hampered deployment of SURGE.

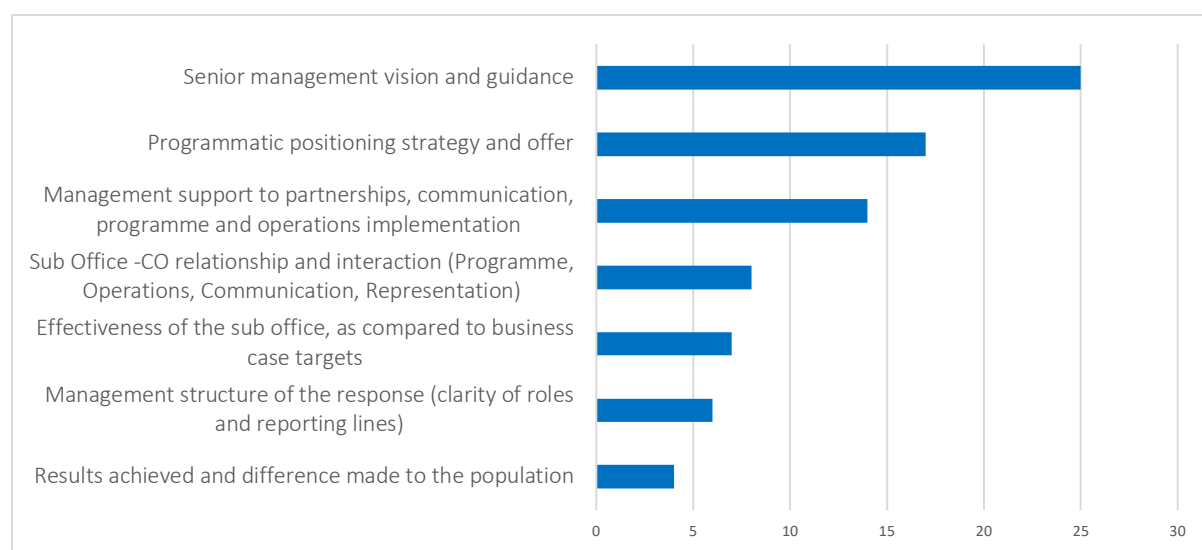
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- Visa issuance is an issue in Yemen, which slows down deployments.
- Available current and innovative crisis preparedness and response tools must be known well by the CO colleagues and SURGE advisors, this is not always the case, particularly for the crisis packages and operations tools.
- The Hodeidah response reconfirmed the need for UNDP to establish an internal UNDP revolving fund.
- Corporate funding should have been aligned with the corporate vision to position UNDP in Hodeida taking into consideration the clearly associated high investment risk.
- Despite excellent systems, the deployment of the team was significantly constrained by the visa process.
- While UNDP Programmatic system is innovative, in the other hand the operations system of the CO is very poor in delivery and bureaucratic.
- UNDP needs to enhance/update the business continuity plan and presented to the staff.

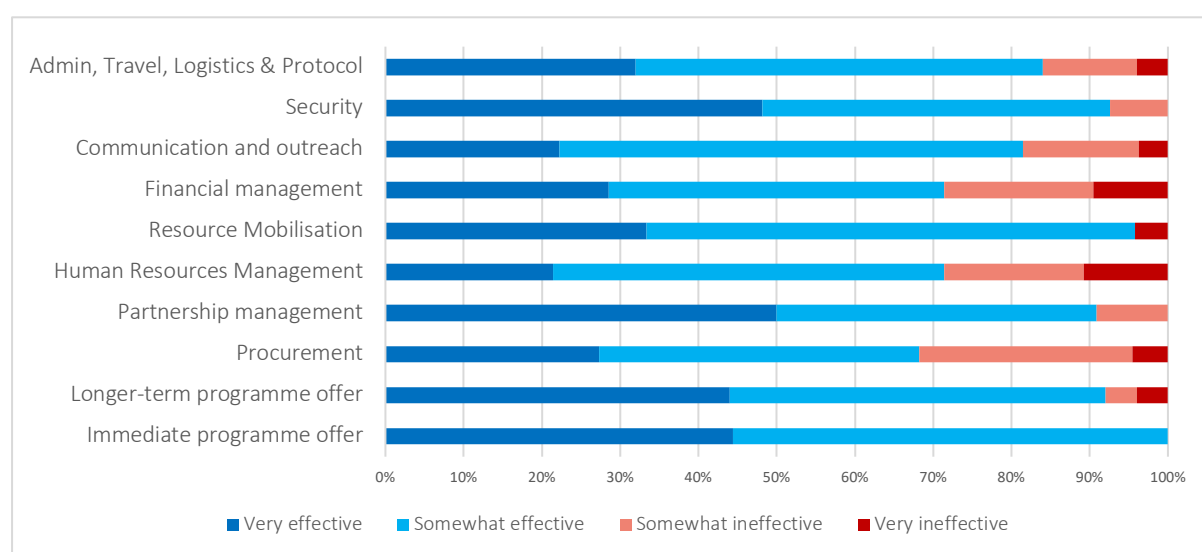
Question 14

In which of the following areas do you believe the country-level crisis response was particularly strong?



Question 15

Please rate the effectiveness and efficiency of the country-level crisis response in the following areas:



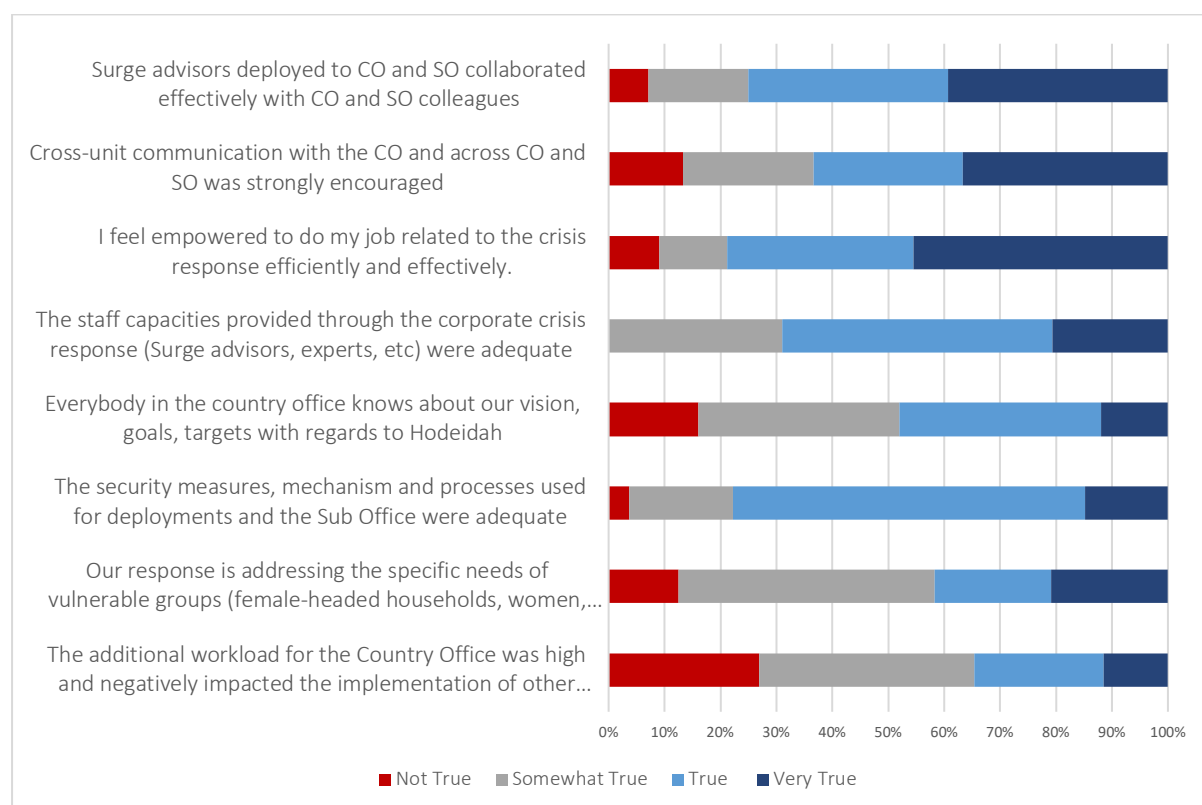
Don't know (by area): 9, 11, 14, 14, 8, 12, 15, 9, 9, 11.

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Question 16

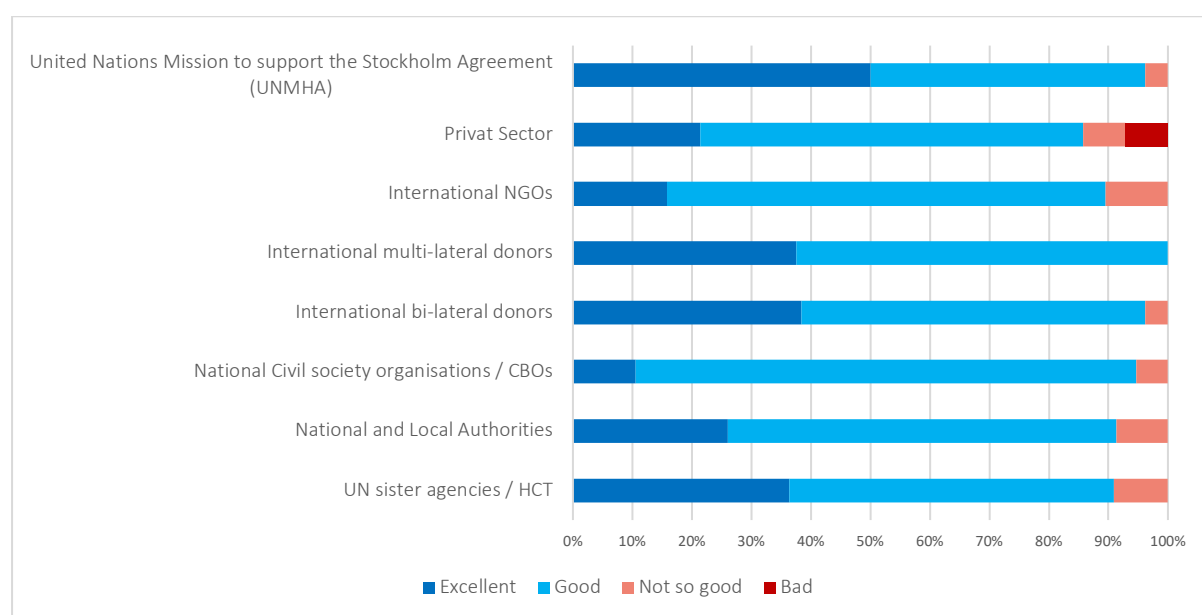
Please rate the following statements:



Don't know (by statement): 8, 6, 3, 7, 11, 9, 12, 10.

Question 17

Please rate the quality of UNDP Yemen's partnerships with the following actors:



Undecided / don't know (by actor): 10, 22, 17, 12, 10, 17, 13, 14.

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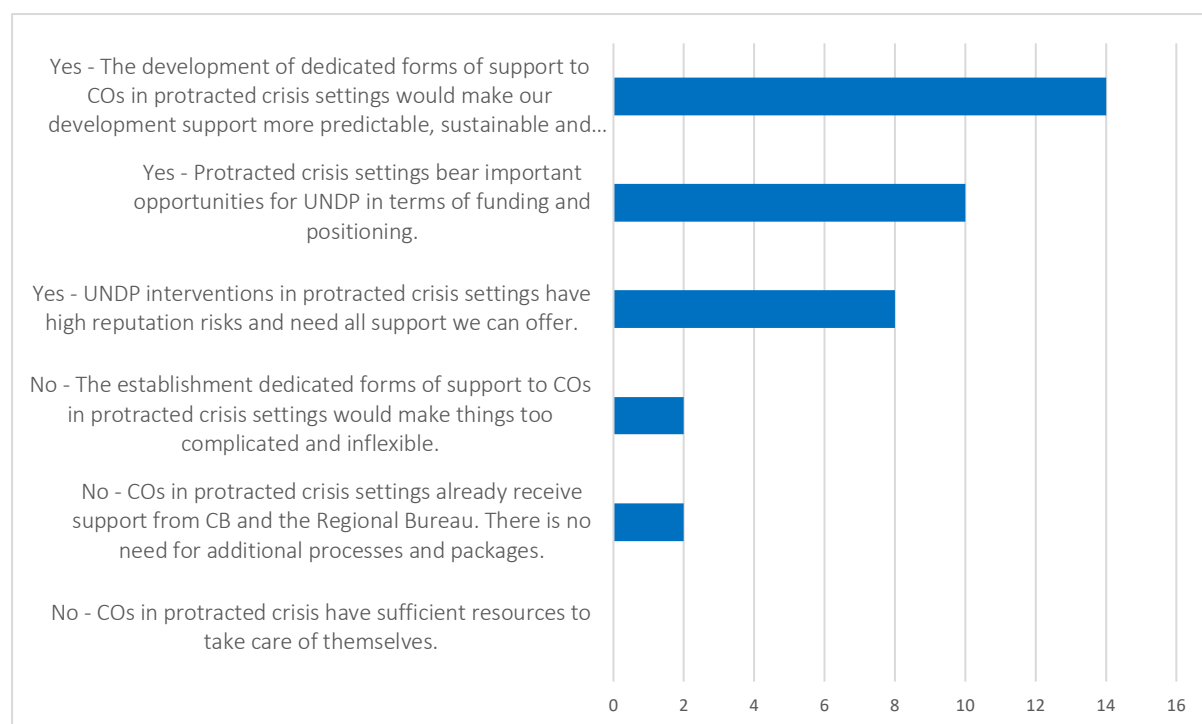
Question 18

Having reflected about the entire response in Hodeidah, what is in your view the most important lesson learned? Please try to summarise the lesson in one sentence.

- We should be more flexible.
- The focus on inter and intra UN coordination, as well as on UN planning and programming was too disconnected from the parties engaged in political negotiations and peace dialogue, instead of focusing on peace dialogue outcomes and building on these.
- The high speed of the response was not done at the expenses of the quality of the response, at least from a programmatic/partnership/resource mobilization level.
- Greater clarity is needed on the Ops (HR) front. There were a lot of inconsistent messages about whether ICs have the same security coverage as staff members.
- Unpredictability due to visa issuance negatively impact deployment
- In Yemen deployments are unpredictable because of the issue with visa.
- A timely intervention in development can be supportive of peace operations.
- You may have the best and most effective CRP and the best intentions, but the authorities might have a reluctance to allow implementation of the plan.
- In my view the Hodeidah is example of a timely and strategically well positioned response. It allowed for UNDP to become the most important UN agency for the implementation of the Stockholm agreement. On the operational side, gaps did occur in HR, finance, and procurement that require attention at the CO and corporate level.
- The effective collaboration between RBx and central units led to successful results
- A great strategic and partnerships-oriented effort cannot guarantee a full success of the implementation of the peace agreement if not properly backed up but effective and fast operations support measures and capacity and adequate corporate support to boost the CO capacity on both dimensions.
- Importance of strong and clear decision making early on.
- the speed in building the sub-office was admirable; however, having some uninformed and assumption-based decisions with certain consequences could have been avoided with proper consultation and/or expert advice
- We should to work together to support the people in Al Hodeidah who really affected from the conflict to spread peace in this city
- "effective communication with local authorities is very important to achieving UNDP goals"
- UNDP is quick to deploy all available resources to respond to a corporate emergency.
- Flexibility to accommodate country needs to support crisis is key.
- UNDP was quick to the mark in Hodeidah following the Stockholm Agreement - both in terms of positioning with authorities and the UN system (UNMHA, OSESGY) but also in resource mobilisation with partners. This was a win for UNDP even if the operational establishment of the Hodeida Sub Office has some lessons learned.
- That the organization should be more open to taking risks, such as making the bet of opening a presence in Hodeidah, when nobody knew were the peace agreement was headed.
- From my engagement in the Hodeidah response, the most important lesson learned is that we, in the deployments team and Crisis Bureau, need to reflect on the conditions we deploy experts in the field and assess the appropriateness of the deployment mechanism used (staff contract or consultancy). Also, to pay attention to the duty of care issues and put in place a proper package of support (including psychological) for the deployees. For now, there is no system in place (it is not regarded as our problem) and for some reason the decision to deploy on TAs seems to trigger a lot of resistance (justified or not).
- UNDP rushed too much for a process that might never unfold, at the risk of being perceived pro- de facto authorities
- More coordination is required.
- "Being part of the HR response, and looking back at Hodeidah experience: More clarity is needed in terms of options available for deployment of staff to L3 crisis countries, perhaps a document outlining all HR options and potential solutions along with requirements for each option so CO can make an informed decision. Better flow of information and involvement of stakeholders."
- Operations Colleagues and Management do not have an understanding of the importance of what the programme colleague do and seek to achieve, therefore, they become obstruction to the delivery.
- Expectation management and the need for an official MOU with the Mission.
- Involve related parties internal and external so that actions taken are not rejected.
- My involvement was little, so I am not sure whether I am the best person to give my view here.
- Context in Hodeidah is different therefore any coming step/projects/partnership/coordination needed to be studied carefully and precisely at different level and came up with strategical systematic procedures at operation and grammatical level.
- The presence of UNDP in Hodeidah served strongly to relief peoples' suffering.
- Partnership and strengthen the relationship with the authority.

Question 19

Do you believe that UNDP should develop dedicated and continuous forms of support to country offices in protracted crisis settings beyond the “regular” 6-month support package? Please choose the statement which comes closest to your opinion:



Question 20

Optional - Any other suggestions/thoughts on corporate support to UNDP country offices in protracted crisis settings?

- Release of trained SURGE advisers to crisis effected area is very crucial for speedy recovery of the affected crisis area.
- UNDP should reflect with the key COs in protracted crisis and fragile settings looking to the development offer and operations arrangements. In 2020 a workshop involving those COs should inform the policy reform and identify priority measures in support of the COs.
- None of the proposed responses under question 19 works for me. It has to be context specific - Niger is protracted, Afghanistan is protracted, Somalia is protracted, and each of them requires different type of support. See parallel with IASC discussions around 'scale-up' (for sudden on-set crisis) and 'sustain' (for protracted crisis).
- Systematic corporate tools should be developed and made available with adequate training and orientation to the COs in crises settings
- CB in coordination with other central bureaus (particularly regional bureaus and BMS) should assess the needs of offices in protracted crisis and address gaps, especially in relation to the operational capacity of the CO but also programmatic. For instance, two of the top requesters of support from the ExpRes roster are Iraq and Lebanon (both protracted crisis) which are not priority countries for both CB and RBAS. It is worth doing an internal analysis and see how we can best support these COs (in terms technical/substantive support but also operational).
- Maybe UNDP can learn a lesson from the previous experience that Yemen had go through and check the validities of valubles outcomes of the protracted crisis were set up through close cooperation with the local authority in order to avoid constrain in future.

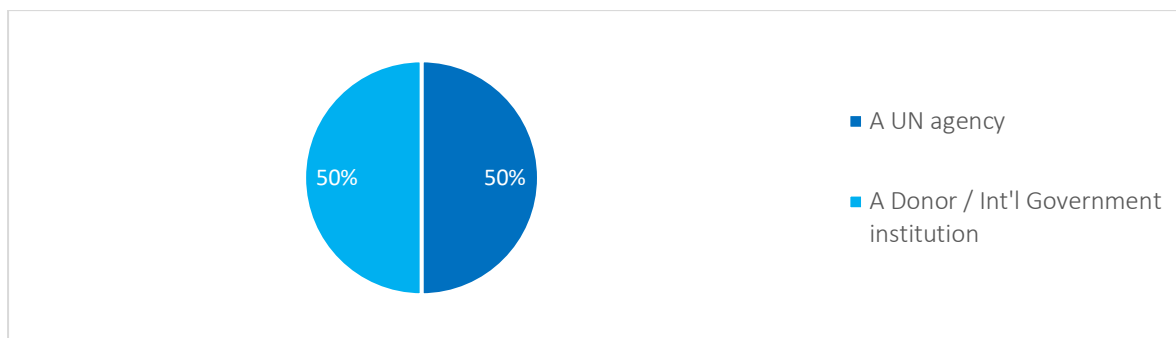
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External Partner Survey

Total Responses: 6

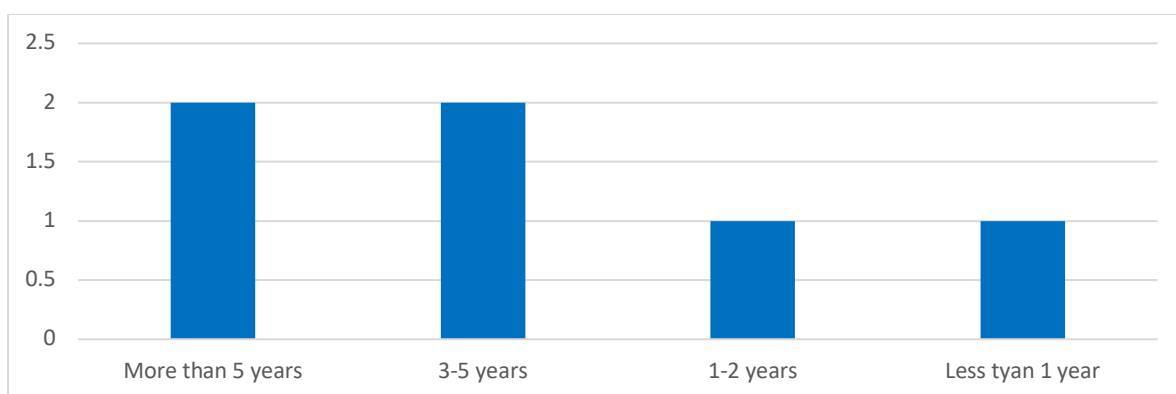
Question 1

You are a representative of:



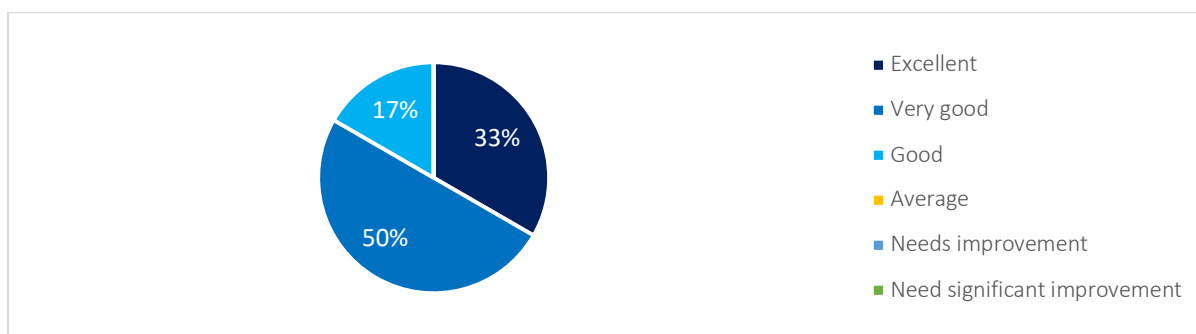
Question 2

You have been working on / in Yemen since:



Question 3

How would you rate the overall support provided by UNDP to the implementation of the Stockholm peace agreement (ie. support to ports of Hodeidah, Salif and Ras Issa, Local Security Forces, Mine Action and Port revenue management).

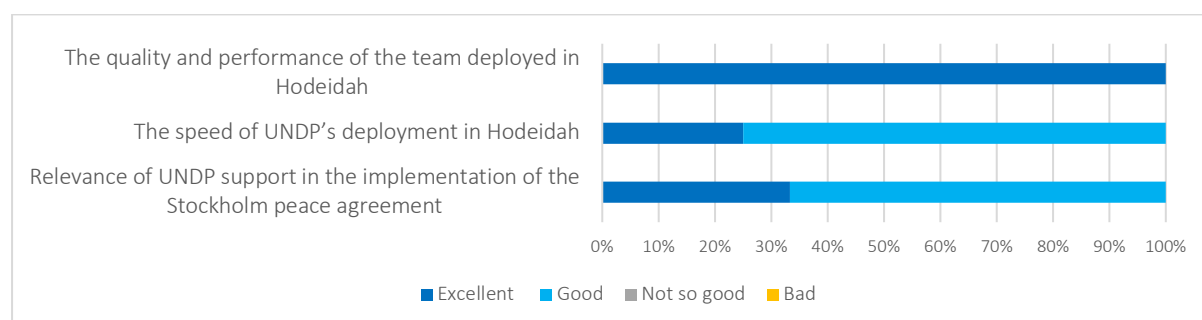


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Question 4

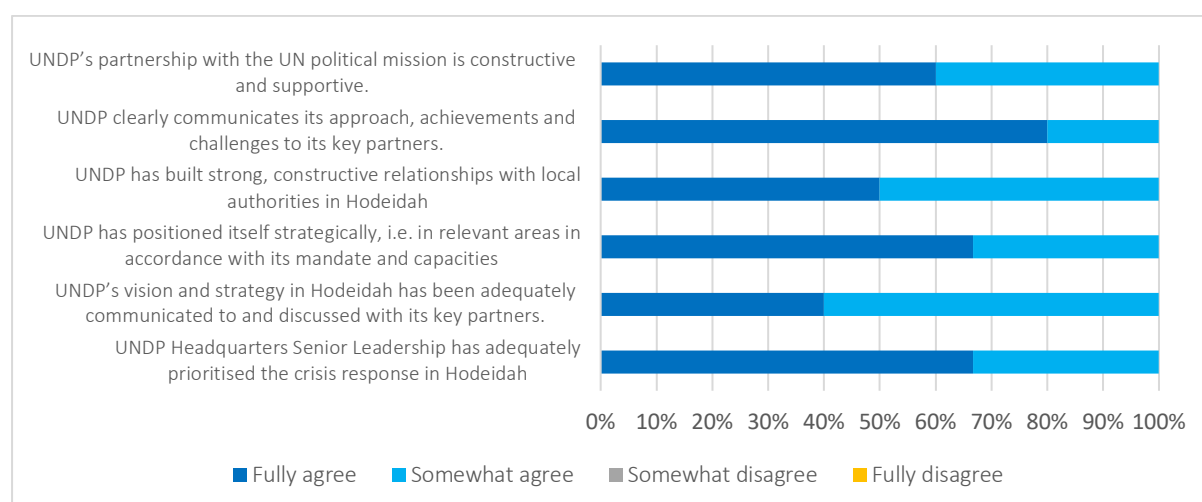
Please rate the following aspects:



Neutral / Undecided (by statement): 0 / 2 / 2.

Question 5

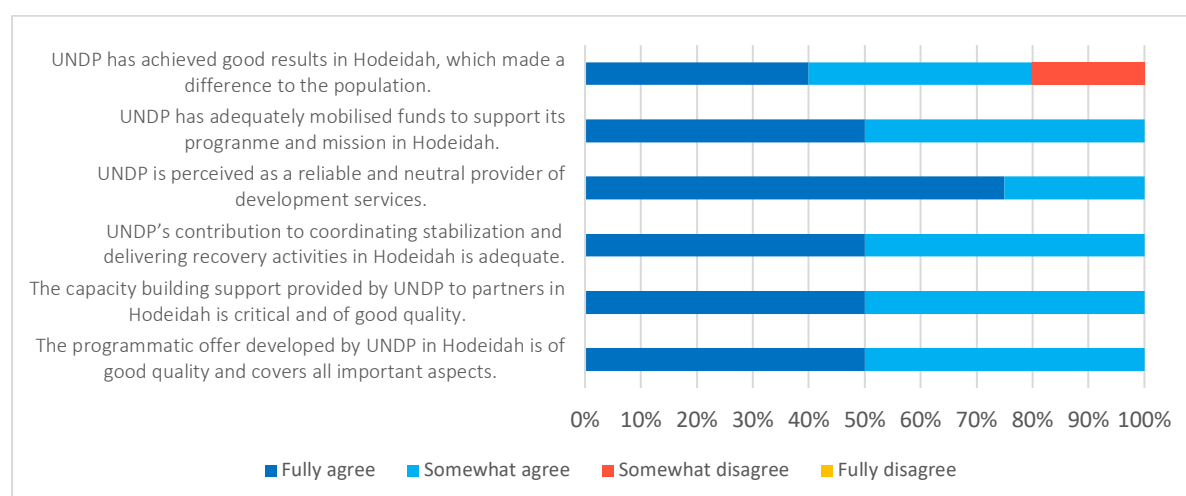
Please rate the following statements:



Neutral / Undecided (by statement): 0 / 1 / 0 / 4 / 1 / 1.

Question 6

Please rate the following statements:



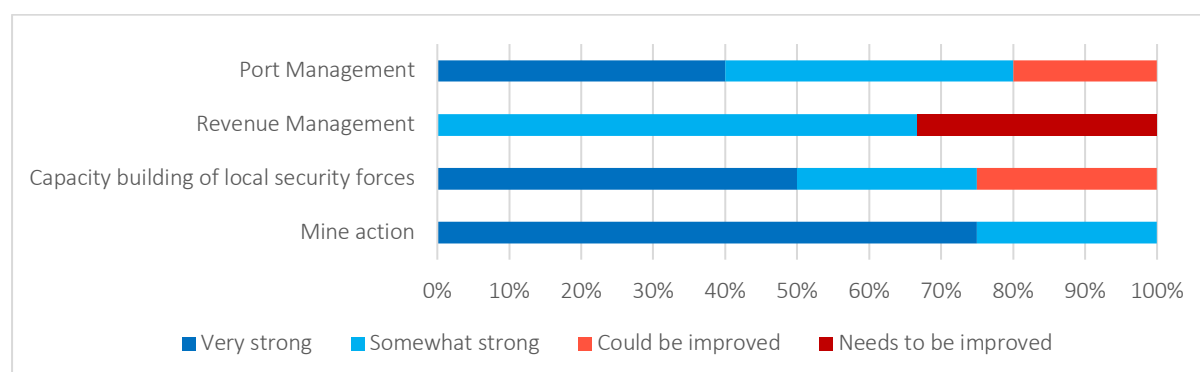
Neutral / Undecided (by statement): 2 / 4 / 2 / 2 / 0 / 1.

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Question 7

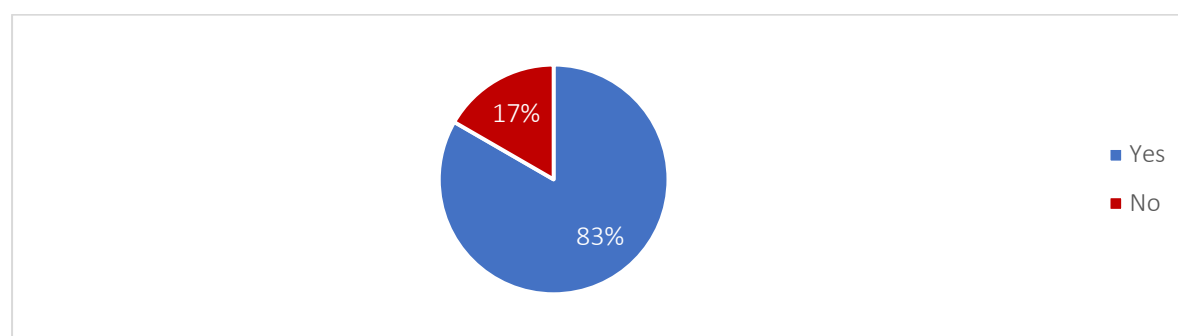
Looking at the quality of programme design and implementation, please rate UNDP's support in the following areas:



Neutral / Undecided (by area): 2 / 2 / 3 / 1.

Question 8

Looking into the future, do you feel that the cooperation between UN political mission and UNDP in Hodeidah is a model worth replicating?



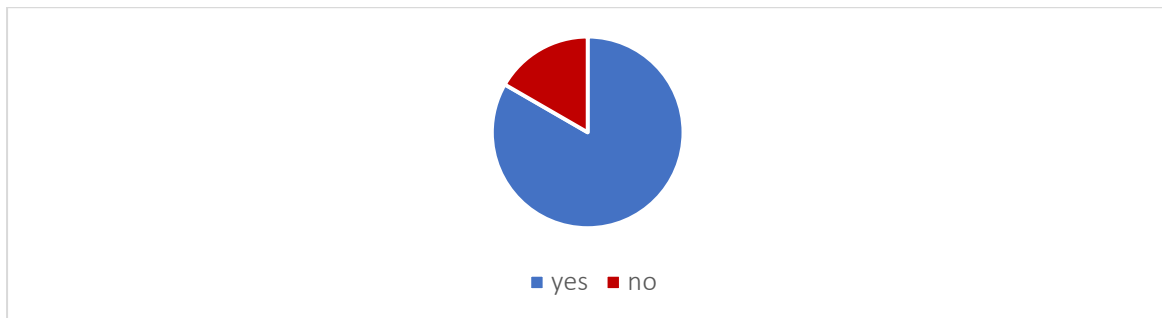
Question 9

Please briefly explain your answer to question 8:

- I believe the PSF will be very useful. The roles between the RC and UNDP could be clearer. Also, the cooperation on working level between political mission/UNDP and the RCs office could improve with clear structures.
- Worth having a clear operational agency involved and at arm's length. Could be another agency but UNDP gives hope for future development
- In environment of Hodeidah city and having Hodeidah port as the lifeline for the north of Yemen brings great deal of stress to work under. Only coordinated actions between political mission and UNDP Hodeidah led to effectively and efficiently performance of programs and activities that are ensuring lifesaving and other vital commodities to reach the millions of people across the country who depend on humanitarian assistance.
- As far as known on the basis of among others information provided, talks conducted, and briefings indicates a cooperation between the two entities that could serve as an example.
- They are interlinked and cannot be separated.
- UNDP has been on the starting blocks to assist the UN political missions, the challenges that all UN agencies face are Mostly due to the difficult political environment and the obstacles to the implementation of the Stockholm agreement.

Question 10

Do you feel that the cooperation between UN humanitarian country team and UNDP in Hodeidah is fully functional?



Question 11

Please briefly explain your answer to question 10.

- I don't know first-hand but from a distance it seems to work well.
- Can always be better.
- UNDP vision and strategy in Hodeida have been clearly communicated from the beginning with the UN Humanitarian team and regular communication on the progress and coordination has been established. This led to the establishment of a strong and constructive relations with a greater impact of the actions taken by the UN Humanitarian team and UNDP.
- As far as understood this is the case, though not following the humanitarian country team that closely as the political process and more specific the UNDP programmes.
- The decoupling of UNDP and HC/RC office left some unclear lines of authority which were not clarified quickly enough - but overall it appears the relationship is effective.
- I've seen good cooperation between these partners.

Question 12

Optional - Please provide any additional input you would like to share:

- The difficulties that UNDP faces in Yemen are due to the lack of implementation of the Stockholm agreement and difficulty to work with the involved parties.

[ends]

5.7 Extract from the Letter of the Secretary General to the PSC³⁹

[Note: Blue highlights were added for illustration purposes]

(...)

Coordination with Stakeholders of the Stockholm Agreement

During the reporting period, UNMHA maintained coordination with United Nations entities and other stakeholders of the Stockholm Agreement, **including with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**, on the issue of local security forces, demining activities and port rehabilitation, as well as with the United Nations Verification and Inspection Mechanism on the issue of enhanced monitoring at the ports of Hudaydah, Salif and Ra's Isa. UNMHA continued to support the United Nations Verification and Inspection Mechanism in discussions with relevant authorities in Hudaydah on technical aspects of launching the Mechanism's operations from inside the ports, which is pending approval of the two parties at the political level.

In the meantime, the Mechanism's operations continue mainly from Djibouti. **It is worth noting that UNDP has completed an assessment of the three ports** and raised funds for an emergency rehabilitation package aimed at keeping the port operational to handle the shipment of commercial and humanitarian goods into Yemen. Similarly, **my Special Envoy, in close collaboration with UNMHA and UNDP**, is working on a mechanism and options for port revenue management.

Yemen Executive Mine Action Centre teams, **supported by UNDP**, are yet to complete the marking of minefields in Hudaydah after Houthi forces redeployed from the ports in May. **UNMHA is liaising with UNDP** to coordinate, through the Centre, the development of quick-impact mine action initiatives to ensure the safety of the population of Hudaydah. Humanitarian actors and UNMHA personnel are monitoring the removal of military manifestations in the vicinity of the minefields.

Related to these issues, my Special Envoy for Yemen is liaising with the parties to encourage progress on outstanding political issues related to local security forces, **while UNDP remains ready to provide technical support to any agreed approach**, as well as the launch of enhanced monitoring through the United Nations Verification and Inspection Mechanism. In addition, as part of its mandated tasks, UNMHA has, when requested, continued to serve as a liaison between humanitarian actors and the military leadership of the parties in Hudaydah to support the planning, coordination and conduct of humanitarian tasks. UNMHA, which does not participate in the humanitarian tasks itself, has facilitated operational movements for United Nations entities and international non-governmental organizations through communication with the parties, including with respect to access to critical infrastructure in contested areas.

(...)

³⁹ Source: Security Council Online Document Library (click [here](#)). Accessed 3 December 2019.

5.8 Results of the RACI exercise

This RACI exercise has been carried out with CMST members in New York in October 2019.

Tasks ⁴⁰	CB	CMST	EXO	C Bureau	BERA	BMS	CO	RB	BPPS
Immediate crisis readiness									
Activate BCP							R	A	
Appoint a CRT and Coordinator	C			A			R		
Activate CMST				R			C	R	
Alerting first responders and their bureaux				R					
Nominating staff to deploy as First Responders				R			A		
Provide proposed initial messages									
Crisis declaration and support planning									
carry out a rapid crisis level assessment				R				R	
Deploy a Surge Planning team	A			R					
Draft Exigency Memo	A			R					
Participate in crisis assessments									
Organise first mandatory crisis board				R					
Prepare confidential report on CO capacities									
Hold confidential consultations									
Take decisions on CO changes									
Identify programmes to be reoriented							R		
Surge Implementation									
Identify and field deployments	A			R	C	C	C	C	C
Monitor Surge plan implementation				R			A		
Develop a UNDP recovery vision	A						R		
Develop a crisis response programme	A						R		
Prepare a communication action plan					C		R		
Set up a development solutions team									
Support programme development									
Develop Resource Mobilization strategy					C		R	C	
Organise & Manage RM events									
Issue public crisis response updates							R		
Define key messages for UNDP managers / staff									

→ Unclear or disagreement: 9/26 (35%); functions highlighted in blue in the table.

⁴⁰ The tasks / functions were extracted from the UNDP Surge SOP. Not all functions defined in the SOP are reflected in the table.

5.9 Model Calculation for the Revolving Fund

Overview of corporate support components and assumptions

<u>Upfront Support Components:</u>	*	<u>Assumptions:</u>	
Security Funds	0.5	45 m newly mobilized	
RB Resources	1	of which 15 m annual delivery	
TRAC 3 Grant	1	for annual reimbursement:	
Investment Loan	2	– 50% of corporate 5% GMS income	
TOTAL	4.5	– 2% DPC charge on annual programme budget	

* In million US\$

Average reimbursement scheme by country

GMS Reimbursement		DPC Reimbursement	
Newly mobilized	45	New Annual delivery	15
New annual delivery	15	Assumed Staff DPC charge (1.5%)	0.225
Annual GMS, corporate portion (5%)	0.75	Assumed Facility DPC charge (1.5%)	0.225
Annual Reimbursement portion (75%)	0.563	Annual DPC reimbursement	0.45
GMS reimbursement after 3 years	1.688	DPC reimbursement after 3 years	1.35
		Total Reimbursement after 1 year	1.0125
		Total Reimbursement after 3 years	3.0375

* In million US\$

Funds Capitalization over 6 years

Year 1		Year 2	
Initial Capitalization	20	Initial capitalization year 2	30
Annual investments per L2, L3	2	Average reimbursement by country	1.0125
Average number of annual L2, L3	5	Total annual reimbursement	5.0625
Total annual loans	10	Total annual investment	10
Capitalization at end of year 1	10	Capitalization at end of year 2	25.0625
Year 3		Year 4	
Initial capitalization year 3	5.063	Initial capitalization year 4	25.1875
Average reimbursement by country	1.013	Average reimbursement by country	1.0125
Total annual reimbursement	10.13	Total annual reimbursement	15.1875
Total annual investment	10	Total annual investment	10
Capitalization end year 3	5.188	Capitalization end year 4	30.375
Year 5		Year 6	
Initial capitalization year 5	10.38	Initial capitalization year 6	35.5625

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Average reimbursement by country	1.013	Average reimbursement by country	1.0125
Total annual reimbursement	15.19	Total annual reimbursement	15.1875
Total annual investment	10	Total annual investment	10
Capitalization end year 5	15.56	Capitalization end year 6	40.75

At the end of 6 years

Number of L2, L3 serviced	30
Total amount invested (US\$)	60
Total reimbursements (US\$)	60.75
Pending reimbursements (US\$)	15.19

** In million US\$*

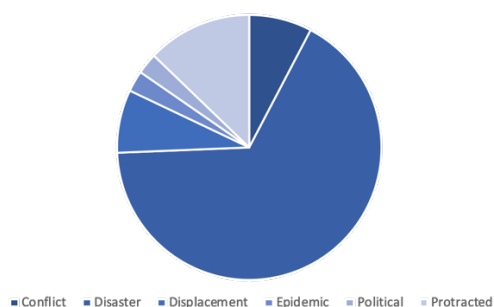
5.10 CRU / Crisis Bureau crisis support 2015–2019

The following statistics are based on the data provided by the UNDP CB the Portal and Deployments Annual Reports 2015 – 2019.⁴¹ The UNDP CB responds on average to 25 crises per year, of which five L1, three to four L2 and one to two L3 crises.

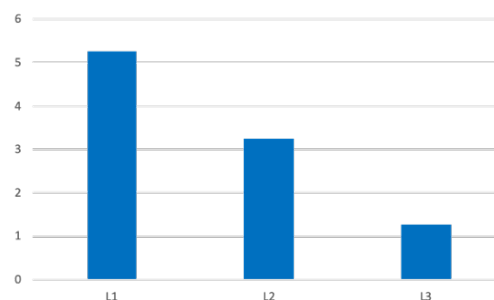
The majority of crises are natural disasters (67%), as compared to 13% protracted and 8 % conflict. Most of the L3 crisis, however, are conflict / protracted.

In terms of the high reputational risk & high opportunity crisis (L2,3), UNDP supports between 3-6 crises per year.

Distribution of crises by type



Average annual number of crises by level



⁴¹ <https://intranet.undp.org/sites/crr/response/Lists/CountryPages/Country%20Pages.aspx>.

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5.11 TA recruitment process: AS-IS and TO-BE

As-is Process

Step		Days	Location	Comment
1	TOR drafting, approving	3	CO	Hiring Manager has to draft and finalize job description in consultation with HR
2	Position Classification	0.5	CO	For Local Positions - HR to classify and approved by Head of Office. For international positions - classification is approved by ODU, Classification unit
3	Position Creation	2	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
4	Atlas E-recruit entry/approval of vacancy	0.2	CO	Needs to be performed by UNDP SM
5	Receipt of applications	14	CO	Can also be advertised for 7 days.
6	Longlisting (average time needed for 200 applications)	2.5	CO	
7	Shortlist (average time needed for 80 applications)	3	CO	Minimum 2 short-listers required at the same or higher level as the position. Another UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
8	Organizing and conducting written test	3	CO	Only/In-person. Not a requirement, can be skipped, however useful to test technical competencies and to further trim the shortlist.
9	Written test scoring	4	CO	Min. 2 scorers required at the same of higher position. Another UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
10	Organizing and conducting interviews (5 candidates)	5	CO	Incl. notification of candidates that should be min. 3 days in advance
11	Finalizing, circulating and approving interview reports	3	CO	Professional minute takers can be hired
12	Reference check, verification of credentials	4	CO	Can be run parallel as soon as interview list known
13	Organizing and conducting CRB	3	OHR	
14	Issuing letter of offer/accepting offer	3	OHR	
15	Issuing/Accepting Letter of Appointment	2	OHR	
16	Medical Clearance	5	HQ	Performed by the UN Medical Division
Total time (days) 57.2 – approximately 3 months.				

To-Be Process

Key process reduction:

- Use of TA positions pre-established by CB in the system
- Use of Express Roster candidates instead of advertising, interviewing and reference-checking
- Medical clearance done and regularly updated for “inner circle” of Express Roster candidates

Step		Time (days)	Location	Comment
1	Selection of Candidates from Roster and confirmation of Availability	2 days	CB	Can be done using the AI-based automatized database system and vetted by the roster manager and the CB and RB country desks.
2	Approval of selection	1 day	CB/CO	Should be done by the head of CSMT and the RR.
3	Issuing letter of offer/accepting offer	3 days	OHR	Service level agreements need to be defined.
4	Issuing/Accepting Letter of Appointment	2 days	OHR	Service level agreements need to be defined.
Total time (days) 8 – approximately 1.5 weeks.				

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5.12 Security Considerations for Third Party contracted personnel

The below text is an extract from the Back-To-Office report of the Director of UNDP's Security Office after his official mission to Somalia and Ukraine.

"Transferring risk through the use of third-party contractors (TPCs), towards whom the UNSMS and UNDP does not have security accountability, is one recognized albeit controversial security risk management measures often adopted in high risk environments. Whilst UNDP does not have a security responsibility for these non-UNDP personnel, it does not mean we ignore all moral of 'ethic of care' for these partners.

Consequently, whilst risk transfer is one acknowledged method through which UNDP has been able to enable and implement numerous programmes effectively and efficiently to deliver results, there must be numerous HR, legal, financial and security issues that UNDP managers and programme personnel need to consider when deciding where and how to utilize TPCs. This can include:

- Is the security risk for TPCs implementing UNDP programmes lower than what it would be for UNDP personnel?
- Has the financial, legal and security implications of sharing transport and/or office space between UNDP personnel and TPCs been considered and been balanced with Programme Criticality considerations?
- If providing UNDP transport/office space to TPC's has been chosen as the most efficient means of programme implementation, does the security risk substantially increase for either the UNDP personnel or TPC's in that shared transport/office space? Have all appropriate waivers been signed?
- Whilst the TPCs company is responsible for providing security, in the event of an incident against a shared mode of transport/office space, are there security plans in place to extend support when possible and available to TPCs?
- In the event of a security incident involving UNDP TPCs, have the reputational risks been considered, including in the event of assistance (for security, legal or financial reasons) not being extended?
- Have efforts been made to ensure that TPCs are not mistaken for UNDP personnel, including preventing the use of official UNDP logos and badges by TPCs?
- As part of the Global Terms and Conditions of third-party contractors, vendors are required to have in place a security plan and for UNDP to be able to review and suggest modifications to that security plan. In high risk environments, have those security plans been shared with UNDP manager's and security advisors? And have they been reviewed for appropriateness and to ensure that in the event of an incidents, coordination and support can be enhanced?
- Are there methods through which situational awareness and security information can be shared appropriately and in a timely manner?
- Is the activity one that should be considered a UNDP staff function?

Whilst the above points attempt to provide some practical guidance without being prescriptive or inhibiting to programme implementation, it is clear that enabling UNDP projects in high risk environments consciously and taking into account the 'ethic of care' can be a complex task that needs to be balanced by Managers within a local context, also taking in account Programme criticality considerations as well. This is a complex area with significant organizational risks and opportunities that requires further discussions and consultations within and across UNDP and the UNSMS."

5.13 Options for operational clustering

FTA Recruitment

Step	Description	Time (days)	Can be outsourced?	Location of Performance	Comment
1	TOR drafting, approving	3	No	CO	Hiring Manager has to draft and finalize job description in consultation with HR
2	Position Classification	0.5	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	For Local Positions - HR to classify and approved by Head of Office. For international positions - classification is approved by ODU, Classification unit
3	Position Creation	2	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
4	Atlas E-recruit entry/approval of vacancy	0.2	No	CO	Needs to be performed by UNDP SM
5	Receipt of applications	14	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can also be advertised for 7 days.
6	Longlisting (average time needed for 200 applications)	3	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	
7	Shortlist (average time needed for 80 applications)	3	No	CO	Minimum 2 short listers required at the same or higher level as the position. Another UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
8	Organizing and conducting written test	3	No	CO	Not a requirement, can be skipped, however useful to test technical competencies and to further trim the shortlist. The time includes creation of test questions. So far only finance position accounting testing is performed by the HQ
9	Written test scoring	4	No	CO	Min. 2 scorers required at the same of higher position. Another UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
10	Organizing and conducting interviews (5 candidates)	5	No	CO	Incl. notification of candidates that should be min. 3 days in advance
11	Finalizing, circulating and approving interview reports	3	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Professional minute takers can be hired
12	Reference check, verification of credentials)	4	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can be run parallel as soon as interview list is known
13	Organizing and conducting CRB	3	No	CO	
14	Issuing letter of offer/accepting offer	3	No	CO	
15	Issuing/Accepting Letter of Appointment	2	No	CO	
16	Medical Clearance	5	No	HQ	Performed by the UN Medical Division
Total time (days)		57.7			

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SC recruitment

Step	Description	Time (days)	Can be outsourced?	Location of Performance	Comment
<i>Note: SC Local. Waiver from competitive process can be given up to 20 contracts/CO/year; roster can be used that can decrease the time or recruitment to 10 days.</i>					
1	TOR drafting, approving	3	No	CO	Hiring Manager has to draft and finalize job description in consultation with HR
2	Position Classification	0.5	No	CO	For Local Positions - HR to classify and approved by Head of Office. For international positions - classification is approved by ODU, Classification unit
3	Position Creation	2	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
4	Atlas E-recruit entry/approval of vacancy	0.2	No	CO	Needs to be performed by UNDP SM
5	Receipt of applications	14	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can also be advertised for 7 days.
6	Longlisting (average time needed for 200 applications)	2.5	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	
7	Shortlist (average time needed for 80 applications)	3	No	CO	Minimum 2 shortlisters required at the same or higher level as the position. Other UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
8	Organizing and conducting written test	3	No	CO	Not a requirement, can be skipped, however useful to test technical competencies and to further trim the shortlist. The time includes creation of test questions. So far only finance position accounting testing is performed by the HQ
9	Written test scoring	4	No	CO	Min. 2 scorers required at the same of higher position. Other UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
10	Organizing and conducting interviews (5 candidates)	5	No	CO	Incl. notification of candidates that should be min. 3 days in advance
11	Finalizing, circulating and approving interview reports	3	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Professional minute takers can be hired
12	Reference check, verification of credentials)	4	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can be run parallel as soon as interview list is known, currently performed by COs but in future to outsource
14	Issuing letter of offer/accepting offer	3	No	CO	
15	Issuing/Accepting Letter of Appointment	2	No	CO	
16	Medical Clearance	5	n/a	HQ	Fitness certificate from a medical practitioner is required
Total time (days)		54.2			

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TA recruitment

Step		Time (days)	Can be outsourced?	Location of Performance	Comment
<i>Note: Waiver from competitive process can be given up to 10 contracts Roster can be used, the time of recruitment shortens to appr. 10 days from the CVs desk review</i>					
1	TOR drafting, approving	3	No	CO	Hiring Manager has to draft and finalize job description in consultation with HR
2	Position Classification	0.5	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	For Local Positions - HR to classify and approved by Head of Office. For international positions - classification is approved by ODU, Classification unit
3	Position Creation	2	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
4	Atlas E-recruit entry/approval of vacancy	0.2	No	CO	Needs to be performed by UNDP SM
5	Receipt of applications	14	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can also be advertised for 7 days.
6	Longlisting (average time needed for 200 applications)	2.5	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	
7	Shortlist (average time needed for 80 applications)	3	No	CO	Minimum 2 shortlisters required at the same or higher level as the position. Other UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
8	Organizing and conducting written test	3	No	CO	Only/In-person. Not a requirement, can be skipped, however useful to test technical competencies and to further trim the shortlist. The time includes creation of test questions. So far only finance position accounting testing is performed by the HQ
9	Written test scoring	4	No	CO	Min. 2 scorers required at the same of higher position. Other UNDP Office or UN Agency can be involved
10	Organizing and conducting interviews (5 candidates)	5	No	CO	Incl. notification of candidates that should be min. 3 days in advance
11	Finalizing, circulating and approving interview reports	3	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Professional minute takers can be hired
12	Reference check, verification of credentials)	4	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Can be run parallel as soon as interview list is known, currently performed by COs but in future to outsource
13	Organizing and conducting CRB	3	No	CO	
14	Issuing letter of offer/accepting offer	3	No	CO	
15	Issuing/Accepting Letter of Appointment	2	No	CO	
16	Medical Clearance	5	n/a	HQ	Performed by the UN Medical Division
Total time (days)		57.2			

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Contract Management

Step		Time (days)	Can be outsourced?	Location of Performance	Commen
1	Hiring documents completion, Hiring of Staff member in Atlas, their dependents, MIPh enrolment, Life insurance managing life events, pension enrolment	1	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Staff member provides duly filled and signed hiring forms. Hiring/Rehiring is performed online by UNDP HR SM
2	Email creation, ATLAS profile creation & approval, UN ID card and access card processing	2	No	CO	UNDP HR SM/Project Admin. Focal Point
3	Separation (Exclusive Agreed Separation)	10	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Performed online by UNDP HR SM
4	Agreed Separation Cases	45-50	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Performed online by UNDP HR SM
5	Settlement/Withdrawal of Pension Fund	1	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Processed by UNDP HR SM. Pension withdrawal is processed by Pension Fund in 1-2 months maximum.
6	Payroll entries, validation, disbursement	7	Yes	GSSC	outsourced to GSSC
7	Salary advance request, review, approval, disbursement, recovery	3	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Performed online by UNDP SM & HR admin for agency's staff and payment via voucher by GSSC
8	Contract expiry notification- FT/SC	2	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Contract expiry notifications are sent by UNDP HR SM to hiring manager / unit chief 60 days earlier than expiry of SM's contract.
9	Contract extension, within-grade increment, SPA entitlements	1	Yes	SURGE Service Hub	Performed online by UNDP HR SM.
10	Leave monitoring, adjustments, reconciliation	1-10 of the month	No	CO	Performed by /Absence Processor & Payroll Administrator
11	Performance management, PMD online management, trouble shooting	3 Phase cycle	No	CO	Performed by HR SM (Focal point for PMD)

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Vendors and Financial Transactions

Step		Time required	Can be outsourced?	Location of Performance	Comment
1 Vendor Management					
	Vendor Entry	20 min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
	Vendor Approval	10 min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
2 Payment Processing/Banking					
	Receipt of documents		No	CO	Finance has to keep original documents
	Scanning of documents		No	CO	Required if voucher entry outsourced time depends on volume. In crises situation signed cover page is sufficient
	Voucher entry	10 min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to the Global Shared Service Center (GSSC). Supporting docs need to be scanned and uploaded to GSSC online stie
	Voucher approval and budget check	10min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
	Paycycle running	15 min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC
	Payment processing (EFT)	30min	Yes	GSSC	If H2H modality in place. If not, local currency payments need to be processed by the CO, out of Atlas.
	Payment processing, approval (Cheque)	1h	No	CO	
	Bank Reconciliation	1d	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC. Time depends on the volume of payment and other factors, e.c. cheque payment modality
3 Other major finance related actions					
	APJV entry	10min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC. Supporting documents need to be scanned and uploaded to the GSSC online site
	Payment Cancellation	20 min	Yes	GSSC	Outsource to GSSC. Supporting documents need to be scanned and uploaded to the GSSC online site

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5.14 Notes on Communication

Note: The following communications-related observations and recommendations have been proposed by the communications consultant deployed as surge advisor to support the Yemen country office.

Strategy and Implementation Protocols

Fundamentally, a sub-office (Hodeidah) communication strategy should complement and strengthen an existing framework of mutually reinforcing strategies and collaborative efforts. Closer collaboration on communication between agencies in Hodeidah would be beneficial for both the UN system and individual UN agencies.

Recommendation: UNDP and other agencies/offices supporting peace negotiation efforts should establish mutually reinforcing communication strategies for Hodeidah, including common principles and protocols; and a system for regular planning and information-sharing.

Internally, UNDP (HQ, RBAS, Yemen/Hodeidah) should establish its own protocols for the conception, approval and public release of information on behalf of the agency, to ensure swift, strategic action while navigating political sensitivities. Between agencies, regular Strategic Communication meetings (including a Strat-Comms representative from relevant UN agencies, diplomatic missions and security forces) could facilitate informed, coordinated and complementary messages, responses and actions.

Recommendation: A Hodeidah-based Communication Expert should have a communication line to the HQ communications office.

Given the importance, visibility and political nature of the negotiations that UNDP/the Peace Facility supports, more communication-related consultation should happen, including the provision of guidance, between a Hodeidah-based communication team, the Sana'a based team and UNDP's corporate communication office. This will help ensure a consistent and coordinated approach.

Staff and Capacity

The Hodeidah sub-office is tightly tethered to the CO, where capacity for basic communication functions (writing, photography, film, graphic design, website maintenance, social media and international media liaison) is notably low. Understandably, responding to urgent demands takes precedence over long-term day-to-day coaching – and security risks present further limitations, meaning that many activities are outsourced.

With fewer resources and greater risks in Hodeidah, implementing a targeted communication strategy requires a strong full-time presence, with the capacity to carry out a full range of functions and overcome challenges, quickly and efficiently.

Recommendation: Prioritize capacity development of communication staff.

Work continuously with communication staff, providing on-going skills training and direct coaching in all core communication areas. Engage Communication Expert(s) to oversee/develop staff capacity in: writing/journalism; media liaison; website management; graphic design; photo/video production; and social media.

The Hodeidah-based Communication Expert could oversee both the implementation of a Hodeidah strategy and train and coach 1 – 2 national staff in these core areas. As capacity is strengthened, staff would provide increasing support to the Expert.

Recommendation: Equip the communication team with professional software.

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All communication staff should be equipped with and trained to use Adobe Creative Suite – InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Premiere Pro. In addition to improving internal capacity, this will reduce the time and cost of managing service providers while increasing control over product quality/branding.

Operating Context

The prevalent UNDP approach to communication (qualitative, optimistic, ambiguous) is insufficient and inappropriate in the context of Yemen/Hodeidah. Overstating success is inauthentic and serves no strategic purpose.

Recommendation: Demonstrate a thorough understanding of the Yemeni context and emphasise the value of UNDP within that context.

Prioritize information with a practical purpose – quantitative indicators, expert analysis, theories of change linked to concrete case studies, personal/social experiences as described by Yemenis in their own words. Provide audiences with a better understanding of the Yemeni people and context.

Advantages, Risks and Opportunities

The challenges to stakeholders (including media) to enter/collect information from Yemen represents an opportunity for UNDP. In addition to its designated role in supporting peace negotiations, long-term in-country presence, well-established reputation and local networks, UNDP's unique core "product" is the expertise of its own national and international staff. Its unique ability to procure information and analysis is an opportunity for UNDP to raise awareness and disseminate information about the situation in Yemen while remaining politically neutral.

At the same time, UNDP must sustain the trust of local networks and the communities in which it works; and avoid exposing any individuals to unnecessary danger.

Recommendation: In Hodeidah, increase level of exchanges and communication with local communities.

Where confidence is likely to be low, UNDP must explain its role and interventions, manage expectations (clarifying both what is and is not possible and acknowledging both opportunities and challenges), cultivate relationships and encourage genuine dialogue.

Recommendation: Among international stakeholders, establish UNDP as a reliable and authoritative source for humanitarian/development content (facts, figures, data visualization, photos, film, case studies and expert analysis).

Assist stakeholders (including international media), who have limited or no access to Yemen. Conduct a stakeholder survey to identify specific information needs, in relation to shared objectives, and include them in Yemen/Hodeidah action plans.

Recommendation: Prioritize media relationships.

Designate 1 – 2 communication persons the project of developing functional relationships with national and international media. Study audience demographics, media/geographic reach, corporate interests and focus issues. Tailor information packages, grant exclusives, and hone a system for delivering the right information to the right audiences at the right time.

Recommendation: Involve national staff as interlocutors.

Given cultural and environmental sensitivities, UNDP should rely heavily on its national staff as facilitators and interlocutors. In responding to the information needs of stakeholders (including media),

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this could include gathering case studies; receiving inputs and feedback from the communities that UNDP serves; and producing audio-visual clips for sharing via traditional or social media.

Recommendation: Engage Yemeni communities in information-gathering and content-creation.

Provide platforms through which Yemenis can (safely) explain their own situation; provide tools such as inexpensive cameras and video cameras and training in skills such as interviewing and survey administration.

Recommendation: Showcase the expertise housed at UNDP Yemen and its Hodeidah team.

Equip UNDP expert staff to participate in high-profile academic/expert forums; and publish scholarly and public interest articles. Ensure familiarity of staff with key messages and provide media/speech training to those who are authorized to speak and/or represent the office at public events.

The Hodeidah team might also consider producing a flagship publication – regularly measuring a small and specific set of indicators and producing an annual trend report – as a product/platform on which awareness and interest can be expanded.

Recommendation: Package information in ways that equip partners to communicate with their own domestic audiences, and that naturally expands the reach of UNDP messages.

Capitalise on the advantages of social/digital media. Be familiar with trends and demographics as well as the purposes and audiences of various stakeholders. Package information so that it is engaging, useful, and easily extracted, adapted and shared.

5.15 Overview of rated recommendations

The below tables provide the detailed review and prioritization of recommendations. The letters “I”, “U” and “P” stand for Impact, Urgency and Priority, and the letters “F”, “C” and “L” for feasibility, complexity and “Low Hanging Fruit”. The latter identifies recommendations that have low degrees of costs and feasibility, while promising a reasonable level of impact.

The ratings for I, U, F and C were initially proposed by the authors of this report. The level of priority has been identified by multiplying impact and urgency. For “low-hanging fruits”, impact was multiplied with feasibility and divided by costs. The results of this slightly mechanic approach have subsequently been vetted by AAR stakeholders.

Corporate Level Recommendations

Review Area	#	Recommendation	Lead	I	U	P	F	C	L
Corporate Response Strategy & Leadership	1	Invest further into, and enhance collaboration between UNDP, DPPA/DPO and possibly IFIs aiming at formally defining UNDP’s institutional role in post-conflict settings (startup support, technical advice and implementation support, key deployments).	CB	2	2	4	3	1	6
Corporate Response Strategy & Leadership	2	Establish a corporate support mechanism to country offices in performing a coordination function in post-conflict contexts focusing on the areas of peacebuilding, rule of law, livelihood recovery, and government coordination capacities.	CB	3	2	6	2	2	3
Corporate Response Mechanism	3	Further encourage and mainstream the close technical collaboration and communication between CB and RB, using annual work plans, performance discussions and PMDs.	CB	2	2	4	3	1	6
Corporate Response Mechanism	4	Clarify role of corporate bureaus and align resources accordingly.	EXO	2	2	4	2	2	2
Corporate Response Mechanism	5	Introduce a corporate L3 follow-up and support mechanism.	CB	2	2	4	3	1	6
Corporate Response Mechanism	6	Introduce default rapid CO capacity assessment methodology as standing practice (supported by BMS).	BMS	3	3	9	3	1	9
Corporate Response Mechanism	7	Introduce a crisis management qualification for UNDP operations staff.	BMS	3	2	6	2	2	3
Corporate Response Mechanism	8	Revamp and include crisis operations training into the DRR introduction (both at regional and corporate level).	BMS	3	2	6	3	2	4.5
Corporate Response Mechanism	9	Include the review of use of mainstreamed crisis procedures during an L1-L3 crisis into UNDP country office audits. In case procedures were not used, the audit should formulate a negative audit finding.	BMS	2	2	4	2	1	4
Corporate Response Mechanism	10	CB to engage with OAI to support the creating of an audit approach that reviews the use of procedures during surge settings.	CB	2	2	4	3	1	6
Corporate Response Mechanism	11	Introduce the “3+6 surge” mechanism (surge, transition, institutionalization).	CB	3	3	9	3	2	4.5
Corporate Response Mechanism	12	For sub office establishment / surge responses in complex settings, establish and train rapid response teams (including OM and Construction Engineer).	CB	3	2	6	1	3	1

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Corporate Response Mechanism	13	Include a security specialist by default in all L3 post-conflict surge responses and ensure the entire period of covered.	CB	3	3	9	3	2	4.5
Corporate Response Mechanism	14	Introduce a revolving fund with XB/GMS reimbursement scheme serving L2 and L3 crises, especially start-up funding for sub offices.	BMS	3	2	6	1	2	1.5
Deployments	15	Mainstream the “careful selection practice” for L2/L3 and ensure CB has adequate capacities to perform this task.	CB	2	2	4	2	1	4
Deployments	16	Establish a dedicated contract modality for L3 (insurance coverage, LP, staff status, reasonable pro-forma costs, fast-track recruitment).	BMS	3	3	9	2	1	6
Deployments	17	Negotiate an adequate insurance package to be offered of ICs to be deployed in high-risk environments.	BMS	3	3	9	3	1	9
Deployments	18	Ensure LPs are fast-tracked and delivered before / at EOD (validity can be restricted to 6 months).	BMS	2	2	4	2	1	4
Deployments	19	Introduce systematic mission briefing & debriefing, and establish required capacities.	CB	2	2	4	3	2	3
Deployments	20	Introduce a standard procedure for regular well-being counselling (Rome Institute).	CB	2	2	4	3	2	3
Corporate Implementation Support	21	Establishment of a flexible surge operations support center at HQ level to absorb temporary workload peaks in all areas.	CB	3	3	9	1	3	1
Corporate Implementation Support	22	Clearly base operational processes supporting surge operations in either the CO or the corporate support structure to avoid process confusion and delays.	CB	2	2	4	3	1	6
Corporate Implementation Support	23	In protracted settings, introduce systematically scenario preparedness planning supported by joint RB/CB/GPN capacity.	CB	3	2	6	2	2	3
Corporate Implementation Support	24	Expand the UNDP existing crisis packages with (a) the stabilization approach and (b) a package specifically designed for post-conflict political transition settings.	CB	2	2	4	3	2	3
Corporate Implementation Support	25	Establish a STRATCOM & Marketing capacity for L3 settings (led by BERA).	BERA	2	2	4	3	2	3
Corporate Implementation Support	26	Designate a dedicated HQ-based spokesperson for L3 settings, especially in politicized contexts such as Yemen.	BERA	3	3	9	2	2	3
Corporate Implementation Support	27	Strengthen linkage and interaction between Surge COMS deployment and HQ COMS office (invest into Surge COMS consultants).	BERA	2	2	4	3	1	6

Country-level recommendations

Review Area	#	Recommendation	Lead	I	U	P	F	C	L
CO Response Structure and Capacities	28	For future surge support, assess country office operations capacities in view of needs prior to the design of the surge package.	BMS	2	2	4	2	1	4
CO Response Structure and Capacities	29	Assign matrix management responsibility to Amman liaison office for surge staff based in Amman, and revise job descriptions as required to maximize use of these capacities.	CO	3	3	9	3	1	9
CO Response Structure and Capacities	30	Introduce regular (quarterly) feedback loop between CO middle managers (aligned with adaptive management).	CO	2	2	4	2	1	4

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CO Response Structure and Capacities	31	Establish a technical coordination group in Hodeidah covering the areas of livelihood recovery, peacebuilding, government coordination capacity building and rule of law, and launch key assessments in close collaboration with SCMCHA.	CO	2	3	6	2	2	2
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	32	Clarify sub office financial architecture, including the establishment of a dedicated budget.	CO	3	3	9	2	1	6
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	33	Ensure all SO staff is paid from a project budget dedicated to Hodeidah operations or from the SO budget.	CO	3	2	6	2	1	6
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	34	Staff re-deployment / regular circulation from main to sub office to facilitate main office – sub office exchanges and on-the-job training of new sub office staff.	CO	2	3	6	2	1	4
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	35	Clarify sub office contract modalities and realign contracts and staffing accordingly.	CO	3	3	9	2	1	6
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	36	Provide training for business-critical functions at Hodeidah level.	CO	3	3	9	3	2	4.5
Programmatic Response	37	Further strengthen technical cooperation between Office of the Special Envoy (OSES), UNMHA and UNDP – especially in areas of political transition (Dialogue, Constitution, SSR, Reintegration, possibly PVE).	CO	2	2	4	3	1	6
Programmatic Response	38	Ensure joint up-front communication and planning between programme and operations colleagues for key programme activities.	CO	2	2	4	3	1	6
Programmatic Response	39	Expand of CfW programme at Hodeidah level as much as possible and launch planned Waste2Energy project. Discuss and agree on approaches for Power (Electrification) and Wash at central level.	CO	2	2	4	2	2	2
Programmatic Response	40	Increase the exchange between CO and Surge programmes, including the introduction of dedicated feedback loop sessions at programme / SO level.	CO	2	2	4	2	1	4
Operational Response	41	Outsource administrative/operational tasks for areas where staff presence in the CO is not required.	CO	3	2	6	2	1	6
Operational Response	42	Targeted training / preparation of CO operations colleagues covering business-critical functions.	CO	3	3	9	3	2	4.5
Operational Response	43	Carry out a business process review exercise for surge-critical functions, including adequate delegation/expansion of approvals. Consider combining the process review with process training.	CO	2	2	4	2	2	2
Operational Response	44	Explore additional approaches to increase bandwidth in Sana'a and Aden.	CO	3	3	9	1	1	3
Operational Response	45	Create skeleton operational capacities in Amman, and transfer process steps requiring stable internet connectivity to Amman.	CO	2	2	4	2	2	2
Operational Response	46	Organize monthly briefings with local and national authorities on incoming staff and missions to facilitate visa approval processes.	CO	3	2	6	3	1	9
Operational Response	47	Issuance of UNLPs for Service Contract Holders.	BMS	2	3	6	2	1	4
Operational Response	48	Comprehensive review of country office financial sustainability and staff sources of funding (staff budgeted on projects).	CO	2	2	4	3	1	6
Resources Mobilisation and Communication	49	Develop, implement and monitor a SO communication strategy (linking into CO strategy).	CO	3	2	6	3	1	9
Resources Mobilisation and Communication	50	Launch a dedicated “apolitical” communication campaign in Hodeidah targeting communities and grand population.	CO	2	3	6	3	2	3
Resources Mobilisation and Communication	51	Train SO project staff on key communication functions related to gathering of pictures, footage and data.	CO	2	2	4	2	2	2

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Resources Mobilisation and Communication	52	Use assessment data to shape quality public information and public interest products (Humans of Hodeidah ...).	CO	2	1	2	3	1	6
Resources Mobilisation and Communication	53	Build relationships with key Yemeni media outlets and journalists, in collaboration with authorities.	CO	2	1	2	2	1	4

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